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Buying the dip? This bull run has offered shallow ones

LIMITED DOWNSIDE. Data show fewer deep corrections, longer gaps and shallower drawdowns in the current cycle; domestic liquidity cushions markets

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Indian investors have been relentless dip-buyers in recent years. Every bout of market weakness is seen as an opportunity to add equities, top up SIPs or deploy idle cash.

But an uncomfortable detail remains hidden in the data: In the current bull market, investors have largely been buying shallow dips, not deep wounds which is when investors get more bang for the buck.

Since the rally began on March 23, 2020, the Nifty 50 has delivered one of the strongest bull runs in Indian market history. It has also been unusually forgiving. Sharp declines have been less frequent, large drawdowns have been limited.

That is why the recent correction needs perspective. Seen in isolation, the market turmoil since the September 2024 peak may look unsettling.

There has been sharp stock-specific damage, global uncertainty and persistent nervousness around foreign flows. However, when benchmarked against earlier cycles, the takeaway is different: The current phase has seen fewer deep corrections, less frequent pullbacks, and more contained declines.

The popular "buy the dip" narrative may, therefore, be overstated.

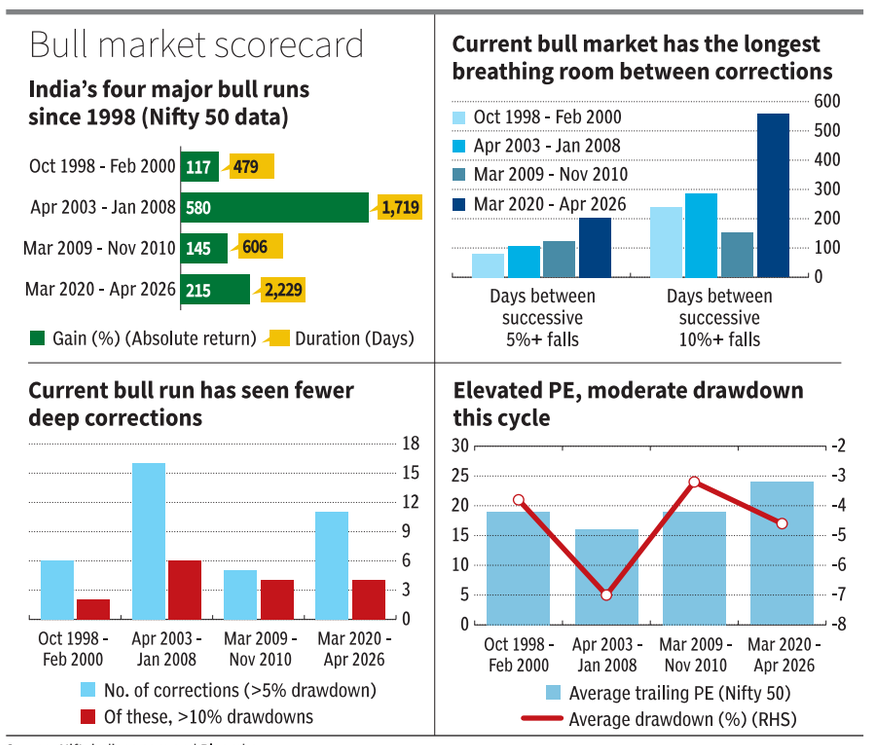
To assess how severe the current correction really is, we studied each bull phase for the Nifty 50.

We counted how often the market fell more than 5 per cent and 10 per cent from recent highs, how frequently such declines occurred, and how deep the drawdowns were on average.

FEWER DEEP CORRECTIONS

Despite running for more than 2,229 days, the ongoing bull market has seen only four drawdowns exceeding 10 per cent.

This is lower than the 2003-08 bull market, which saw six such instances, and comparable to the much shorter 2009-10 phase, despite the current cycle being significantly longer.



Source: Niftyindices.com and Bloomberg

Based on Nifty 500 data, the trend is even stronger, with just three such instances.

This shows that investors are experiencing fewer large shocks over a much longer period in the current phase.

The average interval between corrections exceeding 5 per cent has increased consistently across bull cycles.

It stood at average of 80 days in the 1998-2000 rally, rose to 107 days in the 2003-08 phase, then to 121 days in the 2009-10 surge, and now stands at a remarkable 203 days in the current bull run.

While investors may perceive short-term volatility, the data clearly shows that meaningful corrections are happening far less often than before.

Further the average drawdown in the current bull market stands at about -4.6 per cent.

While this is slightly higher than the milder corrections seen during the 1998-2000 and 2009-10 bull phases, it is meaningfully lower than the -7 per cent average drawdown recorded during the 2003-08 rally.

HIGH VALUATIONS ABSORBED

Average Nifty PE has climbed from 16x in 2003-08 and 19x in 2009-10 to about 24x in the current phase, with a peak of 31x.

Conventional wisdom suggests that higher valuations should lead to sharper and more frequent corrections. The data tells a different story.

Despite these premium multiples, the gap between corrections of more than 10 per cent has more than doubled, or is close to doubling, to about 557 days in the current phase.

In earlier bull markets, foreign institutional investors were the primary drivers of liquidity, often amplifying both rallies and corrections.

The present cycle marks a decisive shift.

Despite net outflows of about ₹47,878 crore from foreign investors, domestic institutional investors have infused over ₹20-lakh crore into equities.

This strong domestic participation has acted as a powerful stabilising force.

TAKEAWAY

The data show a clear pattern in the current bull market.

Despite what sentiment may indicate with 339 stocks out of Nifty 500 currently trading more than 20 per cent below their lifetime highs, of which 74 stocks are down over 50 per cent from their peaks, at an index level corrections remain far less severe than in past cycles.

Reacting to every dip with aggressive buying may protect near-term returns, but in a market where deep corrections are scarce it could also impact long-term returns.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

SAIL: Accumulate

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

The recent steel price rebound following imposition of duty safeguards on imports from China as compared to the decline in last three years, and inherent operational leverage of steel industry present an opportunity in the steel sector for long term investors.

SAIL is trading at 7.7 times one-year forward EV/EBITDA, which is a 42 per cent premium to last five-year average, post the 25 per cent YTD gains in the stock. Peers Jindal Steel, JSW Steel and Tata Steel are also trading at a premium to their past averages. This premium is in anticipation of an upcycle ahead over the next few years.

Hence, high-risk investors with a long-term perspective can consider accumulating on dips the stock of SAIL in current volatile environment. Despite increasing raw material costs, SAIL can sustain high profit growth assuming steel prices recover and costs are controlled.

Specialised investment funds see rapid growth, especially beyond top 30 cities

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Specialised Investment Funds, introduced recently by the market regulator SEBI for sophisticated investors, is fast catching on, with 50 per cent participation from smaller cities (beyond the top 30).

Fund houses are rushing to capitalise on the first-mover advantage as the minimum investment of ₹10 lakh is set at the fund house level. In a way, this may be advantageous to large mutual fund houses as a person who has invested ₹10 lakh with a large fund house's SIF can also invest ₹50,000 in subsequent offerings of the same fund house.

Madhu Nair, Chief Executive Officer, Union Mutual Fund, said that as of now, there is no clear distinction between large and small fund houses as the SIF playfield has just opened, and no one knows who will make it big.

RISING PARTICIPATION

The SIF asset holding is also interesting, with investors from smaller cities accounting for 30 per cent, compared with 20 per cent in MF business, and this clearly shows that aspiration has no pincode, he said. "SIF as a category for the industry should have an AUM of ₹1 lakh crore in 3 years," he added.

Anand Vardarajan, Chief Business Officer, Tata MF, said the fund house is extremely excited about SIF because it solves problems around tax, ticket size, and talent.

"At ₹10 lakh, investors are getting a very superior product. Over the next couple of years, this category can become very big. Until now, for investments to do well, markets had to go up. In this product, you can participate 100 per cent of the time, regardless of whether the market is in a bull, bear or sideways phase," he said.

The SIF AUM has more than doubled to ₹10,620 crore in March, up from ₹4,892 crore in December. The number of offerings has also doubled to 14 quarter-on-quarter as of March-end, according to the Association of Mutual Funds in India data.

EARLY MOVERS

SBI Mutual Fund's Magnum SIF has taken the early lead with an AUM of ₹2,994 crore against ₹1,181 crore logged in the December quarter, followed by ₹2,366 crore (₹508 crore) of early-mover Altiva SIF of Edelweiss MF and ₹1,036 crore of the latest entrant iSIF of ICICI MF. Others to make a mark in SIF include qSIF of quant MF (₹867 crore), Titanium SIF of Tata MF (₹404 crore) and Diviniti SIF of ITI MF (₹355 crore).

Though the industry is rushing to the market, distribution has remained the weak link, with only 6,000 distributors clearing the NISM's 150-mark test covering derivative market basics, trading strategies, risk management, and regulations.

Interestingly, there is also negative marking: 1 mark is deducted from the total score for every 4 wrong answers. The exam also includes currency derivatives, which are hardly used in SIF.

Besides hand-holding distributors to clear exams, the industry has been pushing SEBI to remove the negative marks and currency derivatives from the syllabus.

Govt appoints 2 more full-time members to NITI Aayog

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Centre on Saturday appointed academician Joram Aniya and scholar-author R Balasubramaniam as full-time members of the NITI Aayog, taking the total number of members in the government think tank to seven, along with a Vice-Chairman.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is the Chairman of the NITI Aayog.

An accomplished academician, associate professor, and member of the Arunachal Pradesh Private Educational Regulatory Commission, Aniya has more than 18 years of experience in teaching, research, and public policy engagement.

Scholar-author Balasubramaniam is a public policy expert and development activist.

GAS RUSH

PRICE PRESSURE. People crowd an LPG vendor in New Delhi on Saturday to buy a cylinder a day after the price of commercial gas cylinders was hiked. A 19-kg commercial LPG cylinder is now costlier by a whopping ₹993. While domestic LPG price remains unchanged, there was fear of a hike coming and a scramble to buy ANI

Plugging into young talent to power next-gen grid

APTransco to offer internships to students of IITs, top institutes to build deployable solutions

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

In a move that blends talent scouting with grid innovation, Andhra Pradesh Transmission Corporation (APTransco) is opening its control rooms to students from IITs and other premier institutes, inviting them to work on real-life power transmission challenges.

The utility is rolling out its Summer Internship Programme 2026 as a hands-on, problem-solving platform embedded within State grid operations. Unlike conventional internships, the programme is designed around implementation-ready outcomes, with participants expected to build solutions

that can be deployed on the network.

Interns will be assigned clearly defined problem statements, mentored by senior utility engineers, and work with real-time data and field exposure. The focus spans both advanced analytics and core engineering systems.

APTransco has identified 44 problem statements across 10 functional wings, covering areas such as grid planning, renewable energy forecasting, substation automation, cybersecurity and financial analytics.

The programme departs sharply from observation-led internships. Participants will be tasked with developing AI models to improve solar and wind forecasting, creating digital twins for grid operations, deploying drone- and computer vision-based systems for asset inspection, and designing decision-support tools for real-time power procurement

"The objective is to create outputs that can be directly deployed within the utility. Every project is linked to real-time data, field exposure and operational use-cases," APTransco said.

PILOT BATCH

The first cohort will include 30 interns, with scope to scale up in subsequent cycles. "Power utilities are increasingly turning to Artificial Intelligence, predictive analytics and automation to manage growing renewable energy loads, improve efficiency and enhance safety," an official said.

Selected interns will receive a stipend of up to ₹25,000 a month, with top performers potentially considered for extended engagements, pilot projects and future collaborations with State utilities.

India opens automatic route for FDI by firms with up to 10% Chinese stake

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry on Saturday notified amendments to the Foreign Exchange Management Rules, allowing overseas companies with up to 10 per cent Chinese (or other land-bordering country) shareholding to invest in India under the automatic route.

The move follows a Cabinet decision to ease FDI norms for investments from land-bordering countries (LBCs) and is aimed at boosting manufacturing in electronic components, capital goods and solar cells.

China shares land borders with India as do Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Myanmar, Afghanistan and Bhutan.

The amendment introduces a clearer definition of beneficial ownership, aligned with the Prevention of Money Laundering Rules, 2005, and widely used by investors.

Under the revised framework, the beneficial ownership test will apply at the investor entity level, investments with non-controlling LBC ownership of up to 10 per cent will be allowed under the automatic route subject to sectoral caps and conditions, and investee companies must report relevant details to DPIIT.

In effect, foreign companies with up to 10 per cent Chinese or Hong Kong shareholding can now invest in sectors open under the automatic route.

KEY EXCLUSIONS

However, the relaxation does not apply to entities incorporated in China, Hong Kong or other LBCs. Earlier, even minimal shareholding from these jurisdictions triggered need for mandatory government approval; now, the restriction is linked specifically to beneficial ownership.

The notification also clarified that multilateral banks or funds of which India is a member will not be treated as entities of any specific country, nor will any country be deemed the beneficial owner of such investments. At the same time, investments involving any direct or indirect LBC ownership — while not requiring prior approval under the revised norms — will remain subject to RBI-prescribed reporting requirements.

TIMEFRAME

Separately, the Cabinet has mandated that proposals involving LBC investments in key manufacturing segments such as capital goods, electronic components, polysilicon and ingot-wafer be processed within 60 days.

In all such cases, majority ownership and control must remain with resident Indian citizens or Indian-owned entities.

bl.portfolio

WISE WORDS.

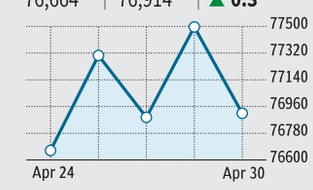
Financial regulators and law enforcement are archaeologists. Short sellers and financial journalists are financial detectives.

JIM CHANOS
Forensic investor

MARKET ACTION.

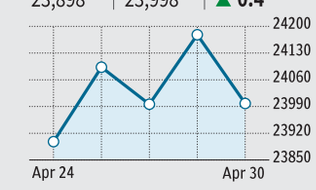
SENSEX

Week ago	Latest	Change (%)
76,664	76,914	▲ 0.3



NIFTY

Week ago	Latest	Change (%)
23,898	23,998	▲ 0.4



5 governance traps that destroy investor wealth

SORDID TRICKS. An analysis of SEBI orders reveals how some companies create, divert or distort value before investors realise the damage

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

A stock may fall because markets are weak or has been bought at a bad elevated price. But in many cases, investor wealth is destroyed because the company itself is hollowing out value. This is done through suspect fund flows, inflated profits, delayed disclosures, promoter-linked transactions or trading patterns that make prices look more genuine than they are. In stock markets, volatility is the risk investors can see. But corporate governance failure is the risk they often cannot see. Corporate governance simply means how honestly and responsibly a company is run; lapses occur when those in control use weak disclosures, poor oversight or unfair transactions to benefit insiders at the cost of other shareholders.

An analysis of last 12 months' SEBI orders, which run into over 500 pages (all combined), shows that these are not always random lapses. They often follow repeatable patterns. Money is raised but not used as promised. Profits are made to look better than they are. Assets are moved at questionable valuations. Stock prices rise even when business fundamentals deteriorate. Such actions can play out over months or years. By the time the regulator steps in, investors may already have paid the price. The useful question, therefore, is not just what went wrong in these cases, but what investors could have watched for earlier.

Here are five governance traps, and the warning signs they leave behind.

1 MONEY WITHOUT ACTUAL CASH

One typical pattern involves capital appearing to be created without a corresponding inflow of funds into the business. It is like showing a bank deposit by moving the same ₹100 through several accounts and calling each movement fresh money.

Between December 2, 2024, and January 16, 2025, the share price of Pacheli Industrial Finance moved from ₹21.02 to ₹78.20, a rise of 372 per cent in just over a month. The stock was hitting the 5 per cent upper circuit every day from December 9, 2024. Its market capitalisation rose from about ₹40 crore to over ₹4,000 crore in eight months, despite negligible revenues in the previous three financial years. Its P/E ratio moved above 4 lakh!

SEBI stepped in after internal alerts. Pacheli had reported loans of about ₹850 crore from six entities. These loans were later converted into equity, resulting in the issuance of over 51 crore shares and giving the said allottees control of nearly 99 per cent of the company. At first glance, this looked like a normal financial restructuring.

However, SEBI observed that in Pacheli, the funds moved in a loop. The purported loan money was received by the company, transferred to other entities and subsequently that was returned to the original lenders, often within short timeframes. Based on this, SEBI noted that the transactions raised questions about whether the company had received actual consideration for the shares issued. Thus, the six entities effectively acquired near-total control of the company without a genuine net outflow of funds.

This practice is commonly referred to as round-tripping. In plain English, money came in, went out and came back to the same people. The governance concern is weak oversight, where transactions may comply in form but lack clear economic substance.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Large loans raised, but no corresponding fixed asset build-up
- Funds moving out within days of receipt
- Preferential allotments tied to loan-to-equity conversions
- Sudden ownership concentration after such issues
- Cash flow statements showing high inflow and outflow in same period

2 MONEY ROUTED OUT

A second pattern involves money being raised for stated business purposes and then routed through layers of entities.

In the much-publicised Gensol Engineering case, SEBI looked into the company pursuant to receipt of a complaint in June 2024. The regulator examined loans of ₹663.89 crore taken from IREDA and PFC for procuring 6,400 electric vehicles (EVs). Under the loan terms, the solar EPC player turned EV lessor and manufacturer, Gensol, also had to bring in a 20 per cent equity or margin contribution, taking the total expected deployment to ₹829.86 crore. Against this, the company procured 4,704 EVs worth ₹567.73 crore, leaving a gap of ₹262.13 crore, according to SEBI. The order also noted that Gensol had transferred ₹775 crore to EV supplier Go-Auto, which was ₹207.27 crore more than the value of vehicles delivered. SEBI observed that funds were routed through the supplier and allegedly moved to promoter (Jaggi brothers)-linked entities, with some end-uses appearing personal in nature including purchase of high-end real estate. Red flags on the company's financial position could be seen looking at negative free cash flows, rising promoter share pledges, and resignation of CFO just after credit rating fiasco, and these were highlighted by a March 2025 *bl.portfolio* piece (https://tinyurl.com/gensolbl).

SME IPOs also seem to be a fertile ground for such lapses. Take a look at the June-July 2023 public issue of IT products and networking solutions provider Synoptics Technologies. Here, the regulator was actually forced to step in after receipt of alleged irregularities in the bidding process. In this case, over 35 per cent of the IPO proceeds was moved out of escrow account a mere 24 hours before listing and trading approval. The transfers were described as issue-related expenses, though the amount was far higher than what had been disclosed in the prospectus. SEBI also found that the bank accounts receiving funds did not match the entities named in the agreements.

Since this issue's Lead Manager was First Overseas Capital (FOCL), the regulator initiated examination into utilisation of funds raised by various companies through IPO in the SME segment where FOCL handled the IPO assignments.

And *voila*, a simpler version of this *modus operandi* was seen in the case of yet another FOCL-handled SME IPO in March 2023 of Nirman Agri Genetics, which was involved in the business of agriculture hybrid seeds, crop protection solution, pesticides. In the case of this three-year-old company, SEBI observed that nearly 93 per cent of the proceeds was transferred to entities that were either not found at their stated addresses or had questionable credentials. Site visits raised doubts about their business activity, and SEBI noted concerns around documents used to justify some transactions. Large payments were also followed by cash withdrawals, with explanations such as payments to farmers, which SEBI questioned.

WHAT TO WATCH

- IPO/loan funds routed to unknown or recently formed entities
- Track quarterly filings on IPO fund utilisation to spot deviations
- Vendors that lack physical presence or track record
- Frequent high-value transactions disconnected from core business

In such cases, the governance concern is the possible misuse of public or borrowed funds, inadequate disclosure of related-party transactions and weak oversight.

For investors, warning signs include large fund-raising without visible asset creation, payments to unfamiliar entities and high-value transactions that do not match the company's scale of operations.

3 INFLATED PROFITS

A third pattern involves how financial performance is presented. This is not necessarily by moving money, but by changing how gains, losses and expenses appear in reported numbers. It is like keeping expenses out of the monthly budget to make household savings look higher!

In the case of ad-tech firm Brightcom Group, SEBI — post receipt of certain complaints — found that profits were overstated by over ₹1,200 crore across two years. One key issue was the classification of large impairment losses under "other comprehensive income" instead of the profit and loss account. Put simply, these losses did not reduce the headline profit figure in the way they should have.

SEBI also found issues with the capitalisation of research and development costs, where certain expenses were treated as assets rather than being recognised as expenses.

Alongside this, SEBI flagged repeated disclosure issues, including incorrect shareholding patterns across several quarters and making misleading announcement.

Elitecon International, involved in manufacturing and trading cigarettes, smoking mixtures, and *sheesha*, offers a related disclosure pattern. Post complaints related to financial statement irregularities and price/volume manipulation in the scrip, SEBI did an examination. It observed delays in disclosure of GST show-cause notices totalling ₹408.65 crore, around 22 times the company's average standalone net profit. These adverse disclosures were followed closely by positive announcements such as acquisitions and fund-raising plans (up to ₹300-crore QIP). This sequence of events appeared strategically timed to neutralise the negative impact of the tax disclosure.

The company had reported exceptional financial figures for the September 2025 quarter, with revenue increasing 6.38 times (from ₹79.13 crore to ₹504.90 crore) and net profit growing 2.28 times to ₹20.2 crore on a standalone basis. The governance concern here is two-fold: Whether financial statements present a true and fair view? Whether disclosures give investors timely and balanced information? For investors, warning signs include large adjustments outside profit numbers, repeated inconsistencies in disclosures and reported growth that does not match operational indicators such as capacity, output, cash flows etc.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Sharp profit growth despite weak cash flows or operations
- Large losses parked outside the profit line
- Repeated restatements or inconsistencies in disclosures
- Expenses being capitalised instead of expensed
- Positive announcements clustered around negative disclosures

4 ASSETS SOLD BELOW VALUE

A fourth pattern involves possible transfer of value from a listed company to promoter-linked entities through transactions that appear compliant in form.

In the case of Par Drugs and Chemicals, the company proposed selling its core profit-making business to a promoter-linked entity. SEBI observed that the valuation was based largely on physical assets and did not adequately factor in elements such as goodwill, brand, employees, technical know-how and future earnings. The proposed valuation for the slump sale was ₹93-95 crore, while independent valuation came up with a figure of ₹387 crore. The proposed transaction had already resulted in erosion of around 70 per cent of the stock value of the company since the decision was made public, with m-cap dropping from over ₹400 crore in December 2024 to ₹140 crore by September 2025.

A simple way to understand this — is a running business is not worth only its land, machinery and equipment. If it generates steady profits, its earning ability also has value. Ignoring that can lead to undervaluation.

SEBI noted that the valuation process did not properly capture the business as a going concern. It also observed that shareholders were not given adequate access to supporting information, and that a stated fairness opinion could not be produced.

The governance concern is whether minority shareholders had enough information to judge if the transaction was fair. For investors, warning signs include sale of core assets to promoter-linked entities, valuations based mainly on assets rather than earnings and limited access to valuation reports.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Sale of key business/assets to promoter-linked entities
- Valuations based on assets, not earnings or cash flows
- Lack of clarity on valuation methodology
- Limited access to valuation or fairness reports
- Repeated attempts to pass similar shareholder resolutions

5 MANUFACTURED PRICE DISCOVERY

A fifth pattern involves the use of capital structures and coordinated trading to push up stock prices. In the case of RRP Semiconductor, SEBI observed that the company's share price rose from merely ₹15 in April 2024 to over ₹10,800 by October 2025, despite weak financials. The company (earlier called G D Trading and Agencies) shot to prominence in April 2024 when its then board approved proposals to insert a new object clause relating to the manufacturing, design and development of semiconductors into the Memorandum of Association, and to change its name. Some of us would have seen social media posts about this stock's over "70,000 per cent" jump or received WhatsApp forwards, stating it is the next 'Indian Nvidia' where one unnamed celebrity cricketer may be an investor etc.

SEBI noted that RRP Semiconductor issued 1.35 crore shares at ₹12 through a preferential allotment. It also observed that one key individual had financed multiple allottees, raising concerns that control may have been concentrated while appearing dispersed. A small number of shares were then distributed in very small lots across several connected entities. Some of these entities placed buy orders at upper-circuit levels contributing to the price rise.

As the price rose, public shareholders increased sharply (22x), suggesting that retail investors entered. The governance concern is the possible misuse of preferential allotments, opaque ownership structures & trading patterns that may distort price discovery. For investors, warning signs include sudden increase in public shareholders and repeated upper-circuit trading in thinly-traded stocks. Investors can track bulk/block deal disclosures, insider-trading disclosures & SAST filings, especially when same entities repeatedly appear as acquirers/sellers or cross disclosure thresholds.

WHAT TO WATCH

- Sharp price rise without earnings or revenue support
- Frequent upper-circuit moves in low-liquidity stocks
- Sudden jump in public shareholder count
- Preferential allotments preceding price spikes
- Trading volumes driven by a small set of entities

Key takeaways

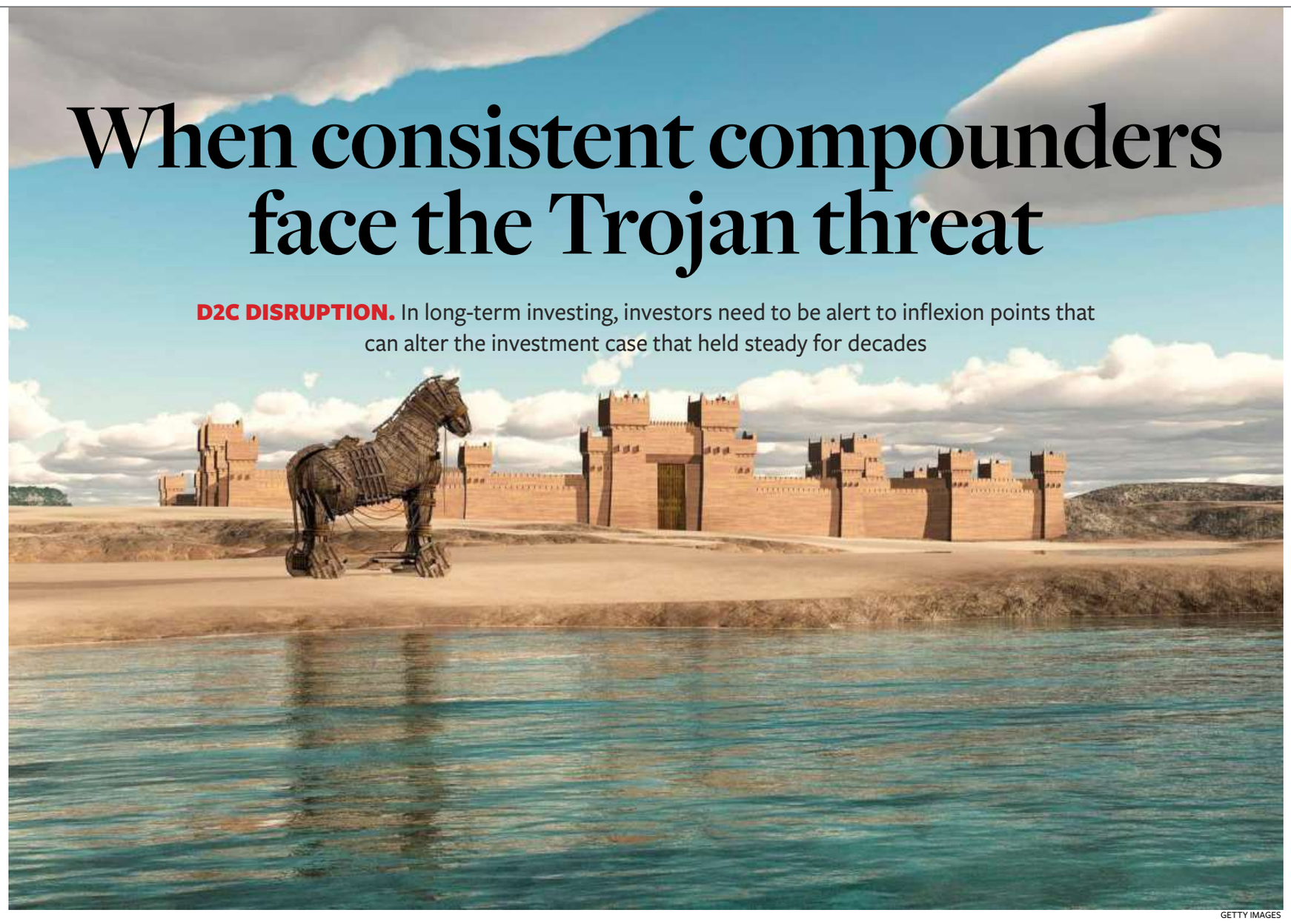
Investors must understand how the broad modus operandi works. Typically, money is first created, raised or presented by those running companies in a certain way. It is then either routed through layers, reflected differently in financial statements, or disclosed in a manner that shapes perception. In many instances, this is followed by trading activity or valuation changes that allow promoters, insiders and others involved in the scheme to benefit in a big way.

These are not isolated lapses. They are often layered systems where multiple elements — capital flows, disclosures, accounting and market activity — interact with each other.

For investors, the challenge is not to track every regulation, but to assess whether key elements are aligned. Does the money raised translate into assets or business growth? Do reported numbers match operational reality? Are disclosures timely and consistent? Does promoter behaviour align with what is being communicated? When these elements begin to diverge, the risk may extend beyond normal market volatility. Unlike price movements, which are visible and immediate, governance- related risks tend to build gradually. In some cases, prices may even rise in the interim, creating a misleading sense of comfort. But when underlying issues surface, the correction can be sharp and lasting. Recognising these patterns early does not prove wrongdoing. But it gives investors a chance to reduce exposure, demand answers, or exit before concerns become impossible to ignore. Bottom line - always invest only in businesses you can understand and not based on what excites you or hearsay. In the ocean called markets, there are numerous sharks. The onus is on you to surf in safer waters.

When consistent compounders face the Trojan threat

D2C DISRUPTION. In long-term investing, investors need to be alert to inflexion points that can alter the investment case that held steady for decades



GETTY IMAGES

Balaji Vaidyanath
Abinash Swamenathan

In the 10th year of the siege of Troy, the Greeks did something unexpected. They stopped fighting. They sailed away, leaving behind a single wooden horse on the beach as an apparent offering to the Gods. The Trojans, after a decade of successfully defending the mightiest walls in the ancient world, wheeled the horse through their gates. That night, Greek soldiers, hidden inside the horse, opened the city gates from within. Troy fell, not because its defences failed, but because the threat arrived in a form its defenders never recognised as a threat.

The walls of Troy were real. They had held for 10 years against the finest army of the age. What the Trojans could not process was that the nature of the attack had changed. The horse was not a battering ram. It was not a siege tower. It was something that looked like a gift, something the Trojans brought inside themselves.

Some of the famed quality companies and consistent compounders that swelled the coffers of Indian investors in the previous decade may now be facing this 'Trojan threat.' In long-term investing, investors need to be alert to such inflexion points that can alter the investment case that held steady for decades. The changed circumstances need to be evaluated for making the right investment calls. We try to explain this with the example of how things played out for two famed companies.

Two of India's most admired consumer companies are learning a version of this lesson. Not from Greek soldiers, but from Instagram ads, Myntra listings and *Shark Tank* episodes. While the end-game is yet to be written and unlike in the case of Troy, the companies are well positioned to fight back, this example explains how post the unrecognised inflexion points, the rules of the game changed.

ALL ABOUT THE NEXT CUSTOMER

Consider two unrelated shopping decisions. A 26-year-old in Bengaluru buys his first pair of premium underwear. A 31-year-old in Delhi buys a new suitcase before a work trip. Five years ago, both of them had one obvious answer: Jockey for the first, VIP for the second. Today, neither of them reaches for that default and the financial statements of two publicly-listed companies are beginning to show exactly what that means.

This is not a story about failing incumbents. Page Industries, which licenses the Jockey brand in India, generated ₹4,935 crore in revenue last year. VIP Industries is Asia's largest luggage manufacturer. Both companies are real businesses with genuine competitive advantages. What is changing is who gets the next customer. And in a market pricing these companies at premium multiples, the next customer is the only one that matters.

NEW BRANDS AND THEIR STORIES

The brands that caused this did not arrive with lower prices. They arrived with better stories. XYXX built its identity around a single fabric distinction and found a consumer who had been waiting for exactly that conversation. DaMENSCH named its technologies and talked about sustainability. Technosport offered performance fabrics with UV protection that Jockey's product line simply had no answer for. bummer made underwear feel like a fashion purchase.

Together, these innerwear brands have crossed ₹820 crore in combined annual revenue from zero in seven years.

In luggage, Mokobara priced into the gap above VIP and below Samsonite, and filled it with built-in phone chargers, silent wheels and design language that made a suitcase feel like something worth owning rather than replacing. uppercase made Indian manufacturing its identity. The luggage cohort has crossed $57 million in under six years. Neither cohort undercut the incumbent. Both made it feel irrelevant to a specific, valuable consumer and that consumer was the one the incumbents were counting on for growth.

THE SAME PLAYBOOK, TWICE

The pattern in both categories is identical. Find the premium buyer the incumbent has stopped trying to excite. Build a product story around fabric, sustainability or design, something beyond functionality. List on Myntra or Amazon, where the incumbent's decades-built retail network is irrelevant because this consumer is scrolling, not walking into stores. Use venture capital to buy the marketing spend that would otherwise take a decade. Then expand offline but not through mass MBO chains, but through curated stores in Indiranagar and Bandra, where the product can be felt.

By the time the incumbent sees it in their own numbers, the D2C brand already owns the most valuable consumer in the category who are the young, urban, digitally-native and spending for the next 20 years.

WHAT IT HAS COST JOCKEY

The consequences are already written into Page Industries' stock. Revenue stalled, distributor shelves piled up with unsold inventory, and the share price corrected from a peak of ₹53,500 to around ₹42,000. The more important number is the PE which halved from about 129x to about 55x. That compression is the market quietly revising how fast Jockey will grow from here. At 129x, investors were paying for a monopoly on the premium upgrade. At 55x, they are paying for a company that no longer has one.

INCUMBENTS VS D2C BRANDS

- Leadership of incumbents Jockey, VIP and Safari in jeopardy
- D2C brands have built product stories around fabric, design, sustainability
- Declining P/E of incumbents captures changing market realities

Chart 1 makes the mechanism visible. As the D2C cohort scaled from 3.3 per cent of Page's revenue in FY20 to 16.6 per cent in FY25, Page's own five-year revenue CAGR which peaked at 19 per cent before these brands existed has settled into the 9-11 per cent band and stayed there. The timing is not coincidental. The growth rate step-down tracks almost precisely with the years the challengers crossed meaningful scale.

The premium urban upgrade is now being split, and Page's CAGR is the evidence the split is structural.

WHAT IT HAS COST VIP

In luggage, the damage arrived faster and more bluntly. VIP's net profit swung from ₹152 crore (FY23) to a loss of ₹69 crore (FY25). Revenue fell even as India's travel market recovered strongly.

The consumer who was supposed to graduate into VIP's premium Carlton range, instead, searched 'Mokobara' on Instagram. That consumer was never counted in VIP's churn data and they were never VIP's customer to begin with. They show up instead on Mokobara's revenue line, which went from ₹53 crore in FY23 to ₹230 crore in FY25. That is where the missing growth went.

The D2C share of VIP and Safari's combined revenue has risen from 2.7 per cent in FY20 to 13.2 per cent in FY25 and the rate of gain is accelerating, not flattening (Chart 2). The CAGR panel tells the same structural story as Page's: VIP and Safari's combined five-year revenue CAGR ran at 14-16 per cent before the D2C brands were a meaningful force, and has settled in the 10 per cent band since the cohort began scaling seriously in FY23. The thesis is real but still being validated at scale.

Safari's gains came from taking share from VIP in the economy and mid-market segment, not from competing in the premium tier. Safari's stock, which peaked at about ₹3,100 in early 2024, has corrected to about ₹1,530. The D2C brands are not Safari's present problem. They are its approaching one.

THE QUIET REROUTING

The incumbents have not been passive. VIP has launched premium sub-brands and upgraded its manufacturing. These are the right responses. They are also reactive ones, made after the D2C brands spent five years defining what premium looks like for a new generation of consumers. Jockey and VIP are now adapting to a product and brand language they did not write.

There is a more fundamental challenge that no strategic response fully resolves. Jockey means every man's innerwear. VIP means every traveller's luggage. That breadth is an enormous asset in tier-2 and tier-3 India, where the upgrade itself remains the aspiration. But in the premium urban segment, the highest-value, fastest-growing, most-visible slice of the market, breadth is a liability. A brand that means everything to everyone means nothing to the consumer who wants something that says something specific about them. That gap is what the D2C brands walked into, and widening it is precisely what their combined $180 million in venture funding is designed to do.

Page Industries will remain India's dominant innerwear brand. Jockey is a category synonym in hundreds of millions of households, and no D2C challenger is within a decade of matching that scale. VIP and Safari will continue selling luggage to the vast majority of Indian travellers. None of this is existential.

But the markets that priced Page at 100x earnings and VIP as a compounder were not pricing those businesses. They were pricing the growth increment, which was the aspirational premium urban consumer who was supposed to graduate to these brands as incomes rose.

That consumer, it turns out, has options now. Ten+ credible ones in innerwear. Five+ in luggage. More arriving every year.

The Greeks who hid inside the wooden horse did not need to outnumber Troy's army. They did not need to breach its walls. They only needed to get inside and they needed the Trojans to be the ones who opened the gates.

That is what has happened here. Page and VIP built formidable businesses with real walls, real moats, real scale. But the D2C brands did not try to breach those walls. They arrived on a platform the incumbents did not control, in a language they did not speak, offering a story they had never thought to tell. And the consumer they were counting on wheeled them in.

Troy's walls still stood the morning after it fell. They just no longer mattered. The question for investors is not whether Page and VIP will survive. They will. The question is whether the walls they built still protect the growth the market is paying for. Or whether the horse is already inside.

In understanding these factors lie answers to how today's giants across sectors will fare as the rules of the game change.

Balaji Vaidyanath is the Head of NAFA Asset Managers and Abinash Swamenathan heads its research

India's D2C innerwear cohort — Table 1

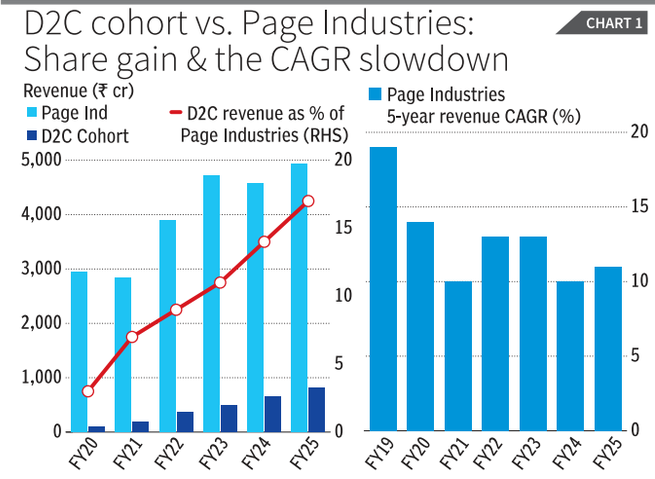
Brand	Founded	FY25 Revenue (₹ cr)	Funding ($ million)	What they offer that Jockey doesn't
XYXX	2017	187	8.8	MicroModal fabric, 46% revenue CAGR, 18,000+ touchpoints
DaMENSCH	2018	118	30.3	Named fabric tech, sustainability story, A91 + Matrix backed
Technosport	2015	448	32.4	Performance activewear: UV-protection, moisture-wicking, anti-microbial
FREECULTR	2019	20	18.4	Bamboo & organic cotton, Sixth Sense Ventures-backed
bummer	2020	11	1.8	Bold Gen-Z design, MicroModal, Shark Tank India viral moment
Heelium	2017	36	58 K	Bamboo-first
COHORT TOTAL	–	820	122+	Built in 7 years what took Jockey two decades in the premium urban segment

India's D2C Luggage Cohort — Table 2

Brand	Founded	FY25 Revenue (₹ cr)	Funding ($ million)	What they offer that VIP doesn't
Mokobara	2020	230	24.1	Built-in chargers, silent wheels, compression systems. Peak XV-backed.
uppercase	2021	83	19.9	100% Made-in-India, GRS-certified recycled plastic. Accel-backed. NY Fashion Week 2025.
Nasher Miles	2017	144	5.9	Shark Tank India. Hardside + softside, quick commerce expansion.
EUME	2020	30	5.2	Premium hard luggage, design-led.
Assembly	2019	35	2.5	Modular, customisable luggage for young frequent flyers.
COHORT TOTAL	–	522	57+	Built from zero in under 6 years in the ₹8,000–20,000 premium segment

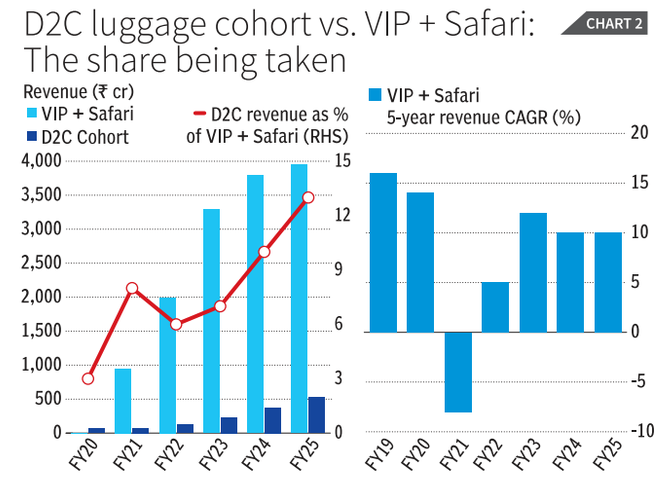
Source: NAFA Asset Managers

D2C cohort vs. Page Industries: Share gain & the CAGR slowdown — CHART 1



Source: NAFA Asset Managers, Page Industries annual results, RoC filings. D2C Cohort: XYXX, DaMENSCH, Technosport, FREECULTR, bummer, Heelium

D2C luggage cohort vs. VIP + Safari: The share being taken — CHART 2



Source: NAFA Asset Managers, RoC filings. Cohort: Mokobara, uppercase, Nasher Miles, EUME, Assembly. VIP and Safari revenues from published annual results

INSURANCE QUERY.

VINEET GUPTA

I'm 35 and my spouse and I are considering assisted reproductive treatment. We do not have fertility coverage currently. If we purchase a comprehensive health insurance policy now, will it cover IVF or related procedures after waiting periods? Or are fertility treatments typically excluded regardless of policy duration?

Kiran Sharma

GETTY IMAGES

It is important to understand how health insurance aligns with fertility planning, both in terms of coverage and limitations. In India, most standard comprehensive health insurance policies do not cover IVF or other assisted reproductive treatments. These procedures are typically categorised as elective or planned interventions and therefore remain permanently excluded unless explicitly included within the policy.

This means that simply purchasing a comprehensive plan today will not automatically make IVF expenses eligible for reimbursement in the future.

That said, the insurance landscape is gradually evolving. A few insurers have begun offering specialised plans or add-on covers that include fertility-related benefits. However, such offerings are still limited and come with clearly defined conditions. These may include waiting periods, typically ranging from two to three years and sub-limits on the amount payable per IVF cycle, and eligibility criteria linked to age or medical history.

Given that fertility treatments can be expensive and often require multiple attempts, it is equally important to plan beyond insurance. Building a dedicated financial buffer or exploring structured financing options can help manage these costs more effectively.

Before finalising any policy, it is advisable to carefully review:

* Whether infertility treatments are explicitly included or excluded
* Applicable waiting periods and eligibility criteria
* Coverage for unsuccessful IVF cycles
* Sub-limits or caps on the benefits

The author is Head, Product Development, ManipalCigna Health Insurance

ALERTS.

Federal Bank to acquire StanChart India credit card portfolio

Federal Bank will acquire a select Standard Chartered Bank India credit card portfolio comprising 4.5 lakh cards, a move that could shift many StanChart card-only customers to Federal Bank. Federal Bank said it is committed to ensuring a "seamless and uninterrupted transition" while giving customers access to its full suite of products and services. The portfolio is concentrated in large urban markets, with about 75 per cent of the acquired card base in India's top eight cities. Federal Bank said the acquisition will expand its credit card base and deepen its presence in tier-1 cities.

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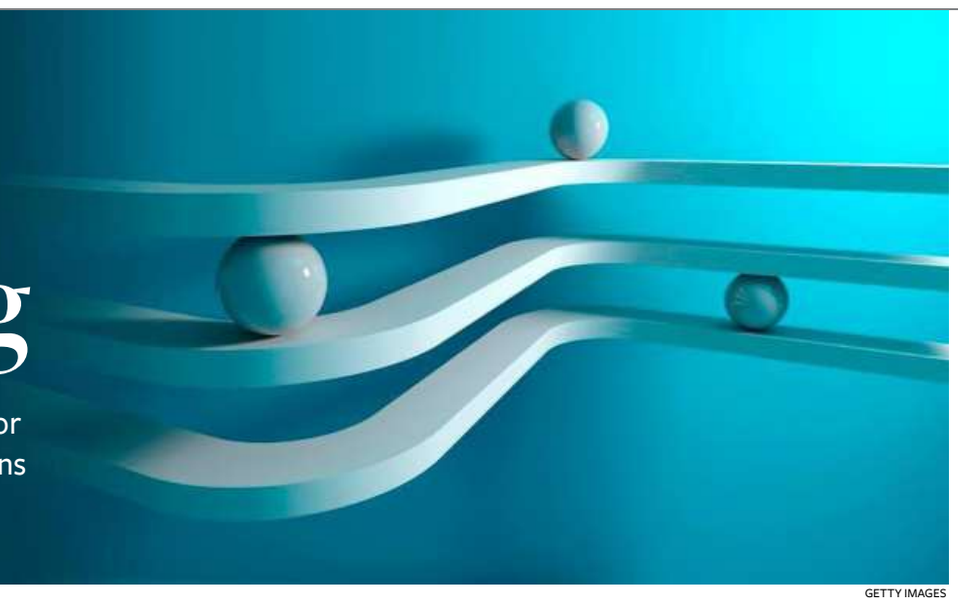
Calm capital compounding

FUND CALL. HDFC Equity Savings Fund is suited for cautious investors, retirees seeking lower drawdowns



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Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

HDFC Equity Savings Fund (HESF) has been upgraded to a four-star rating in the latest edition of the bl.portfolio MF Star Track Ratings, after holding a three-star rating over the previous two years. The upgrade reflects a marked improvement in its risk-adjusted performance within the category. It currently manages assets of Rs 5,576 crore as of March 2026.

Positioned within the equity savings segment, HESF offers a relatively tax-efficient avenue for investors with a low-to-moderate risk appetite. Funds in this hybrid category typically split their portfolios into roughly 30–35 per cent each across equities, arbitrage positions, and debt. With arbitrage and equity together accounting for over 65 per cent exposure to equity instruments, these funds qualify for favourable equity taxation. This in turn makes them appealing to conservative investors seeking returns superior to fixed income without taking on significant market risk.

EQUITY STRATEGY

HESF allocates broadly equally across equity, arbitrage, and debt over most time frames. On the equity side, the fund maintains a fairly stable allocation, typically within a narrow band of 35–40 per cent. However, tactical adjustments are made when valuations appear stretched or unusually attractive. For instance, between June and October 2024, when market valuations were considered expensive, the fund reduced equity exposure to about 30–32 per cent before increasing it again to around 35–37 per cent following a market correction.

Stock selection is primarily driven by a bottom-up approach, with a focus on earnings growth and reasonable valuations. The equity portfolio is predominantly large-cap oriented. Over the last five years, large-cap allocation within the equity portion has ranged between 83 and 93 per cent. As per the latest overall portfolio, allocation to large-, mid-, and small-cap stocks stood at 59 per cent, 3 per cent, and 4 per cent respectively as of March 2026. Sector allocations are dynamic. Currently, the fund has relatively higher exposure to financials, consumer discretionary, and select healthcare segments, while materials, energy, and staples remain relatively underweight. The top three sectors as of March 2026 were banks (16 per cent), petroleum products (6 per cent), and pharma (6 per cent). Over the past year, the fund increased allocation to pharma, power, and construction by over one percentage point each, while reducing exposure to IT, banks, and beverages by 1–2 percentage points.

ARBITRAGE STRATEGY

The arbitrage component plays a stabilising role in the portfolio, providing relatively low-risk returns while helping maintain the equity-oriented tax structure. Arbitrage exposure is typically maintained in the 21–33 per cent range.. The strategy focusses on capturing price differentials between cash and derivatives markets, with most opportunities arising at the stock level rather than the index level.

DEBT STRATEGY

Flexibility in debt allocation is limited by the need to retain equity taxation benefits, and allocation generally remains within the 25–35 per cent range. The debt portfolio is managed like a short-duration fund, with Macaulay duration ranging between 2 and 3.4 years over the past three years. It is largely invested in high-quality instruments, with a strong preference for AAA-rated corporate bonds, while a smaller portion is allocated to government securities to support arbitrage margin requirements. As per the current portfolio, about 12 per cent is invested in AAA-rated corporate bonds and around 2.5 per cent in AA+ rated bonds, including Cholamandalam Investment & Finance and Muthoot Finance. As of March 2026, the fund's debt portfolio reported a yield to maturity of 7.3 per cent, compared with the category average of 7.1 per cent.

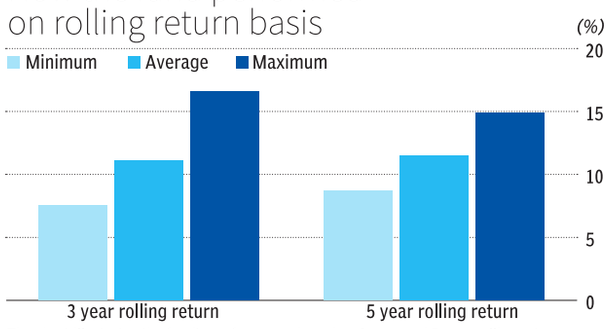
PERFORMANCE

Recent outperformance was supported by timely sector allocation, with strong contributions from select industrials, fertilisers, and metals, including Hindalco Industries, Kalpataru Projects International, Paradeep Phosphates, and Tata Steel. Five-year rolling returns over the past seven years show that the fund delivered an average annual return of 11.5 per cent, outperforming the category average of 10 per cent. The five-year return range has varied between 8.7 per cent and 14.9 per cent. The fund also demonstrated decent performance in three-year rolling returns, delivering an 11 per cent CAGR compared with the category average of 9.6 per cent.

From a cost perspective, the regular plan has an expense ratio of 1.89 per cent, slightly higher than the category average of 1.8 per cent. The direct plan's expense ratio stands at 0.95 per cent, above the category average of 0.8 per cent.

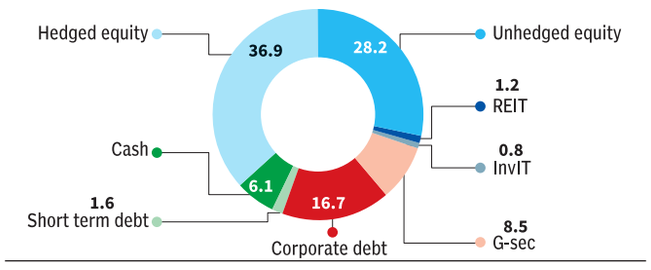
This fund is suited for cautious investors, retirees seeking lower drawdowns, and those looking to park surplus funds for two to four years while benefiting from equity taxation.

How the fund performed on rolling return basis



The chart illustrates the fund's performance based on 3-year and 5-year rolling returns calculated from the last 7 year NAV history, highlighting the minimum, average, and maximum returns achieved over these periods.

Portfolio asset class break-up (%)



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WHY INVEST

- Almost equal allocations in equity, debt & arbitrage
- Large-cap oriented equity portfolio
- Short-duration debt portfolio

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Apr 30	Returns (% CAGR) 3-year	5-year	10-year	Assets (₹ cr)
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	53.4	13.7	13.1	13.9	69,293
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.8	14.8	13.9	13.6	25,125
Kotak Pension Fund	66.4	14.3	13.7	13.5	4,151
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.5	6.4	5.8	8.3	8,421
SBI Pension Fund	40.9	6.5	5.8	7.7	27,519
HDFC Pension Fund	27.9	6.0	5.5	7.6	50,159
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.1	7.7	6.8	8.2	33,108
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.3	7.6	6.6	8.0	13,143
SBI Pension Fund	45.4	7.5	6.5	8.0	14,868
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	46.1	13.7	13.1	13.9	1,673
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.5	14.6	13.9	13.6	700
Kotak Pension Fund	58.4	14.2	13.7	13.4	202

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on April 30, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR) 1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	-5.0	16.2	18.5
ICICI Pru	Largecap	768	-1.3	17.7	16.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	-1.5	16.6	14.0
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-8.2	11.7	13.6
MULTI CAP					
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	108	11.2	29.8	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	106	2.0	28.4	23.6
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	971	8.5	24.2	22.6
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	8,689	6.0	21.0	22.0
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	5,833	-2.6	31.5	21.6
Negen Capital Services	Special Situ & Tech Strategy	1,133	-2.1	24.3	21.4
MID-CAP					
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	312	2.0	13.0	15.9
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-5.3	13.3	15.9
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	-4.1	13.6	15.5
Nippon Life India Asset Mgmt	Emerging India	NA	0.1	17.4	14.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,788	43.5	45.5	44.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	712	-14.0	17.7	33.6
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,046	-19.5	28.3	22.9
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	-4.4	25.6	21.0

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on March 31, 2026

After flying high, turbulence hits SIP returns unevenly

CAP-WISE. Active large-cap funds lagged among categories from Sept 2024 peak, while mid-cap funds led performance amid volatile equity market conditions

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

From its last peak on 26 September 2024 to 30 April 2026, the Indian equity market has moved through a volatile, largely range-bound phase, marked by sharp corrections and brief recoveries.

The phase was shaped by multiple global headwinds, including tariff wars, sticky inflation and risk-off sentiment amid geopolitical tensions including US-Israel-Iran war.

Persistent foreign portfolio investor (FPI) outflows weighed on large-cap stocks, while steady domestic institutional inflows provided partial support, preventing deeper market declines.

Equity mutual funds followed suit, with many schemes across categories correcting more than their respective benchmarks, while a few showed resilience.

bl.portfolio computed SIP performance for this 19-month period across major equity categories to identify the top and bottom five schemes.

SIP returns shown here are in XIRR (extended internal rate of return), the annualised return that accounts for the timing and amount of each installment.

Stock holdings of top- and bottom-performing schemes in each category were analysed too on a point-to-point return basis, tracking their performance between September 30, 2024 and April 30, 2026. Sectors and stocks that drove or dragged returns were identified henceforth.

It is important to mention that despite market volatility, SIP collections have remained robust in recent months, underscoring the resilience of retail investor flows and the growing stickiness of systematic investing.

LARGE-CAP

The active large-cap category was the weakest among market-cap-based segments during this period. On average, it delivered an XIRR of -1.3 per cent, while the benchmark Nifty 100 TRI declined a relatively modest 0.5 per cent.

Bank of India Large Cap Fund, with an XIRR of 4.3 per cent, emerged as the top performer, aided by strong exposure to PSU banks, capital goods, defence and metals. Stocks such as TD Power Systems (174 per cent), SBI (35 per cent) and Tata Steel (25 per cent) were key contributors. Despite weakness in IT (Infosys, TCS) and FMCG, exposure to infrastructure and manufacturing themes aided performance.

In contrast, LIC MF Large Cap (-5 per cent) lagged peers due to underperforming large-cap defensives and IT.

Major drags included ITC (-39 per cent), Infosys (-37 per cent), TCS (-42 per cent) and HUL (-23 per cent).

While some names such as SBI and BEL performed strongly, exposure to HDFC Bank and Kotak Bank led to muted returns.

MID-CAP

Mid-cap funds outperformed other categories, delivering 5.6 per cent XIRR. This compares to 7.7 per cent from their benchmark Nifty Midcap 150 TRI.

Despite volatility, the segment benefitted from strength in industrial and capex-linked mid-sized stocks.

ICICI Prudential Midcap (17 per cent XIRR) stood out, driven by exposure to capital goods, industrials, capital markets and select financials.

Key contributors included Multi Commodity Exchange (162 per cent), Hitachi Energy (130 per cent), Nalco (89 per cent) and Navin Fluorine (98 per cent).

Financials such as Muthoot Finance (68 per cent) and Nippon Life AMC (55 per cent) added alpha. Importantly, avoidance of weak pockets such as IT enhanced relative performance.

Motilal Oswal Midcap lagged others due to concentrated exposure to retail and consumption names such as Trent (-45 per cent), Prestige Estates (-23 per cent) and Tube Investments (-32 per cent).

SMALL-CAP

The small-cap category delivered 3.9 per cent XIRR, compared to 2.2 per cent from the Nifty Smallcap 250 TRI.

Union Small Cap topped the category with 11.7 per cent XIRR, driven by outsized gains from stocks such as MCX (162 per cent), GE Vernova (167 per cent), Gabriel India (98 per cent), SJS Enterprises (80 per cent) and Karur Vysya Bank (64 per cent). Unlike peers, it avoided heavy exposure to consumption and chemicals.

Tata Small Cap lagged, as key drags came from sharp declines in transport and logistics (Allcargo Logistics -85 per cent, Transindia Real Estate -38 per cent), retail (Shoppers Stop -62 per cent) and commercial services (Quess Corp -74 per cent).

Chemicals and pharma exposure (BASF -50 per cent, Cohance -58 per cent, Hikal -48 per cent) also suffered.

LARGE & MID-CAP

The large and mid-cap category delivered 2.3 per cent XIRR, versus 3.6 per cent from the Nifty LargeMidcap 250 TRI.

Motilal Oswal Large & Midcap topped the category. Outperformance was driven by concentrated bets in high-growth sectors such as capital markets, defence and electrical equipment.

Stocks such as MCX (162 per cent), GE Vernova T&D (167 per cent), Bharat Electronics (51 per cent) and Amber Enterprises (66 per cent) delivered strong gains.

Tata Large & Mid Cap lagged due to sharp declines in Quess Corp (-74 per cent), Devyani International (-36 per cent), Gujarat State Petronet (-32 per cent) and Sundram Fasteners (-38 per cent), which weighed heavily.

The fund also had exposure to lagging sectors such as IT, consumption and chemicals, while participation in outperforming themes such as capital goods and PSU plays was limited.

FLEXI-CAP

The flexi-cap category delivered -0.1 per cent XIRR, while the Nifty 500 TRI gained 1.3 per cent.

Quant Flexi Cap topped the category. Key contributors included Adani Power (69 per cent) and infrastructure-linked names such as L&T. Its dynamic allocation across power, autos and capital markets, along with concentrated bets, helped it capture market upcycles.

UTI Flexi Cap was the laggard. Underperformance was driven by sharp drawdowns in consumption, chemicals and healthcare stocks. Holdings such as Cohance Lifesciences (-58 per cent), Syngene (-47 per cent), Rossari Biotech (-47 per cent) and Clean Science (-48 per cent) dragged returns. IT exposure (Infosys, Coforge) added to the weakness.

MULTI-CAP

The multi-cap category delivered 1.9 per cent XIRR, compared to 2.4 per cent from the Nifty 500 Multicap 50:25:25 TRI.

Bank of India Multi Cap led the category, benefiting from exposure to metals, PSU banks, autos and capital market stocks.

Key gainers included Acutaas Chemicals (198 per cent), Indian Bank (63 per cent), FSN E-Commerce (35 per cent) and Shriram Finance (31 per cent).

Invesco India Multicap lagged, as underperformance was driven by weakness in retail, IT and industrial cyclicals.

Stocks such as Trent (-45 per cent), Aditya Birla Real Estate (-47 per cent), Jyoti CNC (-34 per cent) and Coforge (-14 per cent) were key drags.

CHALLENGES

The phase was shaped by multiple global headwinds, including tariff wars, sticky inflation and risk-off sentiment amid geopolitical tensions including US-Israel-Iran war

How equity MF SIPs performed in the current volatile phase

Scheme name	SIP return (XIRR %)	Lump sum return (CAGR %)
Large-cap		
Top 5		
Bank of India Large Cap	4.3	-3.0
Quant Large Cap	2.2	-5.8
Taurus Large Cap	1.4	-3.6
Tata Large Cap	0.9	-3.9
SBI Large Cap	0.8	-3.2
Bottom 5		
LIC MF Large Cap	-5.0	-7.6
UTI Large Cap	-4.3	-6.7
Axis Large Cap	-3.9	-6.6
Sundaram Large Cap	-3.8	-6.8
Mahindra Manulife Large Cap	-3.6	-5.9
Benchmark: Nifty 100	**-0.5**	**-4.6**
Mid-cap		
Top 5		
ICICI Pru Midcap	16.9	5.4
HSBC Midcap	14.7	2.5
WOC Mid Cap	9.7	3.1
Nippon India Growth Mid Cap	9.5	0.8
Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	9.2	0.1
Bottom 5		
Motilal Oswal Midcap	-8.6	-9.5
Taurus Mid Cap	-0.8	-7.3
Franklin India Mid Cap	0.3	-4.0
PGIM India Midcap	1.1	-4.5
LIC MF Midcap	1.9	-5.1
Benchmark: Nifty Midcap 150	**7.7**	**-0.5**
Small-cap		
Top 5		
Union Small Cap	11.7	1.5
Bank of India Small Cap	9.7	-2.2
DSP Small Cap	8.5	-0.2
Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	7.6	-2.5
Sundaram Small Cap	7.4	-0.4
Bottom 5		
Tata Small Cap	-9.8	-13.0
Kotak Small Cap	-1.5	-8.8
HDFC Small Cap	-1.4	-4.7
JM Small Cap	0.1	-7.0
SBI Small Cap	0.4	-6.5
Benchmark: Nifty Smallcap 250	**2.2**	**-5.5**

Scheme Name	SIP return (XIRR %)	Lump sum return (CAGR %)
Large- & Mid-cap		
Top 5		
Motilal Os Large & Midcap	8.8	0.5
HSBC Large & Mid Cap	8.1	-1.3
Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	6.3	-1.1
BOI Large & Mid Cap	4.8	-2.3
Invesco In Large & Mid Cap	4.6	-0.7
Bottom 5		
Tata Large & Mid Cap	-5.9	-9.2
LIC MF Large & Midcap	-2.5	-5.8
Canara Rob Large and Mid Cap	-1.4	-5.6
Franklin India Large & Mid Cap	-1.4	-5.2
Baroda BNPP Large & Mid Cap	-1.0	-5.9
Benchmark: Nifty LargeMidcap 250	**3.6**	**-2.5**
Multi-cap		
Top 5		
Bank of India Multi Cap	8.3	0.4
ICICI Pru Multicap	7.0	-1.3
ITI Multi-Cap	5.6	-3.2
Mahindra Manulife Multi Cap	5.5	-1.6
Kotak Multicap	5.3	-1.6
Bottom 5		
Invesco India Multicap	-5.5	-8.9
Motilal Oswal Multi Cap	-4.4	-1.9
HDFC Multi Cap	-1.3	-6.1
DSP Multicap	-0.9	-6.2
Sundaram Multi Cap	-0.5	-4.8
Benchmark: Nifty500 Multi 50:25:25	**2.4**	**-3.6**
Flexi-cap		
Top 5		
Quant Flexi Cap	8.9	-5.5
Bank of India Flexi Cap	7.7	-1.4
Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	4.8	-1.0
Navi Flexi Cap	4.4	-3.3
Bajaj Finserv Flexi Cap	4.3	-1.2
Bottom 5		
UTI Flexi Cap	-7.9	-8.6
NJ Flexi Cap	-6.9	-13.5
Samco Flexi Cap	-6.2	-14.5
Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	-6.0	-7.8
Shriram Flexi Cap	-5.5	-11.5
Benchmark: Nifty 500	**1.3**	**-3.9**

Schemes in each category are sorted based on SIP performance; *SIP returns (XIRR) are based on investments made on the 26th of each month between September 26, 2024 and April 30, 2026; Total return variant (TRI) is considered for benchmark returns; Lump-sum returns (CAGR) are calculated for the period between September 26, 2024 and April 30, 2026. Source: ACEMF

Wait for the fog to clear first!

IPO WATCH. OnEMI Technology Solutions is a digital lender at a fair price but wait for clarity on credit-cycle resilience

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

The IPO of digital lending fintech OnEMI Technology Solutions (OTS), better known by its 'Kissht' brand, is open for subscription until May 5. It is a ₹926-crore issue, split between a fresh issue of ₹850 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) of shares worth ₹76 crore. The fresh issue proceeds are meant to augment the capital base of its NBFC subsidiary 'Si Creva Capital Services' by ₹638 crore and the rest for general corporate purposes. A clutch of investor shareholders is set to offload partial stakes in the OFS. Promoters' stake falls to 23.3 per cent from 32.3 per cent before the IPO, on a fully-diluted basis.

Disbursing unsecured personal loans through the interface of a mobile app, OTS has built a scalable business model, and its numbers do paint a healthy financial position.

At ₹171 per share, the IPO values OTS at 1.4x post-issue book value. The RHP lists diversified NBFCs such as Bajaj Finance, Cholamandalam Investment & Finance and HDB Financial Services and SBI Cards & Payment Services (SBI Cards) as its peers. However, SBI Cards comes across as the closest peer, as 94 per cent of OTS' AUM is personal loans.

In FY26, SBI Cards delivered an RoA of 3.2 per cent and trades at 3.9x its book value. OTS' RoA, on the other hand, is 8.5 per cent (annualised) for 9M FY26. However, OTS' RoAUM (return on AUM) is the more pertinent measure here, as its business/ AUM is not just confined to loans on the balance sheet (on-book AUM) but also includes off-book exposure (off-book AUM). On-book and off-book loans share the over-₹6,000-croreAUM in a 51:49 ratio. RoAUM for 9M FY26 (annualised) works out to 5.3 per cent — making the valuation appear more than justified on a relative basis.

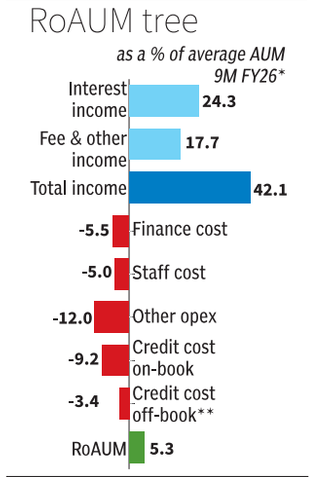
GETTY IMAGES

Financial snapshot

	FY23	FY24	FY25	9M FY26
AUM (₹ crore)	1,268	2,604	4,087	5,956
Customers served (lakh)	64	82	92	112
On-book:Off-book ratio (%)	36:64	57:43	61:39	51:49
Gross NPA ratio (%)	0.1	0.8	2.9	2.9
Average lending rate (%)	29.5	24.2	31.9	30.7
Average cost of borrowing (%)	21.3	11.7	14.4	15.4
Net interest margin (%)	18.6	16.8	23.8	21.2
RoA (%)	3.3	12.9	7.1	8.5
RoAUM (%)	-	10.2	4.8	5.3

In FY25, the company decided to advance longer tenor loans. Average tenor rose to 9.7 months from 2.9 months in FY24. Disbursements fell 47 per cent and impacted fee income. Hence FY24 and FY25 are not comparable Source: RHP

RoAUM tree



*annualised **includes FLDG cost
Source: IPO documents

IPO rating

OnEMI Technology Solutions

Business	★★½☆☆
Financials	★★★☆☆
Management	★★★☆☆
Valuation	★★★☆☆
Overall	★★½☆☆

Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest

Offer period	Apr 30 - May 5, 2026
Price band	₹162-171
Market cap	approx. ₹2,900 cr

First, the average lending rate is high — over 30 per cent. This is higher than CreditAccess Grameen's (leading microfinance player) 21 per cent.. While borrowers do avail such personal loans for the app-based convenience, it is difficult to eliminate the possibility that their not-so-healthy finances might have made them ineligible to avail loans from banks or larger NBFCs — where interest rates are relatively lower. Cases where a borrower might have multiple loans outstanding cannot be ruled out too. As an investor, one can never be more wary of this than now, with a stagflation-like scenario looming as the scramble for energy persists. El-Nino and lower-than-average rainfall expected further compound the risk.

To its credit, OTS does have robust risk models and its current asset-quality metrics do not suggest a crisis. Gross NPA ratio of 2.9 per cent is comparable with SBI Cards' 2.4 per cent. However, given its small footprint and the short track record presented in the RHP, we are unable to reliably conclude whether OTS' models can lead the company successfully through credit downcycles.

While it cannot be generalised, it is nevertheless worth noting that there is hardly a case of lending businesses charging hefty interest rates and, at the same time, successfully manoeuvring through credit cycles in India. The underwhelming returns since IPOs for microfinance companies and SBI Cards serve as cautionary examples.

Second, the company has some moving parts currently. Besides personal loans, OTS has started offering LAP (loan against property) since Q4 FY24, which is essentially a mortgage. LAP now constitutes the remaining 6 per cent of the AUM. Unlike personal loans which can be end-to-end managed from a central location — from sourcing to underwriting and collection, LAP needs physical presence to verify the collateral. OTS has expanded its physical presence to 82 branches now and it is reasonable to expect it to scale this business in the coming years.

That said, this addition of a secured product changes how the RoAUM model would look like a few years from now. For instance, LAP carries relatively low interest rates and entails higher opex, offsetting the operating leverage of personal loans and bringing RoAUM down. At the same time though, it carries lower credit cost (provisions, write-offs), thus making up for the above to an extent. The company could also leverage its branches to add other products such as gold loans later on, making it further difficult to model for. With little clarity as to how the portfolio mix would be in the future, investors can wait for more clarity.

BUSINESS AND STRENGTHS

OTS operates in a crowded yet fast growing new-age/ digital lending market, which is projected to grow from about ₹60,000 crore as of FY25 to about ₹4.1 lakh crore by FY30, at a CAGR of 48 per cent (per a 1Lattice report in the RHP). With an AUM of just about ₹6,000 crore, it has good headroom for growth. A debt-to-equity ratio of 1.6x (mature firms generally operate at 4-5x) and a capital adequacy ratio or CRAR (pre-IPO) of 27 per cent (regulatory requirement of 15 per cent) should support growth. Fresh issue proceeds will take CRAR even higher.

It sources prospective customers via digital marketing (46 per cent), partnership with merchants and e-commerce platforms/ aggregators (30 per cent) and the rest organically (24 per cent). A turnaround time under 10 minutes for 85 per cent of new users and under six minutes for 90 per cent of repeat users is a key USP of this company. The average ticket-size of the loans ranges between ₹25,000 and ₹30,000, and the average tenor at around 10 months.

OFF-BOOK BUSINESS

In its off-book business, OTS sources prospective borrowers for its lending partners (other NBFCs) to underwrite. It also manages loans that are so underwritten, including collection, on behalf of its partners — thus earning fee income.

OTS does two kinds of off-book arrangements. In the first, the entire loan is underwritten by the partner, and this constitutes two-thirds of the off-book AUM. In the second, OTS underwrites a fixed portion of the loan (say, 20 per cent) and the rest by the partner (this 20 per cent reflects on OTS' balance sheet). The company is also regulatorily required to guarantee up to 5 per cent of the off-book loan amount, to indemnify its partner in case the borrower defaults — called FLDG (first loss default guarantee).

Sail on the steel turnaround

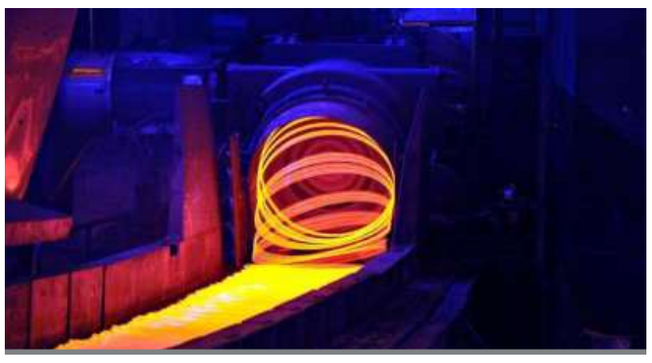
STEEL. While SAIL is trading at a 15-year high, today it trades at a price/book of 1.3 times vs 2.25 times in December 2010

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

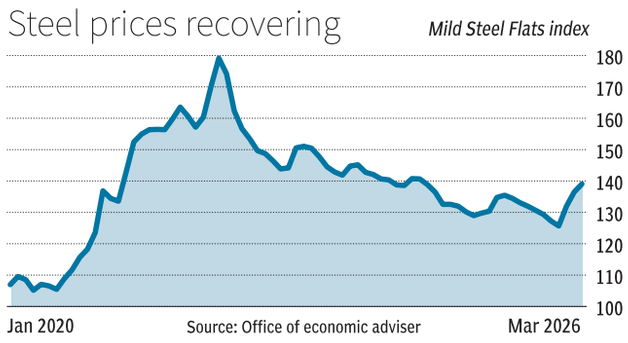
In October 2025, we had recommended investors hold the stock of Steel Authority of India Ltd (SAIL), a PSU manufacturer of steel with a capacity of around 20 million tonnes per annum (mtpa).

The recommendation followed the stock delivering 50 per cent returns from an earlier Buy recommendation in January 2023, and as benefits of raw material cost savings were running out. Since then, the stock has delivered better than our expectations and returned 42 per cent from October 2025, including the 25 per cent gains in the year to date (YTD). The stock's YTD performance is above the 14 per cent gains by Nifty Metals Index and in stark contrast to Nifty 50's 8 per cent decline.

The steel price rebound, compared to the decline in the last three years, and the inherent operational leverage of the steel industry have aided such performance. With SAIL's control on operating costs along with higher steel prices, the earnings growth in the next three years should be stronger. The stock is trading at 7.7 times one-year forward EV/EBITDA, which is a 42 per cent premium to the last five-year average. Peers Jindal Steel, JSW Steel and Tata Steel are trading at 9.6/10/8 times on the same metric, which is an average 36 per cent premium to their respective last five-year averages. The valuation premium can be attributed to the revival in steel prices and valuation at the beginning of an upcycle. Bloomberg consensus estimates a 45 per cent EPS CAGR over FY25-27 for SAIL. We now recommend investors accumulate the stock on any dips in the volatile macro-environment to gain a cushion from the premium valuations. High-risk investors can consider the stock in anticipation of a turnaround in steel prices. The SAIL stock is now trading at 15-year high. But investors can take solace from the current price to book value of 1.3 times compared to 2.25 times in December-2010 when it reached similar levels.

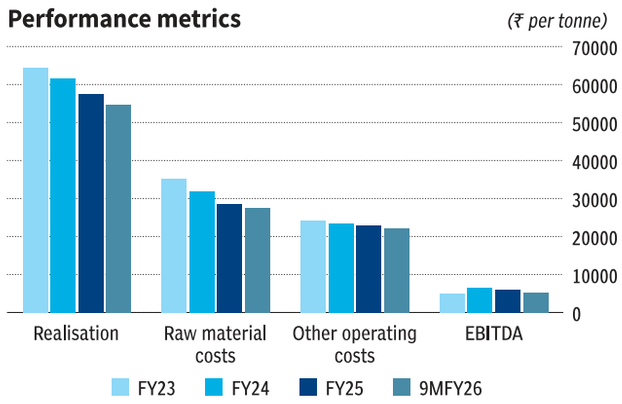


Steel prices recovering



Source: Office of economic adviser

Performance metrics



STEEL PRICE RECOVERY

Steel prices have been in decline in the last four years. SAIL net realisations have declined 4.7 per cent CAGR in FY23-9MFY26. This has been attributed to low-cost imports from China, which is the largest steel producer accounting for more than half of the global production.

But the spot metal prices (steel flats wholesale price index) have increased 11.2 per cent from December 2025 to March 2026. This recovery can be attributed to safeguard duties and steel input prices, apart from robust demand.

ACCUMULATE
SAIL ₹184.70

WHY
- Improved steel prices
- Operational efficiency
- Capacity addition on cards

The Indian government imposed a three-year safeguard duty of 12 per cent on steel imports from China and Vietnam. After an initial 200-day imposition in April 2025, the same duty was extended to three years in December 2025. This has supported steel prices this year and is expected to last till safeguard duties remain in place. Domestic steel demand has grown at 7 per cent year on year in 9MFY26 and if the demand persists, it should support steel price recovery.

INPUT COSTS MIXED

Coking coal, which is the primary raw material apart from iron ore, is also on an inflationary path recently and has partly supported the recovery in steel prices. The raw material cost per tonne for SAIL has declined 8.5 per cent CAGR in FY23-9MFY26. But coking coal costs are on the rise from mid-2025 after couple of years of correction. The current conflict has driven the shipping costs of Australian coking coal higher, thereby driving prices.

The other operating costs of employees and other expenses have also declined 3 per cent CAGR in FY23-9MFY26, driven by cost efficiency measures. SAIL sales volume adjusted for NMDC steel sales of 1 mtpa (SAIL has an agreement with NMDC to sell its steel output), have grown at 7.4 per cent CAGR in FY23-9MFY26. The company is undertaking debottlenecking and adding steel bar facility of 1 mtpa (5 per cent capacity addition) that should support further capacity expansion.

OPERATING LEVERAGE

Despite increasing raw material costs, SAIL can sustain high profit growth assuming steel prices recover and other costs are controlled. Assuming a 10 per cent CAGR in revenue in the next two years, driven in equal parts by volume and price (spot prices have already grown 11 per cent) and a 350-bps decline in gross margins from 50 per cent to 46.5 per cent due to higher input costs, SAIL can deliver 20 per cent CAGR in PAT growth in the next two years. The other operating costs, which have declined 3 per cent CAGR in the last two years, are expected to rise but slower than revenue growth, at 5 per cent CAGR for operating costs for the next two years, which allows the operating leverage to play out.

DEBT AND CAPACITY EXPANSION

SAIL has reported net debt to EBITDA of 3 times in Q2FY26, which is lower than 3.8 times reported in Q2FY25, as the company is repaying debt and controlling finance costs. But in the next two years, the debt should increase, as the company will undertake ₹15,000-crore capex in FY27 (supported by internal cash and debt equally). The company will add 4 mtpa (25 per cent addition to current capacity) to IISCO steel plant, West Bengal, by FY30 at a total estimated cost of ₹36,000 crore.

The company reported revenue and PAT of ₹79,997 crore (9.3 per cent year-on-year growth) and ₹1,537 crore (37.2 per cent growth) in 9MFY26. With improved steel prices and controlled other operating costs, the company should generate higher revenue and profits in the next two years, which should support the expansion.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, 'what is your India plan?' is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. With the March quarter earnings season in progress, this column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. Here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

Amazon.com, Inc. (AMZN, m-cap of $2850.5 billion)
Amazon highlighted strong traction for its quick commerce offering in India.
"Amazon Now, our 30-minute delivery service, is seeing orders grow 25 per cent month-over-month in India, with Prime members tripling their shopping frequency, underscoring strong customer adoption."

The Coca-Cola Company (KO, $338.9 billion)
The global beverage giant highlighted India as a key long-term growth market, driven by localisation and brand engagement.
"We linked brands like Thums Up to major events such as the T20 Cricket World Cup and expanded Sprite into rural regions with localised content. India remains a market where our strong local portfolio enables deep consumer connection and long-term growth."

Hilton Worldwide Holdings Inc. (HLT, $73.8 billion)
The global hospitality company is accelerating expansion in India through large-scale partnerships and pipeline growth.
"We signed an agreement to open 125 Hampton hotels with Royal Orchid, putting us on track for over 400 hotels in India. We see the market as a 10x-20x growth opportunity over time."

CNH Industrial N.V. (CNH, $13.3 billion)
The global farm and construction equipment maker reported strong momentum in India, driven by new product launches and rising market share.
"India has reached record highs in production and market share, supported by our new compact tractor line-up. Upcoming launches will further strengthen India as a key hub for both domestic growth and global exports of small tractors."

Crown Holdings, Inc. (CCK, $10.9 billion)
The US packaging company sees strong structural growth in India's beverage can market and is scaling capacity to meet demand.
"India's can market is around 4-5 billion units and growing 15-20 per cent annually. We are increasing supply from South-East Asia in the near term and plan to add 2.2 billion units of capacity to support long-term demand."

NOV Inc. (NOV, $7.4 billion)
The oilfield equipment and services provider is leveraging India to improve operational efficiency through shared services.
"We established a global service centre in Kochi, India, as part of broader restructuring efforts, enabling shared services and process improvements to enhance operational efficiency."

Sensata Technologies Holding plc (ST, $6.1 billion)
The industrial technology firm highlighted India as a key growth driver in its automotive segment.
"We are significantly outgrowing vehicle production in India, with revenue from a key OEM more than doubling year-over-year, reflecting strong momentum in this fast-growing market."

AAK AB (publ.) (AAK, Skr68.7 billion)
The Swedish specialty oils and fats company is expanding into higher-value segments in India through targeted investments.
"We are investing in a pharma facility in India focused on non-active delivery systems, strengthening our position in higher value-added segments and building a platform for long-term growth."

Carlsberg A/S (CARLB, Dkr118.5 billion)
The Danish brewer said India continues to deliver strong growth while it evaluates strategic options for the business.
"India delivered double-digit volume growth, and we are exploring options to enhance shareholder value, including a potential IPO of our India business, although no decision has been made."

DWS Group GmbH & Co. KGaA (DWS, €11.8 billion)
The German asset manager is deepening its India presence through a strategic partnership in alternatives.
"We acquired a 40 per cent stake in Nippon Life India Asset Management's alternatives platform, a profitable €1-billion AUM business. Going forward, the focus will expand into infrastructure, real estate and private credit to tap India's large investment needs."

Andritz AG (ANDR, €7.1 billion)
The Austrian engineering group said India is a major source of growth, supported by its localised manufacturing presence.
"We are seeing very strong growth in India and gaining market share, supported by our fully-localised production capabilities for turbines and generators, which enhance our competitiveness."

Contributed by NAFA ASSET MANAGERS

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

1. I have been a leader in my business for more than 50 years, yet I remain a small-cap stock.
2. My corporate name still carries the identity of my association with a multi-billion dollar brand that's a global leader now.
3. My chairman, who is completing 30 years this year since joining the board, has impressive credentials, including a master's from IIT. His wife, a chartered accountant, also serves with him on the board.
4. The market has rewarded my shareholders with more than 15 per cent CAGR over both the last five and 10 years, reflecting my consistent growth without diluting the highest standards of corporate governance.
5. Despite this, aggregate institutional shareholding remains in single-digits. I am hopeful of attracting greater attention as the business gains scale from ongoing capacity expansion initiatives.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to **who-am-i@thehindu.co.in**, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week's stock: KRBL
Last week's winner: Shobha Sriram

BENGALURU
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - MAY 3 - 2026

Split signals

F&O TRACKER. Nifty structure steady; Nifty Bank may see more correction before seeing recovery

GETTY IMAGES

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,998) gained 0.4 per cent, whereas Nifty Bank (54,863) declined 2.2 per cent last week. The derivatives data of these indices are not aligned. While Nifty 50's positioning indicates a mild positive bias, Nifty Bank's data points to a bearish inclination.

Overall, FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) continue to maintain a bearish stance, although they have marginally reduced their short exposure. The net short positions on index futures and call options have declined, along with a reduction in net long positions in index puts (refer Change in Open Interest table).

That said, futures positioning shows a divergence, with Nifty witnessing long build-up and Nifty Bank seeing fresh short build-up, suggesting relatively stronger sentiment for the former. However, it is important to note that the market has just transitioned from April to May expiry. Hence, while these signals are valid, they may be slightly noisy at this early stage of the new series.

Here is our detailed analysis:

NIFTY 50

Nifty futures (May) (24,098) was largely flat through the last week, oscillating between 24,000 and 24,430. Nevertheless, the upward bias stays as the support at 24,000 remains valid and the price is above the 21-day moving average.

We expect Nifty futures to eventually resume the rally. It can surpass the nearest hurdle at 24,430 and rise to 25,000 in the near-term.

Long build-up in futures substantiate the positive bias. As May futures gained 0.3 per cent last week, the outstanding Open Interests (OI) almost doubled to 152 lakh contracts during the period. Put Call Ratio (PCR) of May monthly options, too, support the bulls as it stands at 1.11. A ratio greater than 1 means option traders have written (sold) more put options when compared to call options. Traders sell puts when they have neutral to positive expectations.

Overall, the chart shows that Nifty futures is trading above key support levels and the futures and options data also gives it a positive inclination. Thus, the probability for a rally is high.

The outlook for Nifty futures will turn bearish only if it slips below the support at 23,500. Until then, the bulls will have an edge over the bears.

BROAD TREND

- Early-series positioning remains noisy
- Trend strength varies within indices
- Breakout confirmation needed for Nifty Bank

Strategy: Retain long position on Nifty futures (May) that we recommended at 24,027. Maintain the stop-loss at 23,480. Going ahead, when the contract rises to 24,500 and 24,750, raise the stop-loss to 24,200 and 24,500 respectively. Book profits at 25,000.

Option traders can consider buying 24500-call of May monthly expiry. The premium closed at ₹264.85 last week. Go long at ₹250 with a stop-loss at ₹80. Target can be ₹600.

NIFTY BANK

Nifty Bank futures (May) (55,195) slipped 2.2 per cent last week, declining for a second week in a row. While it made a low of 54,605 on Thursday, it managed to reclaim 55,000-mark, providing some hope for the bulls.

However, a recovery might take time as the derivatives data show bears possess relatively greater strength at the moment.

The May futures has seen a short build-up last week. That is, while it dropped 2.2 per cent, the outstanding open interest of the contract nearly doubled to 20 lakh contracts during this period.

In addition, the PCR of May options is now at nearly 0.90 because option participants have written comparatively greater number of call options than put options on Nifty Bank, a bearish sign.

Given the above factors, there is a good chance for Nifty Bank futures to witness some more moderation in price before the uptrend kicks-in. Such potential declines can be arrested by the support levels at 54,600 and 54,000.

In case the support at 54,000 is breached, the outlook can turn bearish wherein we could see a quick fall to 52,000 and 50,500.

That said, in case there is a recovery from the current level, Nifty Bank futures ought to surpass 56,500 to establish a strong rally. If this occurs, the contract can move up to 59,000.

Strategy: Stay out for now. Go long on Nifty Bank futures (May) when it breaks out of 56,500. Place stop-loss at 55,300. When the contract rises to 58,000, raise the stop-loss to 56,900. Book profits at 59,000.

F&O: Expiry week long position

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Potential gains should drive your decision to choose one over the other

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed how delivery margins impact your trading strategy for equity options. This week, we extend this discussion to include long futures position. Specifically, given the delivery margins, we look at the factors you should consider while choosing between futures and options if you were to set up a long trade as a contract approaches expiry.

GETTY IMAGES

FUTURES VS OPTIONS

Long positions on single-stock futures and in-the-money (ITM) equity calls require holders to take delivery of the underlying shares at contract expiry. Previously, we discussed why break-even price (strike price plus option premium) is an important reference price if you want to close your position four days before expiry to avoid delivery margins. But what if you want to initiate a position before contract expiry?

Consider initiating a long position on an immediate out-of-the-money (OTM) call to bet on a positive view on an underlying. If the underlying moves up as you expected, the immediate OTM call is likely to become ITM. Because you hold the position as the contract approaches expiry, your broker will levy delivery margins, which progressively increases to 100 per cent of the contract amount on the expiry day. Similar delivery margins will apply if you initiate long position on single-stock futures before the expiry of the contract. Note that this is in addition to the initial margin you must make when you initiate the futures position. If cash outflows relating to margins are similar for futures and options closer to expiry, potential gains should drive your decision to choose one over the other.

QUICK TIP

Futures have symmetrical payoff while options have asymmetric payoff

We know that futures contract moves nearly one-to-one with the underlying. That is, futures contract has a delta close to one. Calls have a delta less than one. This is because calls lose value each passing day because of time decay. The upshot is that if your view on the underlying materialises, potential gain on futures will be more than that on call options. While there could be a bias towards futures among active traders who are disciplined at taking their stop-losses, this does not mean that you should always prefer long futures over long call if you were to initiate a position four days before expiry. But it is important to be mindful of the delivery margins and take that into consideration in your decision process.

OPTIONAL READING

Futures have symmetrical payoff while options have asymmetric payoff. This means that if price moves adversely, you are likely to lose more in futures compared to options on the same underlying. It is, therefore, important that you trade your futures positions with strict stop-loss. Note that buying put options to protect your long futures position is not an optimal way to protect your losses. Finally, note that your long futures position will always attract delivery margins closer to expiry. Your long call position will attract delivery margins only if the strike is ITM as it approaches expiry.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Range-bound bias

BULLION CUES. Either-side move likely

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold ($4,613.80/ounce) and silver ($75.40/ounce) lost 2 per cent and 0.4 per cent respectively over the last week. MCX gold futures (₹1,51,352/10gm) was down 0.9 per cent whereas MCX silver futures (₹2,50,937/kg) gained 0.4 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,51,352)

Gold futures (June) dropped in the first half of last week and marked a low of ₹1,47,950 on Wednesday. But it recovered some of the losses in the last two sessions.

Nevertheless, the price remains below the 21-day moving average and there are no strong signs of a bullish reversal at the moment.

Only a clear breakout of ₹1,55,000 can turn the outlook positive. At the same time, the price action shows that ₹1,48,000 is acting as a good support. There is a good chance for gold futures to stay between ₹1,48,000 and ₹1,55,000.

Resistance above ₹1,55,000 is at ₹1,62,000 and support below ₹1,48,000 is at ₹1,40,000.

Trade strategy: We suggested shorting gold futures at ₹1,54,000 with a stop-loss at ₹1,56,000. Book profits at the current level of ₹1,51,352.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,50,937)

Silver futures (July) declined to hit an intra-week low of ₹2,36,852 on Wednesday before recouping all the losses.

However, the price action does not show a definite trend where the contract is trading within two important levels at ₹2,36,000 and ₹2,60,000.

Only a clear breach of either of these levels will give us clues about the next leg of trend. A breakout of ₹2,60,000 can take the contract to ₹2,80,000 whereas a breach of ₹2,36,000 can drag it to ₹2,20,000.

Trade strategy: Stay out.

Range holds

CRUDE CHECK. But breakout may follow soon

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices have now risen for a second week in a row. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) ($108.20/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹9,665/barrel) were up 9.1 per cent and 9.6 per cent respectively. Below is an analysis.

BRENT FUTURES ($108.20)

Brent crude oil futures extended the rally and marked a high of $114.70 on Thursday before moderating to the current level. The price action over the last two months shows that the contract has been trading within the broad range of $94-114, barring the brief drop to $86.09 on April 17.

So, the next leg of trend depends on the direction of the breakout of the aforementioned range. A breakout of $114 will open the door for an upswing to $125-130 whereas a breach of the support at $94, can drag it lower to $80. But as it stands, the risk is tilted on the upside for the breakout of $114.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹9,665)

Crude oil futures (May) was largely trading between ₹8,000 and ₹9,500 for about two months. But last week, it broke out of ₹9,500 and rallied to hit a high of ₹10,571 on Thursday before ending the week lower at ₹9,665.

Although there is a fresh breakout in MCX futures, Brent crude futures is yet to see one. As the latter is the driving force, we cannot go long on MCX futures based on it seeing a fresh breakout.

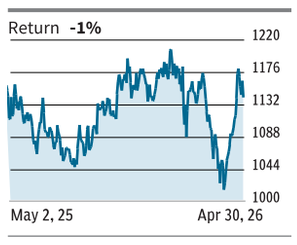
For the next actual uptrend to happen, MCX futures should surpass ₹10,600. In such a case, the contract can rise to ₹12,000.

Trade strategy: Traders with higher risk-appetite can buy crude oil futures at ₹9,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹12,000 and ₹7,800 respectively.

F & O QUERY

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU
bl. research bureau

Can I short Tata Consumer futures at current levels?
Jeevanandham



Tata Consumer Products (₹1,144.60): After witnessing a rally in the recent weeks, the stock slipped 2.5 per cent last week. The downtick may not extend much as there are support levels ahead at ₹1,126 – its 200-day moving average – and ₹1,110.

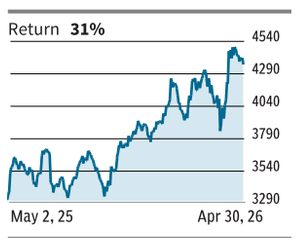
That said, there is a key resistance at ₹1,200. Last week's price correction happened on the back of this.

Given that there are two important levels, one, a support at ₹1,110 and two, a resistance at ₹1,200, it can be a bit early for us to predict the path of next swing in price. The equivalent levels for Tata Consumer Products futures (May) (₹1,150.10) are at ₹1,120 and ₹1,200.

As the recent trend has been bullish, the probability of the breakout of ₹1,200 is higher than the breach of the support at ₹1,120.

So, we suggest staying out for now. Go long on May futures if it breaks out of ₹1,200. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,300 and ₹1,150 respectively.

Titan seems to be stabilising at current levels. Based on this, do you recommended buying futures now?
Sunil Mark



Titan Company (₹4,385.20): The stock broke out of a notable resistance at ₹4,350 on April 8 and hit a record high of ₹4,544 on April 16. Ever since the scrip broke out, it has largely stayed flat i.e., it has been consolidating between ₹4,350 and ₹4,540.

The May futures of Titan Company has been trading between ₹4,370 and ₹4,570.

Nevertheless, the outlook remains positive and the sideways movement is a corrective consolidation, which has now taken the price and the 21-day moving average to the same level of ₹4,400.

Therefore, we expect Titan Company May futures (₹4,402.20) to resume the rally soon. This time, we anticipate a breakout of the barrier at ₹4,570. The contract can touch ₹4,650 soon after surpassing ₹4,570.

So, we recommend going long now at ₹4,400. Place stop-loss at ₹4,290. When the contract touches ₹4,570, revise the stop-loss to ₹4,450. Book profits at ₹4,650.

Send your queries to **derivatives@thehindu.co.in.**

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Apr 30	Weekly change %	As on Apr 30	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	27506	-57	205791	-8
Future Index Short	211982	-21	75633	-12
Net Futures	-184476	-10	130158	-6
Index Call options Long	351772	-47	2329462	-26
Index Call options Short	572110	-35	2202648	-27
Net Call options	-220338	-3	126814	-23
Index Put options Long	715640	-21	1671237	-18
Index Put options Short	356275	-32	2388599	-14
Net Put Options	359365	-6	-717362	-2

FIIs have reduced net short on index futures. They've also marginally reduced net short on calls and net long on puts. Overall, FII bearish stance persist, but with reduced exposure.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Apr 30)				
KFINTECH	895.70	-6.3	118.6	58.3
FORCEMOT	19,904.00	-2.2	4.6	40.7
SUNPHARMA	1,808.30	11.6	424.4	18.4
ETERNAL	247.03	-3.8	3484.4	18.2
WAAREEENER	3,118.80	-5.7	119.0	16.5
FALL (as on Apr 30)				
360ONE	1,034.65	-0.5	55.8	-57.1
BOSCHLTD	35,995.00	-1.9	3.1	-54.8
ANGELONE	308.71	-1.8	390.2	-53.3
NUVAMA	1,326.50	-1.4	20.1	-47.9
ABB	7,230.00	-1.3	32.0	-47.0

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on May 4)

Nil

Change in OI and market positioning

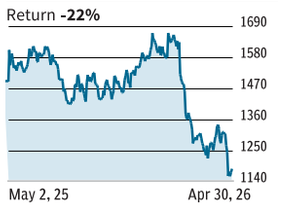
Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹) (Weekly change %)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on May 1)				
ALUMINIUM	29-May	368.9 (-1.4)	3,097 (32)	Short build-up
COPPER	29-May	1,282.2 (-0.9)	12,099 (15)	Short build-up
CRUDEOIL	18-May	9,665.0 (9.6)	15,344 (39)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	18-May	9,665.0 (9.6)	47,459 (37)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,51,352.0 (-0.9)	9,083 (12)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	29-May	1,21,893.0 (-1.0)	15,875 (38)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Jun	1,51,353.0 (-0.9)	40,383 (106)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	29-May	15,274.0 (-1.0)	2,03,485 (34)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	29-May	1,51,604.0 (-0.9)	35,065 (19)	Short build-up
LEAD	29-May	199.4 (0.1)	290 (21)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	26-May	264.5 (3.6)	27,833 (6)	Long build-up
SILVER	3-Jul	2,50,937.0 (0.4)	6,994 (84)	Long build-up
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,53,922.0 (0.4)	19,124 (19)	Long build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,53,956.0 (0.4)	57,770 (12)	Long build-up
ZINC	29-May	343.4 (-1.7)	2,174 (40)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Apr 30)				
USDINR	26-May	95.12 (0.7)	1550972 (100)	Long build-up
EURINR	26-May	111.61 (-)	29608 (-)	-
GBPINR	26-May	128.77 (-)	35273 (-)	-
JPYINR	26-May	60.84 (-)	145 (-)	-

F&O Strategy

Buy Infosys call

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Infosys (₹1,181.80), although has been in a downtrend, can see a pullback rally from the current level. Immediate resistances are ₹1,250 and ₹1,310. On the other hand, nearby support is at ₹1,127. We expect the pullback rally to lift the stock to ₹1,300 in the short term.



F&O pointers: Infosys May futures closed at ₹1,187.40 against the spot price of ₹1,181.10. The counter witnessed unwinding of long positions in the last couple of days when the stock price moved up, as traders preferred to book profits rather than rolling over due to uncertainty ahead. Option trading indicates that Infosys could move between ₹1,100 and ₹1,400.

Strategy: Consider buying 1180-strike call on Infosys that closed with a premium of ₹40.45 last week. As the market lot is 400 shares, this strategy would cost traders ₹16,180.

The premium paid will be the maximum loss and that will happen if Infosys fails to cross ₹1,180. The break-even point is ₹1,220.45. However, the profit potentials are huge if the stock rises sharply during the current May series.

We advise traders to keep the initial stop-loss at ₹32. Traders can aim for a target of ₹55 with trailing stop-loss that should protect profits.

If Infosys opens this week either above ₹1,200 or below ₹1,160, traders should avoid this strategy.

Follow-up: Tata Power and Suzlon hit our respective target levels.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

F&O ban explained

bl. research bureau

More often than not traders can find certain stocks being banned in which no fresh positions in futures and options (F&O) contracts can be initiated. Because the trading activity in the scrip would have reached certain level that is deemed very high.

So, what is this F&O ban? To know this one should understand what Market Wide Position Limit (MWPL) is.

MWPL for a stock is 20 per cent of the number of shares under free float i.e. shares owned by non-promoters. When aggregate OI in futures and options across exchanges exceeds 95 per cent of MWPL at the end of a day, that particular stock will come under F&O ban from the next day.

Normal trading will resume when aggregate OI drops to 80 per cent of MWPL.

For instance, let us assume that the total number of shares outstanding in Company A is 2000 and out of this, 1000 shares are free float. So, MWPL for this scrip is 200 shares (i.e. 20 per cent of 1000). Here, when the aggregate OI of this stock exceeds 95 per cent i.e. 190 shares, the scrip will enter F&O ban. Thereafter, normal trading will resume if OI falls below 160 shares.

While traders can exit positions they initiated before the ban, creation of new positions will attract penalty of 1 per cent of the value of increased position, subject to minimum of ₹5,000 and maximum of ₹1 lakh.

Supports ahead

INDEX OUTLOOK. Benchmark indices likely to reverse higher again

GETTY IMAGES

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex bounced back well initially last week but failed to sustain. The indices fell sharply on Thursday giving away almost all the gains and managed to close marginally higher for the week. The Nifty Bank index on the other hand got knocked down all through the week. The index fell 2.19 per cent.

The market movement last week is broadly in line with our expectation. There is not much downside left from current levels. Supports are there to limit the downside. We can expect the Nifty, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index to reverse higher and resume their up-move either from here itself or after some more fall.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold heavily in the equity segment last week. There was a net outflow of about $1.79 billion last week. For the month of April, the equity segment has seen a net outflow of about $6.47 billion.

NIFTY 50 (23,997.55)

Short-term view: The support in the 23,800-23,750 region can continue to hold well this week as well. Near-term resistance is at 24,300 which can be tested this week. A rise past this hurdle can take the Nifty higher to 24,600-24,700 in the coming weeks. An eventual break above 24,700 will then clear the way for the rise to 25,400-25,500 in the short term.

In case Nifty breaks below 23,750, an extended fall to 23,500 can be seen. Thereafter it can rise back again and go up to 24,300-24,700 and higher levels.

The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index breaks below 23,500. If that happens, 23,100-23,000 and lower levels can be seen on the downside.

Medium-term view: The fall last week has not disrupted the big picture. The bullish view remains intact. Nifty can rise to 26,500 in the medium term. A break above 26,500 will then trigger a rally to 28,000-30,000 in the long term.

If 26,500 caps the upside, then the broad range of 22,000-26,500 can continue to remain in play for some more time.

Nifty has to fall below 22,000 to prove our bullish view wrong.

NIFTY BANK (54,863.35)

Short-term view: The fall to 54,500 happened last week as expected. There is room to see 53,600-53,500 on the downside in the near term. But thereafter we can see the Nifty Bank index rising back to 56,000 initially and 58,000-58,500 eventually in the short term. As mentioned last week, an extended rise to 60,000 cannot be ruled out.

A sustained break below 53,500 is needed to bring the index under pressure for a fall to 52,500 and 51,000.

Medium-term view: The broader bullish view remains intact. A decisive weekly close above 60,500 will strengthen the momentum for a rise to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term. That in turn will open the doors for the Nifty Bank index to target 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

The level of 50,000 is a crucial support. The bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below this support.

NEAR-TERM SUPPORTS

- Nifty 50: 23,750, 23,500
- Sensex: 76,000, 74,000
- Nifty Bank: 54,500, 53,500

Nifty 50 stays afloat

SENSEX (76,913.50)

Short-term view: Support is in the 76,100-76,000 region. We expect the Sensex to sustain above this support zone. A bounce from there and a subsequent rise above 77,500 can give some relief. It can then increase the chances of a rise to 78,800-79,000. An eventual break above 79,000 can then take the Sensex up to 81,500-82,000 in the short term. The short-term outlook will turn negative only on a break below 76,000. If that happens, Sensex can fall to 74,000 or even 72,500.

Medium-term view: The big picture remains positive. A rise above 83,000 can boost the momentum. It can then see the Sensex surging to 86,000 or even 90,000 in the medium term.

From a long-term perspective, there is potential to target 94,000 and even 98,000.

This bullish view will go wrong only if Sensex declines below 71,000.

Failure to rise above 86,000 can keep the index in a wide range of 71,000-86,000 for some more time.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,000.05)

The rise above 22,200 did not sustain last week. The Nifty Midcap 150 index touched a high of 22,409.45 and has come down sharply from there. However, the bias remains positive.

Supports are at 21,800 and 21,600-21,500. A bounce from either of these supports can take the index up to 22,200 again. A decisive break above 22,200 can then take the index up to 22,700-23,000 in the short term.

The region around 23,000 is a crucial resistance. A decisive break above 23,000 can boost the momentum. That in turn can trigger a rally to 26,000-26,500 and 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

Failure to breach 23,000 can keep the index inside a range of 20,800-23,000.

The bullish view will come under threat only if the index declines below 20,800.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (16,731.20)

The index rose to a high of 16,905.25 and then has come down from there. The breakout above 16,500 strengthens our bullish case. Key supports are at 16,500 and 16,350. The index can reverse higher again from either of these two supports. That leg of rise can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index up to 17,000-17,500 in the short term. An eventual break above 17,500 can then clear the way to test the crucial resistance level of 18,300. The long-term picture looks strong for the Nifty Smallcap 250 index to target 22,500-23,000 and 24,000. A decisive break above 18,300 will strengthen the momentum and clear the way for this rally.

A fall below 14,000 is needed to negate our bullish view.

bl.portfolio video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

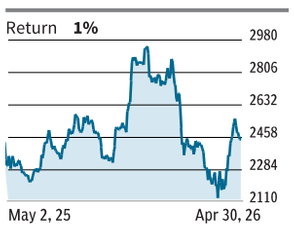
English | Tamil

TECH QUERY

GURUMURTHY K
bl. research bureau

I have Asian Paints shares. My average price is ₹2,647. Should I continue to hold or exit?

Muthubasavan



Asian Paints (₹2,445): The stock is getting support around ₹2,100. The recent bounce from the low of ₹2,116 made in March this year is giving some relief. You may have to be cautious. Resistance is around ₹2,600. A break above it can take the stock up to ₹2,850 or even ₹3,150 in the short term. But ideally, the stock has to rise past ₹3,400 to become bullish. You can consider two options. One is to keep a stop-loss now at ₹2,280 and exit on a rise at ₹2,830. Move the stop-loss up to ₹2,660 when the price touches ₹2,770. Second option is to buy more at current levels and keep a wide stop-loss at ₹1,990. Follow the stop-loss revisions mentioned for the first option here also.

I intend to buy ABB for the long term. Please suggest a good entry point based on charts.

Prashant K Pore

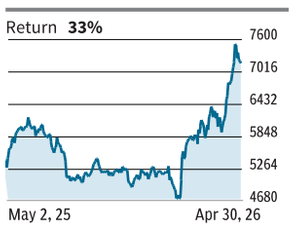
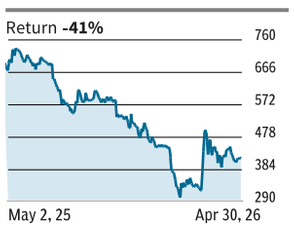


ABB (₹7,229): The long-term outlook is bullish. The strong surge above ₹6,400 last month confirms a double-bottom pattern on the chart. This is a bullish reversal pattern. The recent rise is also happening from a strong long-term trendline support. This strengthens the bullish case. Strong support is in the broad ₹6,400-₹6,000 region. Some resistance is in the ₹7,900-₹8,100 region. A break above ₹8,100 can take ABB share price up to ₹10,000 in the long term. Buy now and accumulate on dips at ₹6,850. Keep the stop-loss at ₹5,640. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹8,050 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹8,450. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹8,860 and ₹9,250 when the stock touches ₹9,180 and ₹9,650 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹9,980.

I have bought Tejas Networks at ₹445. What is the outlook? Can the price go up to ₹1,000?

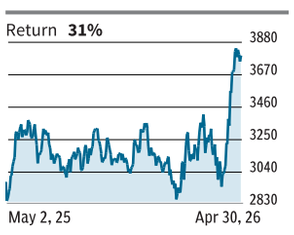
Vijaya, Mysuru



Tejas Networks (₹415): The trend is down and strong since November 2024. A strong rise above ₹660 is needed to turn the outlook bullish. But that looks unlikely. Even if that happens, it may take a lot of time and will need some strong positive trigger. So, we do not see any chance of the price going back up to ₹1,000. Immediate supports are at ₹395 and ₹380. If it manages to sustain above them, a rise to ₹500 is likely in the short term. If you have the risk appetite, keep a stop-loss at ₹375 and hold the stock. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹445 and ₹465 when the price touches ₹455 and ₹480 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹490.

What is the outlook for Siemens. Can I buy the stock for long term?

Reema, Mumbai



Siemens (₹3,828): The stock has made a bullish breakout of its prolonged sideways range that was in place since May last year. Strong supports are there at ₹3,450 and ₹3,350. From a long-term perspective, there is potential for Siemens share price to target ₹4,800 over the next one year. An intermediate dip to ₹3,500-₹3,450 in the short-term cannot be ruled out. So, you may have to buy the stock in two tranches. Buy the stock now and accumulate on dips at ₹3,580. Keep the stop-loss at ₹3,180. Move the stop-loss up to ₹3,720 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹4,080. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹4,120 and ₹4,480 when the share price touches ₹4,350 and ₹4,620 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹4,750.

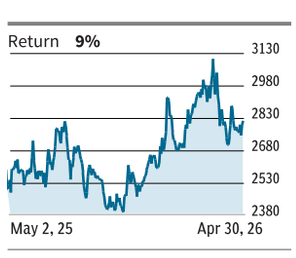
Send your queries to **techtrail@thehindu.co.in**

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

Ajanta Pharma (₹2,824.60)

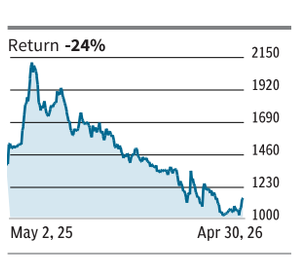
Retains the bullish outlook



The stock of Ajanta Pharma has been consolidating between ₹2,720 and ₹2,930 in the past month. But the trend has been up since October last year. Notably, post the breakout of ₹2,800, we had recommended buying on January 4 edition of *bl.portfolio*. The suggested buying price was ₹2,868 with target and stop-loss at ₹3,800 and ₹2,525 respectively. Traders can retain this position as the stock is trading above the key level of ₹2,800 and the long-term outlook is bullish. When the stock touches ₹3,450 and ₹3,680, revise the stop-loss to ₹3,280 and ₹3,580 respectively. Book profits at ₹3,800.

Concord Biotech (₹1,140.15)

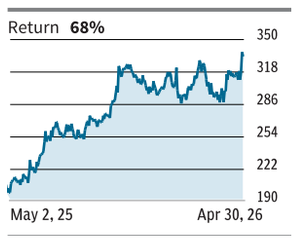
Shifting the direction



The stock of Concord Biotech has been in a long-term downtrend. But after staying in a sideways trend between ₹995 and ₹1,100 through April, it has now broken out of the barrier at ₹1,100. The price is now above both 21- and 50-day moving averages. While there may not be a bullish trend reversal, the likelihood of at least a corrective rally is high given the recent price action. We expect the scrip to touch ₹1,400. Participants can buy the stock now at ₹1,140 and ₹1,080. Place stop-loss at ₹980. When the price hits ₹1,260 and ₹1,350, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,120 and ₹1,260 respectively. Exit at ₹1,400.

RBL Bank (₹336.60)

Sees a fresh breakout



The stock of RBL, since October 2025, has been trading in a broad sideways trend. That is, it has been oscillating between ₹288 and ₹332. Last week, the stock saw a rally and on Thursday, it broke out of the resistance at ₹332. This indicates that the bulls have regained traction and the probability of further rally is high. That said, the price might moderate to ₹320 before the next leg of rally. Go long at ₹336 and accumulate at ₹320. Place stop-loss at ₹300. When the price hits ₹360, alter the stop-loss to ₹340. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹370 when the stock touches ₹385. Book profits at ₹400.

More rise on the cards

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Broader uptrend intact for indices

GETTY IMAGES

Gurumurthy K
bl. research Bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average has risen back sharply towards the end of the week recovering all the loss. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices on the other hand extended their up-move for the fifth consecutive week. The overall uptrend continues to remain intact for the US benchmark indices. We can see them rising further in the coming weeks.

DOW JONES (49,499.27)

Supports are at 48,950 and then at 48,400. Resistance is around 50,000. For now, 48,950-50,000 (narrow) or 48,400-50,000 (broad) can be the trading range for some time. The bias is positive. As such we can expect the Dow Jones to make a bullish breakout above 50,000 eventually. Such a break can trigger a rise to 51,000-52,000.

The bullish view will get negated only if the index declines below 48,400. If that happens, then there is a danger of seeing 46,000-45,000 on the downside.

S&P 500 (7,230.12)

As expected, the S&P 500 index has risen above 7,200. That keeps intact our broader bullish view.

Immediate support is at 7,180. Below that 7,100 is the next strong support. As long as the index sustains above 7,100, there is potential for it to target 7,600 on the upside.

The index will come under pressure for a fall to 7,000 only if it breaks below 7,100. Ideally, the S&P 500 index has to decline below 7,000 to indicate a bearish trend reversal.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (25,114.44)

The index continued to get a good follow-through rise for the second consecutive week. This keeps the door open for the NASDAQ Composite index to see a rally towards 26,300-26,500 in the coming weeks. The upside can extend even up to 27,500.

Immediate support is at 24,600. Below that, 24,000-23,900 is the next strong support. A corrective fall to 24,000 is a possibility if the index breaks below 24,600. However, a fall beyond 23,900 is unlikely as fresh buyers can come into the market and limit the downside.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (98.21) has come down sharply after touching a high of 99.34. The immediate outlook is unclear. Support is around 97.60 and resistance is at 99.50. So, 97.60-99.50 can be the possible trading range for now. A breakout on either side of 97.60 or 99.50 will determine the next leg of move.

MIXED OUTLOOK

The near-term outlook remains unclear, and the dollar index can oscillate in a range of 97.60-99.50

A break below 97.60 will be bearish to see 96.70 on the downside first. It will also keep the dollar index vulnerable for a fall to 95.50 and even 95 in the coming weeks.

On the other hand, if the index breaks above 99.50, it can get some relief. Such a break can then take it higher to 100.50-101.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield rose to a high of 4.43 per cent and has come down from there. It has closed the week at 4.37 per cent.

The bias remains positive. Support is at 4.3 per cent which can be tested this week. A bounce from this support can trigger a fresh rise to 4.5-4.6 per cent in the coming weeks.

In case the yield breaks below 4.3 per cent, then an extended fall to 4.25 per cent can be seen first. Thereafter the yield can reverse higher again.

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

BANDU'S PICKS

1. **Cohance Lifesciences**
2. **Bandhan Bank**
3. **IndusInd Bank**
4. **Reliance Industries**
5. **Vodafone Idea**

Last week's prize winner
Manjeet Kaur

Last week's winning stock
Oracle Financial Services

Closing price (Apr 24)
₹8,957.25

Closing price (Apr 30)
₹9,717.15

Return:
8.48 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to **bandublockbuster@gmail.com** with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

BENGALURU
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - MAY 3 - 2026

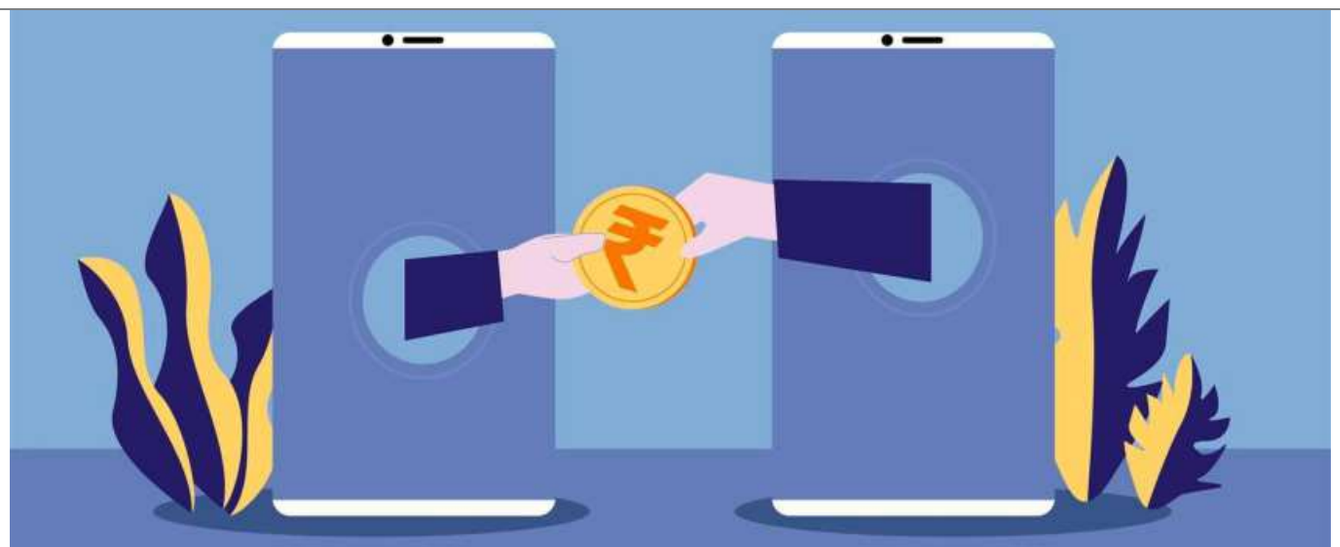
Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.3 and 0.4 per cent respectively last week. BSE Teck gained the most by 3.1 per cent, followed by BSE IT 2.7 per cent and BSE Oil & Gas 2.4 per cent. BSE Bankex and BSE PSU declined the most by 2.3 and 0.9 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	20.9	20.9	33.3	14.0	57.4	62.0	35.1	39.8	20.8	23.0	9.3	37.9	12.1	37.9	24.5
P/BV	3.3	4.1	6.3	2.2	15.2	16.2	7.9	6.8	5.9	3.3	1.7	5.2	2.4	4.9	7.5
Dividend Yield	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.1	0.4	0.5	1.5	0.5	2.9	0.9	2.7	1.0	2.2	0.4	2.2
Weekly Return (%)	0.4 ▲	0.3 ▲	0.9 ▲	-2.3 ▼	0.2 ▲	0.0 ▼	0.7 ▲	2.3 ▲	2.7 ▲	0.6 ▲	2.4 ▲	1.1 ▲	-0.9 ▼	1.8 ▲	3.1 ▲
Monthly Return (%)	7.5 ▲	6.9 ▲	8.7 ▲	9.1 ▲	20.2 ▲	12.3 ▲	12.6 ▲	6.8 ▲	1.7 ▲	14.6 ▲	8.3 ▲	22.2 ▲	11.4 ▲	21.4 ▲	2.0 ▲
Annual Return (%)	-1.4 ▼	-4.1 ▼	14.4 ▲	-1.5 ▼	23.0 ▲	2.9 ▲	-7.6 ▼	5.7 ▲	-19.0 ▼	45.2 ▲	4.5 ▲	22.7 ▲	17.2 ▲	-10.7 ▼	-13.3 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr.High	Yr.Low
360 ONE [1]	1034.9	29.9	34.6	4.3	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	-0.4	14.3	2.0	1273.0	861.8
3M India	33282.6	542.7	61.3	17.5	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	2.0	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28300.0
A														
A B B [2]	7229.1	78.8	91.8	19.6	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	-1.3	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
A B Real Estate	1487.7	-19.0		4.4	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.9	5.1	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	488.9	23.9	20.4	3.1	202512	18.2	22.7	18.7	20.0	0.0	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2
Aarti Industries [5]	507.2	10.2	49.6	3.2	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	7.4	6.2	0.7	512.2	338.2
AAVAS Financiers	1378.7	61.9	22.3	2.9	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-2.3	9.9	3.2	2152.0	1050.3
Abbott India	25430.9	717.3	35.5	13.5	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	0.9	45.0	0.0	35921.6	25164.0
ACC	1422.7	112.4	12.7	1.3	202603	16.9	-62.9	17.3	-9.0	0.8	17.9	0.0	2027.8	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	303.0	8.3	36.6	3.8	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	-0.8	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7
Action Const.Eq. [2]	887.4	35.5	25.0	5.9	202512	-2.3	4.2	0.3	8.6	-2.1	40.2	0.0	1390.0	746.1
Adani Energy Sol	1342.2	19.0	70.6	6.3	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	-5.0	10.1	2.2	1463.0	745.5
Adani Enterp. [1]	2404.1	16.7	143.8	5.8	202603	20.3	-124.0	2.6	-48.0	5.1	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1753.5
Adani Green	1225.9	11.2	109.3	10.1	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	-0.8	9.4	6.4	1271.5	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1655.2	56.3	29.4	4.0	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	4.4	14.0	0.9	1677.0	1203.6
Adani Power [2]	222.1	6.7	33.4	6.6	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	4.2	21.2	0.7	226.3	101.1
Adani Total Gas [1]	634.8	6.0	106.5	14.4	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	1.2	17.4	0.4	797.4	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	1015.2	33.8	30.0	7.3	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	-4.9	35.5	0.0	1098.9	611.8
Aditya Bir. Fas.	64.2	-6.2		1.3	202512	7.9	-215.9	9.7	4.5	3.7	0.0	1.3	107.7	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap	345.4	13.5	25.5	2.8	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.2	1.5	9.5	4.4	369.3	186.0
Aegis Logistics [1]	700.7	21.9	32.0	4.1	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	-2.0	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0
Aether Industri.	1172.9	16.9	69.6	6.7	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	5.3	9.7	0.1	1250.0	723.2
Afcons Infrastr.	339.7	13.9	24.4	2.3	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	7.8	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.9
Affle 3i [2]	1425.3	31.1	45.8	6.2	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	1.3	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.9
AIA Engineering [2]	3946.4	124.8	31.6	5.0	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	-1.8	19.1	0.1	4200.0	3000.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2824.6	81.2	34.8	8.2	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	2.1	32.0	0.0	3158.2	2335.0
Alembic Pharma [2]	754.5	33.8	22.4	2.8	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	0.5	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.3
Alkem Lab [2]	5404.1	200.9	26.9	4.8	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	3.4	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8
Alkyl Amines [2]	1515.6	35.3	42.9	5.4	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	2.6	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	532.6	9.6	55.5	9.6	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	-4.4	21.0	0.9	720.0	302.5
Alok Industries [1]	13.8	-1.6		-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	2.2	0.0	0.0	23.5	11.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	874.5	37.4	23.4	2.1	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	-0.7	15.6	0.0	1095.9	671.5
Amber Enterp.	8026.2	66.0	121.5	7.7	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	3.6	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	444.5	15.6	28.5	2.0	202512	9.2	-89.9	16.4	-8.7	-1.4	12.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Anand Rathi Wea. [5]	3597.7	47.7	75.5	29.9	202603	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	0.5	56.8	0.1	3733.9	1636.8
Anant Raj [2]	487.4	14.6	33.3	3.2	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	5.5	10.9	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	308.7	10.0	30.7	4.6	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-1.9	25.8	0.7	330.1	208.9
Apar Inds.	12332.4	246.9	50.0	10.2	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	6.9	32.6	0.1	12850.0	5300.5
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1903.5	41.1	46.3	11.5	202512	7.2	42.9	9.2	80.0	-5.0	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7639.2	126.3	60.5	12.1	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-1.1	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	408.5	23.0	17.8	1.7	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	-3.8	10.9	0.3	540.3	392.3
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	260.5	17.8	14.7	2.8	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	2.3	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5
Asahi India Glas [1]	836.0	12.3	68.0	5.8	202512	8.4	32.8	5.3	-4.7	0.1	13.1	0.9	1073.0	686.0
Ashok Leyland [1]	162.1	6.2	26.3	7.6	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-4.6	14.9	4.3	215.4	107.0
Asian Paints [1]	2444.6	42.6	57.4	12.0	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-1.6	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.0
Aster DM Health.	701.4	7.8	90.1	8.7	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	-0.6	11.6	0.5	732.0	497.2
Astral [1]	1530.0	19.2	79.8	10.9	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	-2.1	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1240.5
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	8217.2	83.2	98.8	25.7	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	-3.3	32.9	0.0	10653.1	7630.0
Ather Energy [1]	934.7	-16.9		13.1	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	25.0	5.9	0.0	1.1	970.0	287.3
Atul	6808.2	230.3	29.6	3.2	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	1.7	12.8	0.0	7793.0	5563.0
AU Small Finance	1017.3	35.3	28.8	3.9	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	-4.5	0.0	0.0	1079.7	655.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1389.6	60.8	22.9	2.3	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-1.7	14.2	0.2	1459.8	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	472.2	42.8	11.0	2.5	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-3.2	29.7	0.1	683.5	335.2
Avenue Super.	4590.7	43.9	104.5	13.1	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	3.3	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	196.6	8.2	24.1	2.5	202603	17.7	53.5	17.3	-13.4	-0.6	19.8	0.3	285.4	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1267.7	84.9	14.9	1.9	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	-7.2	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3
B														
B H E L [2]	352.4	2.3	150.7	5.0	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	4.5	3.2	0.4	358.0	205.2
B P C L	300.5	57.6	5.2	1.4	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	-2.5	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto	9997.8	319.9	31.3	8.2	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	4.4	28.1	0.2	10186.6	7556.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	936.6	30.8	30.4	5.1	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	1.6	11.4	3.8	1102.5	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1747.0	62.9	27.8	3.6	202603	5.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	-1.3	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings	10268.2	660.2	15.6	1.7	202512	127.6	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	0.0	11.5	0.0	14873.2	8597.5
Bajaj Housing	87.2	3.1	28.3	3.2	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-2.4	9.5	4.7	128.5	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2160.3	67.9	31.8	4.0	202512	6.9	-15.0	2.6	-26.0	-3.2	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2016.0
Balrampur Chini [1]	520.6	22.2	23.5	2.7	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	1.0	11.1	0.6	627.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank	199.9	7.6	26.3	1.3	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	14.5	0.0	0.0	204.5	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	263.5	37.6	7.0	0.8	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.7	-3.9	0.0	0.0	325.6	212.1
Bank of India	139.9	22.4	6.2	0.8	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	-5.1	0.0	0.0	178.5	104.1
Bank of Maha	78.5	9.1	8.6	1.9	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	0.7	0.0	0.0	82.2	47.1
BASF India	3640.1	84.3	43.2	4.2	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	-0.2	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2906.9
Bata India [5]	720.1	14.9	48.2	6.1	202512	2.8	9.0	-0.6	-23.4	-2.3	14.6	0.9	1300.1	605.6
Bayer Crop Sci.	4772.4	149.2	32.0	6.9	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	2.0	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9
BEML Ltd [5]	1804.5	29.9	60.3	5.4	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	0.7	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	472.9	9.6	49.2	8.8	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	2.6	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1365.6	15.8	86.3	11.9	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	-2.4	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	431.4	8.2	52.9	14.6	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	-3.0	36.9	0.0	473.3	304.5
Bharat Forge [2]	1885.9	24.4	77.1	9.6	202512	25.0	41.3	4.5	18.2	1.6	11.7	0.9	1949.9	1080.2
Bharti Airtel [5]	1886.1	50.4	37.4	9.7	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.0	3.9	14.3	2.2	2174.7	1747.2
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1514.2	35.2	43.0	12.1	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	-1.2	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.6
Bikaji Foods [1]	677.4	10.0	68.0	11.3	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	2.7	18.4	0.2	820.9	591.6
Biocon [5]	359.6	5.1	71.1	1.5	202512	9.3	1733.6	14.4	5.9	2.8	6.9	0.8	425.0	317.0
Birla Corpn.	913.1	74.2	12.3	1.2	202512	-4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	0.5	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	369.4	17.5	21.1	2.8	202512	-1.1	22.7	-2.6	-15.1	0.2	20.8	0.0	473.8	320.2
BLS Internat. [1]	278.8	15.6	17.8	5.4	202512	43.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	1.1	39.0	0.1	421.9	218.5
Blue Dart Expres	5458.9	122.5	44.6	7.9	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	5.7	2.1	17.1	0.7	7222.4	4695.0
Blue Jet Health [2]	443.6	16.9	26.2	6.1	202512	-39.6	-59.4	20.6	25.1	9.9	40.4	0.0	1028.2	325.2
Blue Star [2]	1784.4	26.0	68.6	11.8	202512	4.2	-2.0	9.5	-2.6	-1.8	25.8	0.1	2050.0	1450.0
Bosch	36008.8	783.8	45.9	7.6	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	-1.8	20.5	0.0	41894.3	28650.1
Brainbees Solut. [2]	238.8	-3.0		2.6	202512	11.6	-772.0	12.4	-3.4	-2.2	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.1
Brigade Enterpr.	789.9	31.1	25.4	3.0	202512	7.6	-15.1	7.2	17.8	1.8	13.3	1.2	1332.4	615.0
Britannia Inds. [1]	5725.9	100.3	57.1	36.9	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	-0.1	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5280.0
C														
C P C L	1128.2	208.3	5.4	1.5	202603	-2.5	202.6	7.2	1349.4	9.1	4.3	0.3	1159.0	584.8
C.E. Info System [2]	921.2	24.1	38.2	6.1	202512	-18.2	-42.1	10.8	-3.3	-0.1	23.8	0.0	2165.0	795.3
Campus Activewe. [5]	248.1	4.6	53.8	9.6	202512	14.3	37.0	11.2	18.6	1.9	19.7	0.3	304.5	215.4
Cams Services [2]	738.4	18.7	39.5	15.1	202512	5.5	0.0	7.3	0.9	-2.9	51.6	0.1	875.0	611.7
Can Fin Homes [2]	864.6	81.5	10.6	1.9	202603	7.5	47.8	8.7	26.7	-4.9	9.3	7.1	970.0	693.3
Canara Bank [2]	134.7	22.3	6.0	1.1	202512	0.6	24.7	5.6	23.0	-4.4	0.0	0.0	162.9	90.1
Caplin Point Lab [2]	1710.6	80.7	21.2	4.1	202512	10.1	17.9	10.7	19.1	-0.4	26.0	0.0	2397.0	1502.5
Capri Global [1]	186.6	9.9	18.9	2.7	202603	44.7	59.1	45.7	98.4	1.6	11.2	3.2	213.9	150.6
Carborundum Uni. [1]	951.5	12.7	75.1	4.8	202512	2.5	-14.1	3.1	-46.6	2.9	16.4	0.1	1070.0	734.7
Castrol India [5]	184.9	9.9	18.8	9.6	202603	8.7	3.7	7.0	3.2	1.3	58.8	0.0	232.4	170.2
CCL Products [2]	1134.8	28.1	40.4	7.3	202512	38.5	59.1	35.8	37.2	3.3	13.1	0.9	1197.2	583.1
CEAT	3447.7	184.8	18.7	2.8	202603	23.3	98.6	18.6	51.3	-0.8	14.7	0.5	4431.6	3006.5
Cello World [5]	417.1	14.3	29.2	4.0	202512	-0.6	-20.0	9.7	-6.9	-2.7	26.6	0.1	673.0	382.9
Cemindia Project [1]	814.6	34.8	23.4	5.8	202603	17.4	113.6	9.3	60.5	25.7	27.7	0.6	943.2	477.0
Central Bank	36.4	4.9	7.4	0.9	202603	12.1	-32.5	7.0	13.5	1.1	0.0	0.0	41.2	31.3
Cera Sanitary. [5]	5245.1	191.6	27.4	5.0	202506	5.4	-1.1	5.2	7.0	-1.6	22.0	0.0	7271.4	4463.0
CESC [1]	187.5	11.1	16.9	2.0	202512	12.5	7.5	11.1	5.5	3.9	10.4	1.4	193.7	138.1
CG Power & Ind [2]	813.0	7.1	115.1	17.2	202512	26.2	18.4	25.5	18.3	-1.3	38.2	0.0	846.9	525.5
Chalet Hotels	757.9	27.7	27.4	4.9	202512	27.1	29.3	69.4	499.7	-5.3	11.1	1.0	1080.0	690.0
Chambal Fert.	438.1	47.8	9.2	1.8	202512	19.9	9.7	21.5	18.5	-0.5	27.8	0.1	742.5	400.0
Choice Intl.	664.3	9.8	68.0	9.1	202603	21.2	16.7	22.9	39.1	-5.4	20.8	0.7	860.0	568.6
Chola Financial [1]	1556.5	126.1	12.3	2.1	202512	17.2	28.7	20.3	14.2	-0.9	11.4	13.6	2299.0	1305.0
Cholaman.Inv.&Fn [2]	1561.1	61.4	25.4	4.4	202603	19.5	30.6	20.2	22.8	-0.5	10.3	7.2	1831.8	1299.8
Cipla [2]	1309.9	58.9	22.3	3.2	202512	0.0	-43.7	4.6	-4.7	1.2	23.2	0.0	1672.2	1165.6
City Union Bank [1]	270.0	17.8	15.1	1.9	202603	21.1	24.9	17.8	18.0	2.8	0.0	0.0	320.0	172.0
Clean Science [1]	819.2	23.1	35.5	5.8	202512	-8.8	-30.1	4.4	-5.8	0.4	27.3	0.0	1599.0	652.8
Coal India	481.4	50.5	9.5	2.5	202603	36.1	12.9	7.2	-12.1	5.6	25.9	0.1	490.9	368.6
Cochin Shipyard [5]	1734.6	27.6	62.8	8.0	202512	17.7	-18.3	21.8	-9.0	4.2	20.1	0.1	2547.3	1186.6
Coforge [2]	1196.0	29.5	40.5	2.2	202512	28.5	63.0	39.4	59.4	4.0	21.7	0.2	1994.0	1008.5
Cohance Life [1]	483.0	7.9	61.4	4.9	202512	-19.5	-73.8	23.2	-28.4	33.9	13.6	0.1	1180.0	267.9
Colgate-Palmoliv [1]	2096.8	49.0	42.8	36.0	202512	1.4	2.3	-2.9	-8.8	-3.5	103.8	0.0	2746.0	1781.6
Concord Biotech [1]	1140.2	30.1	37.9	6.5	202512	13.7	-11.9	6.4	-3.5	12.2	29.5	0.0	2149.9	987.1
Container Corpn. [5]	508.8	16.8	30.3	3.0	202512	4.5	-8.9	2.0	-4.1	1.2	13.7	0.1	652.5	421.8
Coromandel Inter [1]	1981.7	71.9	27.6	4.8	202512	26.6	-1.2	32.4	28.8	-0.6	23.3	0.1	2720.0	1819.3
Craftsman Auto [5]	7690.3	147.3	52.2	6.1	202512	30.5	477.1	50.4	79.0	1.7	11.3	0.9	8199.0	4425.0
CreditAcc. Gram.	1299.0	30.3	42.9	2.9	202512	8.0	153.3	1.1	-44.9	5.1	9.6	3.1	1496.6	1066.5
CRISIL [1]	4287.7	114.8	37.4	10.3	202603	30.1	45.9	16.7	18.9	0.4	35.6	0.1	6330.0	3689.0
Crompton Gr. Con [2]	272.6	7.6	35.8	5.2	202512	7.3	2.7	1.4	-6.5	9.0	20.2	0.2	364.4	217.5
Cummins India [2]	5271.2	84.0	62.7	18.5	202512	-1.5	4.4	13.4	15.9	0.8	35.3	0.0	5321.0	2701.7
Cyient [5]	871.4	41.4	21.0	1.7	202603	0.9	-58.0	-1.3	-25.2	-0.1	17.2	0.1	1376.9	751.0
D														
Dabur India [1]	441.5	10.5	42.1	7.2	202512	6.1	9.4	3.5	3.4	-2.4	20.9	0.1	576.8	401.1
Dalmia BharatLtd [2]	1906.5	61.7	30.9	2.0	202603	3.8	-9.1	5.9	50.9	-2.8	5.4	0.3	2496.0	1721.5
Data Pattern [2]	4090.8	44.5	91.8	14.9	202512	47.9	35.8	97.4	39.5	0.4	21.3	0.0	4294.5	2122.0
DCM Shriram [2]	1225.9	44.8	27.4	2.7	202512	13.0	-5.2	13.8	28.6	3.3	11.3	0.4	1501.7	946.2
Deepak Fertilis.	1263.5	69.3	18.2	2.5	202512	9.7	-43.6	15.2	-0.7	3.3	15.7	0.7	1777.0	865.5
Deepak Nitrite [2]	1736.9	39.7	43.7	4.3	202512	3.8	10.9	-3.4	-21.5	2.8	16.7	0.2	2173.0	1280.4
Delhivery [1]	467.2	2.4	194.2	3.7	202512	17.9	167.5	11.7	340.6	3.9	1.9	0.1	490.0	295.4
Devyani Intl. [1]	124.6	-0.1		9.9	202512	11.3	2369.4	12.6	-182.5	16.5	0.0	2.8	191.2	91.6
Divi's Lab. [2]	6505.4	95.4	68.2	11.2	202512	12.3	8.2	13.6	22.6	2.3	20.4	0.0	7077.7	5637.5
Dixon Technolog. [2]	11176.9	227.1	49.2	16.7	202512	2.1	67.8	46.4	120.3	3.3	42.0	0.2	18471.5	9605.1
DLF [2]	587.2	17.4	33.7	3.4	202512	32.2	56.1	35.8	14.9	0.0	6.3	0.1	887.5	489.3
DOMS Industries	2294.4	36.6	62.8	12.7	202512	18.2	14.1	23.4	11.5	-0.9	27.0	0.2	2890.0	2006.9
Dr Agarwal's Hea [1]	444.4	4.0	110.1	7.3	202512	23.0	51.0	23.5	42.6	1.5	9.3	0.6	567.8	327.4
Dr Lal Pathlabs	1368.1	31.4	43.6	9.6	202603	16.6	-15.2	12.2	7.8	-2.9	29.2	0.1	1771.3	1272.0
Dr Reddy's Labs [1]	1323.0	66.7	19.8	3.1	202512	4.4	-14.4	11.1	3.7	0.5	23.1	0.1	1378.0	1121.2
E														
eClerx Services	1428.7	71.1	20.1	5.1	202512	25.4	40.1	20.8	28.8	-2.7	28.3	0.1	2493.0	1153.4
Eicher Motors [1]	7110.4	196.9	36.1	8.8	202512	22.7	25.1	26.2	21.6	0.0	28.7	0.0	8232.8	5201.2
EID Parry [1]	844.0	52.5	16.1	1.7	202512	18.3	19.1	23.5	15.1	-0.2	24.2	0.3	1246.5	751.8
EIH [2]	318.9	12.3	26.0	4.2	202512	9.1	-0.7	8.1	9.4	-2.4	22.9	0.1	434.4	271.4
Elecon Engg.Co [1]	507.1	15.1	33.5	4.9	202603	-6.5	-50.7	6.2	-18.2	-1.0	28.1	0.1	716.6	352.0
Elgi Equipments [1



Safety break for your digital payments

PAY-WISE. RBI's proposed safeguards aim to slow, verify and better protect users from scams

GETTY IMAGES

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Think of an airport baggage carousel. When the belt is moving fast, you often hesitate — was that your bag or someone else's? It's easy to miss it in the rush. But when the belt slows down, the same bag is much easier to recognise. Details stand out, and you have a moment to be sure before picking it up.

Fraud works in a similar way. When money moves instantly, there's no time to pause or question. Slow things down even briefly, and it becomes easier to spot when something isn't right.

India spent the last decade building among the world's fastest retail payments systems. UPI, IMPS and instant bank transfers made moving money almost effortless. But that same speed has also become a scamster's weapon. In many frauds today, the victim is not hacked but manipulated — through fake arrest calls, parcel scams or threats of account freezes — into transferring money voluntarily.

These are authorised push payment frauds (APP frauds). The Reserve Bank of India's latest discussion paper (https://tinyurl.com/rbidigifraud) argues that stronger safeguards are now needed, even if that means adding a little friction. The concern is clear. Fraud cases have risen more than tenfold since 2021, while the money at stake has exploded to nearly ₹23,000 crore.

SLOWING PAYMENTS

One of the key proposals in the RBI paper is simple: account-to-account transfers above ₹10,000 to individuals, sole proprietorships or partnership firms could be delayed by one hour.

The lag would apply primarily at the payer's end, with customers retaining the option to cancel the transaction during this window.

The logic is straightforward. Fraudsters rely on urgency and psychological pressure.

A one-hour pause can disrupt that, giving the payer time to reconsider.

The RBI notes that while such transactions account for about 45 per cent of fraud cases by number, they make up 98.5 per cent of the value lost — making the threshold significant.

However, the trade-off is clear. Delays may inconvenience time-sensitive payments and conflict with the expectation of instant transfers. The paper therefore also explores whether such lags should be applied more selectively, for instance, to first-time payees or unusual transactions.

Customers may also be allowed to override the delay by whitelisting payees or specific transactions. But this creates another risk. Fraudsters could simply persuade victims to bypass the safeguard.

KILL SWITCH

The RBI is considering giving customers far greater control over digital payments. Similar to how cards can be switched on or off today, customers may be able to enable or disable UPI, internet banking and other payment channels at the account level.

This would be helpful because fraud situations require speed, and one control can quickly stop all digital payment access. It also lets customers match payment access to their actual usage, instead of leaving every channel open by default.

> **QUICK NOTE**
> Account-to-account transfers above ₹10,000 to individuals, sole proprietorships etc. could be delayed by one hour

More importantly, there could be a single "kill switch" to disable all digital payments at once. This control could be made available through apps, internet banking, call centres, branches and other authenticated channels. Once activated, it would override all other settings.

Reactivating payments may require stricter authentication, and in some cases even a branch visit. Certain transactions such as standing instructions or mandates may continue to be exempt.

A broader policy question remains. Should digital payment access be enabled by default, or should new accounts start with these features switched off in the interest of security? The answer will determine how this balance between safety and convenience evolves.

PROTECTING ELDERLY

The paper proposes that for app transfers above ₹50,000, customers aged 70 and above and persons with disabilities may require an additional authentication from a designated "trusted person". The idea is to add a second layer of verification for high-value transactions, where fraud risk tends to be higher.

However, the proposal raises practical questions. What happens if the trusted person is unavailable? Could this delay urgent transactions? And how workable is this for customers who operate independently?

The framework also proposes a 24-hour cooling period for changing the trusted person or opting out. This is meant to prevent hasty or pressured decisions.

However, it brings up a broader issue. The real challenge is balancing protection with autonomy. Safeguards should help vulnerable customers without making routine banking cumbersome.

MIND IT

One RBI proposal is that all bank accounts may, by default, be flagged as low-credit-turnover accounts unless the bank turns off the flag after taking additional documents. Such accounts may face an annual aggregate credit limit fixed by the bank, subject to an RBI ceiling of ₹25 lakh.

If money comes in above this limit, the excess may be kept as "shadow credit" and released only after the bank is satisfied that the transaction is genuine. If the customer cannot satisfy the bank within 30 calendar days, the amount may be sent back.

The idea is aimed at making bank accounts harder to misuse. But it may also inconvenience genuine customers with irregular large inflows, such as freelancers, small traders, retirees or families receiving large transfers. The challenge is to curb mule accounts without creating avoidable friction for ordinary customers.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Mar 25
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Apr 23
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.9	6.6	6.2	6	Apr 20
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	May 01
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Apr 15
DCB Bank	6.5	7.15	7.15	7.15	Mar 19
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	May 01
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.4	7	7	Mar 19
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.75	6.15	6.15	Apr 11
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Apr 22
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Apr 09
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	7.75	7.75	6	May 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.5	7.5	7.77	Apr 11
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

*Data as on respective banks' website on 01 May 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

Fiscal fitness & job uncertainty

FINANCIAL PLANNING. At 49, job uncertainty calls for liquidity, patience and a realistic retirement corpus

GETTY IMAGES

Sridevi V

Indrani wanted to check her financial position before making a few important financial decisions which will impact her life in the long run.

As she is expecting her employer to cut the workforce by 20-30 per cent in the immediate future, she wanted to check where she stands financially to support her future expenses.

Aged 49 and single, she lives in Hyderabad. She is staying in her own apartment.

She is weighing early retirement and moving back to her home-town, or whether she should stay on in Hyderabad continuing her employment.

Her assets and investments are as listed:

She built these assets and investments over the past 25+ years meticulously planning her savings, opting for housing loan, closing the loan with her year-end bonus systematically.

Hyderabad has given her professional identity; she loves her stay here with all financial growth, but she has her an emotional bond with her native place.

Assets & investments

	in ₹
Self-occupied house	85,00,000
EPF	65,00,000
PPF	15,00,000
Fixed deposits	30,00,000
Equity mutual funds	68,00,000
Total	**2,63,00,000**

She was planning for early retirement but not yet ready for it.

She wants to take a decision at her own pace. She spends ₹65,000 per month and saves the remaining ₹1 lakh from her post-tax salary.

She understands equity market movements and is willing to put money for the long term; however, she is not clear about her goals and how much she needs.

So, she has opted for a balanced approach to her investments.

RECOMMENDATIONS

* She likes to have close to four years of expenses in safe avenues; she considers this as her emergency fund. She was advised to continue with her fixed deposits. Though it is taxable, she is happy holding fixed deposits, as she is the only one to handle the money in case of any emergency including medical needs. It was recommended to have laddered fixed deposits with auto renewal facility to help her manage the fixed deposits.

> **CASE IN POINT**
> - Laddered FDs for emergency liquidity
> - No need to chase aggressive returns
> - Working till 55-58 improves flexibility

* Interest from fixed deposits may be redirected to annual PPF contribution. This will help her not to increase the fixed deposits but smoothen the safety requirement and tax efficiency in the overall plan.

* Fixed deposits and PPF together will be ₹76 lakh when she turns 58. This will be a reasonable corpus for a medical fund.

* With no contribution to EPF and MF Equity portfolio, with an expected return of 9.5 per cent to 10.7 per cent CAGR in the next nine years, she will be able to get a corpus of ₹3.12-3.40 crore.

* This corpus will help manage her expenses of ₹65,000 per month at an expected inflation of 6 per cent per annum from her retirement age of 58 till her expected life expectancy of 90.

* Now, she is expecting 18-24 months of her income as compensation if there is layoff from her employer. Approximately she will receive ₹30-40 lakh, post-tax if she is laid off.

* It would be ideal for her to continue working till she turns 55 or 58, as her technical skills are in demand despite less opportunities.

* Her needs do not demand her to aggressively invest as her financial position is not in disarray. She needs to earn for her living expenses and can focus skill upgradation. A part of the compensation package may be invested towards early retirement, to help her make the choice at her will.

* Additional earned income till her age of 55-58 will help her accumulate wealth for a comfortable lifestyle and time to explore her desires before moving to her home-town.

The author is the Principal Officer at Ploutus Asset Services LLP, a SEBI registered investment advisory firm. https://ploutus.in

ఆంధ్రప్రదేశ్ గ్రామీణ బ్యాంక్
ప్రభుత్వరంగ షెడ్యూల్డ్ బ్యాంక్
ANDHRA PRADESH GRAMEENA BANK
(Scheduled Bank Owned by Government)
HEAD OFFICE : RAGHU MANSION, 4/1, BRODIPET, GUNTUR-522 002, A.P.

Performance Highlights*

Deposits ₹64672.87 Crore 14.89%↑

Advances ₹71664.51 Crore 12.09%↑

Aggregate Business ₹136337.38 Crore 13.40%↑

Operating Profit ₹2523.26 Crore

Net Profit After Tax ₹1835.81 Crore

Net Worth ₹13340.04 Crore 15.96%↑

Net NPA NIL

*All pictorial highlights are derived through comparison with the Bank's financials as on 01-May-2025

FORM - A
BALANCE SHEET AS ON 31ST MARCH 2026

ASSETS & LIABILITIES	SCHEDULE	₹ in Crores As on 31-MAR-2026
LIABILITIES		
Capital	1	122.42
Reserves & Surplus	2	13,217.62
Deposits	3	64,672.87
Borrowings	4	14,115.46
Other Liabilities & Provisions	5	3,456.07
TOTAL		95,584.44
ASSETS		
Cash and Balances with RBI	6	2,466.87
Balance with Banks and Money at Call & Short Notice	7	11,945.13
Investments	8	10,947.28
Advances	9	66,043.27
Fixed Assets	10	282.02
Other Assets	11	3,899.87
TOTAL		95,584.44
Contingent Liabilities	12	664.24
Significant Accounting Policies	17	
Notes to Accounts	18	

Advances shown above are net of IBPC outstanding of Rs.5000 crore as on 31.03.2026.
Advances shown above as on 31.03.2026 are net of Technical Write-Off of Rs.14.19 Crore and NPA of Rs.607 Crore.

FORM - B
PROFIT AND LOSS ACCOUNT FOR THE 11 MONTH PERIOD (01-MAY-2025 TO 31-MAR-2026)

PARTICULARS	SCHEDULE	₹ in Crores 01-MAY-25 TO 31-MAR-26
I INCOME		
Interest Earned	13	7,759.37
Other Income	14	1,140.17
Provisions Written Back		
TOTAL		8,899.54
II EXPENDITURE		
Interest Expended	15	4,431.89
Operating Expenses	16	1,638.74
Provisions and Contingencies	16 A	305.65
Provision for Investments and Others		
TOTAL		6,376.28
III PROFIT & LOSS		
Profit before Tax		2,523.26
Less: Provision for Income Tax		688.00
DTA / DTL		0.55
Profit after Tax		1,835.81
IV APPROPRIATIONS		
Transfer to Statutory Reserves		367.16
Balance carried over to Profit and Loss Acc		1,468.65
TOTAL		1,835.81

Disclosure in financial statements – Notes to Accounts (Excerpts from Schedule 18): (1) CRAR: 23.62%, **(2)** Movement of Gross NPAs: (a) Opening Balance: Rs. 580.16 Cr, (b) Additions during the year: Rs. 234.92 Cr, (c) Reductions during the year: Rs. 208.08 Cr, (d) Closing Balance: Rs.607.00 Cr, **(3)** Provision towards Standard Assets: Rs. 14.05 Cr, **(4)** Bank made provision for NPAs over and above the required provision as per IRAC norms. The Provision Coverage Ratio (PCR) stood at 100% as on 31st March 2026.Thus the advances shown in the balance sheet are net of NPA provision of Rs.607.00 Cr, **(5)** Bank has not drawn any amount from Reserves during the current financial year 2025-26, **(6)** Provision made for income Tax: Rs. 688 crore [Deferred Tax Asset of Rs.0.55 crore is availed], **(7) Business Ratios: i)** Interest Income as a percentage to Working Funds – 8.68 %, **ii)** Non-interest income as a percentage to Working Funds – 1.27%, **iii)** Cost of Deposits - 6.41%, **iv)** Net Interest Margin - 3.72%, **v)** Operating Profit as a percentage to Working Funds – 2.82%, **vi)** Return on Assets – 2.05%, **vii)** Business (deposits plus advances) per employee (in ₹crore) - 18.45, **viii)** Profit per employee (in ₹ crore) – 0.25, **(8)** During the year ended with March 2026, no penalty has been levied by RBI, **(9)** Priority Sector Lending Certificates (PSLC): **(i)** Bank sold PSLC-Agri of Rs.20985.00 and earned income of Rs.617.73 crore. **(ii)** Bank purchased PSLC-General of Rs. 10150.00 crore & PSLC-Micro Enterprises of Rs.10000.00 crore at a premium of Rs. 201.50 crore, during FY 2025-26. **Note: (1)** The financial statements for FY 2025- 26 are audited by Statutory Central Auditors, M/s M N RAO & ASSOCIATES LLP, Chartered Accountants, Vijayawada, **(2)** The above results have been approved and taken on record by the Board of Directors of the Bank at the meeting held on 30.04.2026, **(3)** The financial results have been prepared in accordance with the Master Direction on 'Financial Statements – Presentation & Disclosures (for Regional Rural Bank) issued by RBI, **(4)** The net profit after tax is arrived at after considering provisions for standard assets and non-performing assets as per prudential norms issued by NABARD, provisions for staff related items and provision for taxes and other necessary provisions.

Place : GUNTUR
Date : 30-04-2026
Sd/- K Pramod Kumar Reddy
Chairman

BENGALURU
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SUNDAY - MAY 3 - 2026

bl.portfolio STAR TRACK

MUTUAL FUND RATINGS

Empowering Investors

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	Sortino Ratio (%)
	EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.1	15235	1.7	0.6	-1.4	12.6	11.4	13.6	0.34
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large Cap	106.7	69948	1.4	0.9	0.1	15.3	14.7	14.1	0.49
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Large Cap	88.7	46521	1.5	0.7	3.1	16.2	17.1	14.8	0.55
★★★★	HDFC Large Cap	1091.7	35458	1.6	1.0	-1.6	12.5	13.8	13.1	0.44
★★★★	JM Large Cap	148.2	390	2.4	0.9	1.7	13.3	12.4	11.1	0.35
★★★★	Kotak Large Cap	553.6	9794	1.7	0.6	0.9	12.9	12.1	12.6	0.36
★★★★	SBI Large Cap	91.2	48926	1.5	0.8	2.3	12.0	12.2	12.3	0.37
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	505.3	26702	1.6	1.0	-0.5	13.1	12.5	12.3	0.37
★★★	Bandhan Large Cap	75.5	1821	2.1	0.9	2.8	14.8	12.9	12.8	0.37
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	218.1	2344	2.0	0.8	2.6	14.4	13.1	12.7	0.38
★★★	Edelweiss Large Cap	81.2	1322	2.1	0.6	-0.1	12.3	12.1	12.7	0.36
★★★	Franklin Ind Large Cap	982.8	6821	1.9	1.2	-0.3	12.1	10.4	10.8	0.32
★★★	Invesco India Largecap	67.4	1537	2.0	0.7	2.1	15.5	13.6	12.8	0.40
★★★	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.6	35343	1.5	0.6	0.7	11.1	10.7	13.0	0.31
★★★	Tata Large Cap	496.2	2448	2.0	1.0	2.5	13.3	12.5	12.1	0.37
★★★	UTI Large Cap	259.4	11203	1.8	0.9	-2.5	10.7	10.0	11.6	0.27
★★	DSP Large Cap	451.8	6620	1.8	0.9	-2.4	15.1	12.3	11.6	0.38
★★	HSBC Large Cap	460.7	1667	2.2	1.3	1.3	12.8	11.5	12.4	0.32
★★	LIC MF Large Cap	52.1	1253	2.2	1.1	-3.6	9.4	9.0	10.4	0.24
★★	Union Largecap	22.7	403	2.6	1.8	0.1	11.0	10.8	-	0.30
★	Axis Large Cap	57.5	28661	1.6	0.7	-2.4	10.2	8.2	11.8	0.20
★	Groww Largecap	41.8	117	2.5	1.3	3.4	12.1	11.1	11.2	0.30
★	PGIM India Large Cap	323.5	501	2.4	0.9	-1.9	9.0	8.7	10.3	0.23
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.9	653	2.4	0.8	-2.8	11.9	10.7	-	0.32
-	Taurus Large Cap	156.9	46	2.6	2.3	4.2	14.6	12.3	10.7	0.33
	EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	137.4	14109	1.7	0.5	9.8	23.1	19.1	16.3	0.57
★★★★★	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	331.3	25295	1.6	0.9	3.8	17.9	17.6	14.9	0.53
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1001.6	27005	1.6	0.8	4.8	19.5	19.4	15.9	0.66
★★★★	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.7	13973	1.7	0.6	7.3	18.0	14.6	-	0.40
★★★★	Quant Large & Mid Cap	116.4	2782	2.0	0.8	4.2	16.9	16.6	15.9	0.43
★★★★	SBI Large & Midcap	625.0	34871	1.6	0.7	7.4	16.1	16.5	15.1	0.54
★★★★	UTI Large & Mid Cap	180.6	5234	1.8	0.9	6.4	20.1	17.6	14.5	0.56
★★★	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	89.8	422	2.3	1.1	9.3	16.1	14.9	13.1	0.43
★★★	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	243.6	22203	1.6	0.7	0.8	14.9	13.3	15.2	0.38
★★★	DSP Large & Mid Cap	604.4	15780	1.7	0.7	1.7	18.4	15.0	15.1	0.47
★★★	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	86.8	4067	1.9	0.5	7.1	17.6	15.2	14.8	0.44
★★★	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	98.3	8436	1.8	0.6	8.7	23.1	17.7	16.0	0.47
★★★	Kotak Large & Midcap	341.4	27373	1.6	0.6	7.4	17.4	15.7	15.6	0.46
★★★	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	149.8	38138	1.5	0.6	7.1	15.8	13.5	17.1	0.39
★★★	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1446.1	6299	1.9	1.1	3.8	19.3	16.7	13.2	0.50
★★	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	182.2	3135	2.1	1.4	2.0	14.8	12.9	11.5	0.39
★★	LIC MF Large & Midcap	36.9	2710	2.0	0.9	1.8	16.5	13.6	14.4	0.40
★★	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	83.5	6031	1.8	0.7	3.2	15.0	14.1	14.4	0.39
★★	Tata Large & Mid Cap	482.2	7040	1.8	0.7	-4.1	10.2	11.9	12.7	0.33
★	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	897.8	5103	1.9	1.1	6.7	14.5	10.2	11.9	0.24
★	Navi Large & Midcap	34.7	267	2.3	0.5	3.5	11.8	12.3	12.8	0.34
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	27.8	4238	1.9	0.8	14.1	20.4	16.4	-	0.38
	EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	HDFC Flexi Cap	1944.5	91335	1.4	0.7	1.2	18.8	19.5	16.3	0.68
★★★★★	JM Flexicap	93.0	4504	1.9	0.7	-1.1	18.5	17.3	16.5	0.48
★★★★★	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	83.4	128966	1.3	0.6	3.8	16.8	15.9	17.3	0.59
★★★★	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.8	2957	1.9	0.5	4.7	17.2	15.2	14.9	0.43
★★★★	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1561.8	17536	1.7	0.9	-1.4	16.0	15.4	13.4	0.46
★★★★	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.1	5332	1.8	0.5	1.9	11.8	10.6	13.9	0.30
★★★★	Union Flexi Cap	49.6	2079	2.1	1.0	2.7	13.9	13.0	13.2	0.37
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1824.0	23018	1.7	0.9	6.7	17.4	13.7	14.3	0.40
★★★	Bandhan Flexi Cap	204.2	6651	1.9	1.2	3.0	14.9	12.8	11.2	0.37
★★★	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	329.6	11922	1.7	0.6	2.9	13.5	12.3	14.2	0.36
★★★	DSP Flexi Cap	98.7	10726	1.7	0.7	0.9	15.1	12.3	14.2	0.34
★★★	HSBC Flexi Cap	219.3	4724	2.0	1.2	8.1	18.3	15.5	13.3	0.40
★★★	Kotak Flexicap	83.4	50146	1.5	0.6	4.3	15.0	13.2	14.0	0.38
★★★	SBI Flexicap	105.2	20626	1.7	0.9	0.8	10.8	10.8	12.2	0.32
★★★	Tata Flexi Cap	23.5	3310	1.9	0.6	1.0	14.9	11.9	-	0.35
★★	Axis Flexi Cap	25.8	11413	1.7	0.7	2.8	14.0	10.7	-	0.27
★★	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	55.7	11679	1.7	0.8	-2.6	19.4	12.5	12.4	0.31
★★	Navi Flexi Cap	23.2	232	2.2	0.5	9.8	12.7	11.9	-	0.35
★★	UTI Flexi Cap	292.5	20438	1.7	1.1	-6.0	8.7	6.7	11.5	0.14
★	LIC MF Flexi Cap	94.6	895	2.4	1.7	7.6	12.5	10.9	10.0	0.28
★	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	118	2.4	0.5	-1.1	9.0	9.2	-	0.21
★	Taurus Flexi Cap	218.4	306	2.7	2.6	1.4	13.2	11.5	10.1	0.31
-	Quant Flexi Cap	101.9	5687	1.9	0.7	8.0	17.7	19.0	19.3	0.50
	EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS									
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	281.8	2861	2.0	0.9	4.9	17.4	16.2	14.5	0.44
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	816.0	14681	1.8	1.0	7.7	20.3	17.8	15.1	0.56
-	Invesco India Multicap	120.2	3550	1.9	0.7	-2.4	15.0	13.7	13.4	0.37
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.1	5661	1.8	0.5	10.1	20.4	17.8	-	0.49
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	295.8	46321	1.5	0.7	7.2	20.3	21.3	15.9	0.65
-	Quant Multi Cap	617.6	6574	1.8	0.7	3.7	12.0	13.6	17.0	0.34
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	367.6	2525	2.0	0.9	3.4	15.9	15.3	14.9	0.43
	EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Edelweiss Mid Cap	103.0	13554	1.7	0.5	10.7	24.7	21.0	18.7	0.57
★★★★★	HDFC Mid Cap	196.7	85358	1.4	0.8	10.7	23.6	21.3	18.1	0.66
★★★★★	Quant Mid Cap	212.7	7002	1.8	0.9	0.7	16.6	18.6	16.8	0.49
★★★★	Invesco India Midcap	178.9	9895	1.7	0.6	13.6	25.6	21.0	18.3	0.54
★★★★	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	34.7	4099	1.9	0.5	12.0	24.2	20.1	-	0.55
★★★★	Motilal Oswal Midcap	91.0	31047	1.6	0.9	-3.9	20.9	22.8	16.5	0.58
★★★★	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4306.5	39676	1.6	0.8	12.3	25.4	22.2	19.0	0.63
★★★	Axis Midcap	114.4	28835	1.6	0.5	10.2	19.5	15.7	16.9	0.44
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	106.6	2129	2.0	0.5	12.9	21.0	17.6	15.8	0.50
★★★	ICICI Pru Midcap	329.4	6569	1.9	1.1	24.3	26.2	20.7	17.3	0.59
★★★	Kotak Midcap	137.6	55676	1.4	0.4	13.9	21.5	18.9	17.9	0.53
★★★	PGIM India Midcap	62.4	9681	1.7	0.5	4.4	13.6	13.8	15.7	0.40
★★★	SBI Midcap	233.4	20576	1.7	0.9	4.1	15.7	16.3	14.3	0.48
★★★	Sundaram Mid Cap	1416.2	11898	1.7	0.9	11.3	24.2	19.8	15.3	0.55
★★★	Tata Mid Cap	440.3	4993	1.9	0.7	10.2	20.8	17.3	16.3	0.50
★★	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	793.8	5493	1.9	1.0	9.0	20.5	17.4	14.0	0.47
★★	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2656.8	10899	1.8	1.0	3.1	20.3	16.2	14.7	0.44
★★	Taurus Mid Cap	115.2	109	2.6	2.2	3.0	14.4	13.1	14.8	0.34
★★	UTI Mid Cap	296.0	10482	1.8	0.9	7.3	16.6	15.0	14.2	0.40
★	DSP Midcap	147.5	17492	1.7	0.7	10.1	19.6	13.8	15.1	0.37
★	HSBC Midcap	425.3	11342	1.7	0.7	21.6	26.9	19.2	17.5	0.46
★	LIC MF Midcap	28.7	301	2.5	1.4	7.6	19.9	15.0	-	0.37
	EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	170.4	61809	1.4	0.7	10.4	21.1	22.3	20.9	0.57
★★★★★	Quant Small Cap	256.4	25821	1.7	0.8	8.4	20.1	21.8	18.9	0.52
★★★★	AXIS Small Cap	105.4	23919	1.6	0.6	8.5	17.8	18.1	18.2	0.52
★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	48.7	1770	2.0	0.5	15.3	21.8	19.9	-	0.47
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	41.9	9208	1.7	0.5	11.2	24.1	21.8	-	0.54
★★★	DSP Small Cap	202.4	15300	1.7	0.8	19.4	20.9	19.7	16.8	0.50
★★★	HDFC Small Cap	131.6	33724	1.6	0.8	7.1	16.4	19.1	17.6	0.51
★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	84.7	7538	1.8	0.8	7.5	15.8	18.0	15.9	0.54
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	249.0	15157	1.7	0.6	5.1	14.9	15.2	16.6	0.39
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	268.6	2983	2.0	0.9	15.7	20.5	19.0	14.9	0.48
★★★	Tata Small Cap	34.9	9621	1.7	0.4	-3.0	13.0	17.1	-	0.44
★★★	Union Small Cap	52.6	1666	2.2	1.1	21.7	21.0	18.6	16.3	0.44
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	170.5	11724	1.8	1.0	7.9	19.3	20.0	15.5	0.49
★★	HSBC Small Cap	79.9	13882	1.7	0.8	8.9	17.1	20.0	18.6	0.46
★★	SBI Small Cap	167.9	32286	1.6	0.8	5.5	13.9	15.3	17.7	0.43
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	88.8	4449	1.9	0.9	14.8	19.4	15.1	13.4	0.35
★	LIC MF Small Cap	30.6	552	2.4	1.1	10.7	18.8	18.6	-	0.44
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	38.1	11603	1.7	0.6	8.1	16.1	18.5	-	0.50
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	43.6	5108	1.8	0.5	9.8	19.0	19.4	-	0.52
	EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS									
★★★★★	HSBC Value	112.4	13371	1.7	0.7	10.1	21.7	19.5	16.6	0.56
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	461.4	55852	1.5	1.0	2.1	17.7	18.5	15.2	0.71
★★★★	Bandhan Value	144.5	9042	1.8	0.7	1.4	15.2	16.4	15.7	0.50
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	223.1	7993	1.8	1.1	3.7	20.8	18.1	16.2	0.53
★★★	HDFC Value	743.3	6588	1.9	1.0	5.7	18.4	16.4	14.1	0.49
★★★	JM Value	91.7	721	2.4	1.3	-0.1	18.1	17.1	16.2	0.45
★★★	Templeton India Value	702.3	2005	2.1	1.0	1.3	15.5	17.5	14.6	0.55
★★★	Union Value	28.0	337	2.5	1.2	6.1	17.3	15.8	-	0.48
★★★	UTI Value	162.6	8663	1.9	1.2	1.4	16.9	14.4	13.8	0.44
★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	128.8	5639	1.9	1.0	10.7	19.2	15.9	12.7	0.41
★★	Tata Value	344.0	7909	1.8	0.8	4.5	17.1	16.0	15.1	0.49
★	LIC MF Value	25.6	181	2.5	1.4	16.7	16.7	14.3	-	0.36
★	Quantum Value	117.5	1018	2.1	1.1	-3.3	14.2	12.2	11.5	0.40
-	Groww Value	26.3	60	2.5	1.1	3.1	15.5	13.0	10.5	0.39
-	Sundaram Value	212.9	1212	2.3	1.7	0.9	11.4	12.0	11.4	0.36
	EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS									
★★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	135.6	15044	1.7	0.7	0.6	17.9	15.3	15.5	0.47
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	381.1	10978	1.7	0.8	10.8	17.3	17.4	19.8	0.45
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	427.2	28441	1.6	1.0	2.2	20.6	18.5	14.8	0.58
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	150.5	6274	1.8	0.7	3.1	13.9	14.2	15.0	0.43
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	162.8	1260	2.0	0.8	8.4	16.7	14.7	16.3	0.39
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	172.9	7810	1.7	0.6	4.1	14.0	12.8	14.7	0.38
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax saver	1334.7	14615	1.7	1.1	-2.1	17.4	18.0	14.0	0.62
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	47.2	196	2.4	1.0	4.5	17.9	15.4	15.8	0.41
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	48.1	22940	1.6	0.6	4.7	15.2	13.5	17.0	0.39
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	96.1	809	2.2	1.0	6.4	18.0	13.6	12.7	0.37
★★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1391.1	5684	1.9	1.1	-2.8	15.5	14.7	12.7	0.44
★★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	912.4	12810	1.7	1.1	1.8	15.2	13.7	13.2	0.42
★★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	112.2	5587	1.8	0.6	1.8	13.5	13.6	14.4	0.38
★★★	Mahi Manu ELSS Tax Saver	27.1	828	2.2	0.8	-0.7	11.9	12.6	-	0.36
★★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	53.6	3969	1.8	0.7	15.5	24.8	19.4	17.1	0.44
★★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	116.8	193	2.1	0.9	-3.2	14.1	12.2	11.6	0.40
★★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	494.5	1183	2.2	1.6	1.7	13.6	13.5	13.8	0.40
★★★	Tata ELSS	44.9	4091	1.8	0.8	7.5	15.6	14.3	14.1	0.41
★★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.9	772	2.4	1.4	3.9	13.9	13.6	12.8	0.39
★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	111.5	395	2.3	0.7	7.2	15.7	13.7	12.5	0.39
★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	133.2	3561	1.9	1.2	6.7	18.2	14.6	13.8	0.38
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	116.0	2293	2.0	0.9	-2.1	14.2	11.2	12.9	0.29
★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	128.6	13422	1.7	1.0	5.6	17.2	15.5	11.4	0.46
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	32.8	638	2.3	0.8	-2.6	9.7	11.7	12.7	0.34
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	195.7	3175	1.9	1.0	-0.7	12.1	10.6	12.0	0.28
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	59.9	13117	1.7	1.0	6.1	14.8	9.6	10.8	0.25
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	92.7	29076	1.6	0.8	-0.1	12.6	8.6	12.0	0.19
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	142.1	915	2.2	1.1	-2.9	12.6	11.7	12.0	0.33
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.6	46	2.4	0.9	1.3	11.3	10.5	-	0.27
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.1	42	2.3	0.7	-0.2	9.3	9.0	-	0.21
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	175.2	64	2.5	2.2	-0.7	13.1	12.7	13.1	0.39
	EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS									
-	Invesco India Contra	127.7	17664	1.7	0.5	-0.5	17.6	15.1	15.4	0.44
-	Kotak Contra	148.1	4679	1.9	0.6	5.6	18.4	16.4	16.1	0.49
-	SBI Contra	372.4	43754	1.5	0.8	0.9	16.4	19.2	16.0	0.68
	EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	52.5	5912	1.8	0.6	3.7	20.5	21.3	16.2	0.75
★★★★	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	136.0	2141	2.1	1.3	0.9	15.0	15.9	15.4	0.61
★★★	LIC MF Dividend Yield	30.0	583	2.4	0.8	5.2	20.2	16.3	-	0.46
★★★	UTI Dividend Yield	174.6	3497	2.0	1.5	3.6	18.7	15.5	14.3	0.50
★★	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	455.1	1339	2.2	1.4	8.7	18.0	17.5	13.4	0.54
★	Sundaram Dividend Yield	133.2	810	2.3	1.1	1.5	14.6	13.2	14.9	0.43
	EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	184.4	2186	2.0	0.7	-4.7	13.5	15.6	13.2	0.45
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	29.6	1301	2.1	0.7	-3.3	13.2	12.9	-	0.34
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumption	102.8	1705	2.1	0.9	-1.9	13.4	13.3	15.5	0.36
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	201.4	5478	1.8	0.8	-3.1	12.5	12.8	14.1	0.35
★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	88.0	4018	1.9	0.4	-0.1	13.8	14.6	15.5	0.38
★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	288.9	2644	2.0	1.0	-4.4	11.2	15.5	14.5	0.44
★★★	Tata India Consumer	43.8	2261	2.0	0.8	4.1	17.1	15.4	16.2	0.39
★★	Sundaram Consumption	89.7	1294	2.2	1.2	-4.7	13.3	13.1	12.5	0.35
★★	UTI India Consumer	54.9	609	2.5	1.6	-0.3	12.9	11.9	11.3	0.29
★	Mahi Manu Consumption	21.2	456	2.4	0.8	-1.7	12.6	12.3	-	0.34
	EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS									
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	104.1	1439	2.1	0.8	2.3	15.7	14.7	14.7	0.41
★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	140.5	1480	2.1	0.8	8.2	19.1	16.0	15.6	0.43
★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	622.3	6721	1.9	1.0	2.1	15.5	16.4	14.2	0.46
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	61.1	3155	2.0	1.0	4.0	14.2	12.9	13.6	0.34
★★★	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	127.4	9367	1.8	1.1	-2.0	12.2	12.3	13.8	0.34
★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	42.7	9380	1.8	0.7	5.9	17.6	14.0	16.1	0.37
★★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	42.3	2743	1.9	0.6	1.2	14.2	13.0	14.9	0.35
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	47.0	346	2.4	0.8	1.5	14.3	12.1	12.4	0.30
★★	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	187.1	1213	2.2	1.1	2.4	13.9	12.7	11.7	0.34
★	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	20.8	239	2.5	1.2	4.8	10.2	11.1	9.7	0.29
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	52.5	10	2.6	2.5	-0.2	10.3	11.3	13.0	0.30
	EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS									
★★★★★	SBI Technology Opport	186.4	4027	1.9	0.9	-5.8	10.8	11.1	15.0	0.28
★★★★	ICICI Pru Technology	169.9	12575	1.8	1.0	-9.4	9.7	9.1	15.1	0.22
★★★	Franklin Ind Technology	447.4	1556	2.1	1.1	-5.2	15.5	9.8	14.5	0.22
★★	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	143.6	3590	1.9	0.8	-9.6	7.7	7.8	14.8	0.18
★	Tata Digital India	39.1	9239	1.7	0.6	-12.2	8.4	8.2	14.3	0.19
	EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru P.H.D	40.0	6293	1.9	1.1	7.1	27.0	16.2	-	0.54
★★★★	DSP Healthcare	38.9	2892	1.9	0.6	4.9	21.8	13.6	-	0.41
★★★	Mirae Asset Healthcare	40.1	2754	1.9	0.5	9.4	23.8	14.4	-	0.45
★★★	Nippon Ind Pharma	517.1	7898	1.8	0.9	4.0	22.1	13.3	14.4	0.43
★★★	SBI Healthcare Opport	439.3	4064	1.9	0.9	4.6	24.8	15.6	12.3	0.54
★★	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	30.0	1229	2.2	0.7	2.3	22.0	13.4	12.2	0.42
★	UTI Healthcare	292.7	1056	2.3	1.3	8.3	24.9	14.0	12.7	0.44
-	LIC MF Healthcare	29.3	78	2.4	0.6	4.7	20.9	10.6	-	0.30
	HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS									
★★★★★	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	40.0	1282	2.0	0.7	13.6	19.8	17.3	-	0.48
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	399.8	46700	1.5	0.9	5.1	17.6	18.3	15.8	0.82
★★★★★	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	441.5	1809	2.1	0.8	9.9	13

CASH FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	AA & Below
	LIQUID FUNDS									
-	360 ONE Liquid	2109.9	1177	0.3	0.2	7.7	6.7	6.1	6.0	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	442.2	43022	0.4	0.2	8.1	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Axis Liquid	3057.7	30188	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3313.4	12083	0.2	0.1	8.0	6.8	6.2	6.1	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3162.4	1611	0.1	0.1	6.4	6.8	6.3	6.3	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3154.7	8599	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.2	6.1	-
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3304.5	4858	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	DSP Liquidity	3920.1	16866	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3511.5	8877	0.1	0.0	6.6	6.9	6.3	6.3	-
-	Groww Liquid	2654.4	162	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5384.8	53982	0.3	0.2	8.0	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2736.3	13434	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.8	6.2	6.2	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	406.1	42888	0.3	0.2	7.8	6.7	6.2	6.2	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3773.1	11723	0.2	0.2	6.4	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	ITI Liquid	1427.8	58	0.3	0.1	6.2	6.4	6.0	6.1	-
-	JM Liquid	74.8	2567	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.6	6.1	6.1	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5546.5	33309	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.8	6.2	6.2	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	4961.5	11106	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1786.2	1012	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2876.5	10562	0.2	0.1	7.6	6.8	6.2	6.2	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	1017	0.4	0.2	6.8	6.2	5.8	5.8	-
-	Navi Liquid	29.7	62	0.2	0.2	5.5	5.8	5.7	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6697.4	25756	0.4	0.2	8.0	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1521.9	5171	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.2	6.1	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	357.4	478	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.8	6.3	6.2	5.20
-	Quant Liquid	43.3	1418	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.0	5.7	5.8	-
-	Quantum Liquid	36.6	510	0.3	0.2	5.5	6.0	5.7	5.7	-
-	SBI Liquid	4288.2	57891	0.3	0.2	8.0	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2418.7	5175	0.4	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.1	6.1	-
-	Tata Liquid	4322.3	22316	0.3	0.2	7.7	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	Union Liquid	2641.5	5756	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
-	UTI Liquid	4504.2	19763	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1474.7	592	0.3	0.2	7.9	6.8	6.2	6.1	-
	OVERNIGHT FUNDS									
-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1450.3	4931	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Axis Overnight	1426.7	7849	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1431.3	557	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1369.9	37	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.2	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1414.4	389	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1394.9	264	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	DSP Overnight	1440.7	2255	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1394.2	127	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1406.2	527	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
-	Groww Overnight	1384.9	113	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	HDFC Overnight	3968.3	7434	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1403.8	2589	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.2	5.3	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1448.7	8824	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1362.0	316	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	ITI Overnight	1360.1	25	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.7	4.8	5.1	-
-	JM Overnight	1364.9	53	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	5.0	5.2	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1433.9	5067	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1390.8	902	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1390.8	27	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1378.8	708	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	144.3	3903	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1388.5	41	0.2	0.2	4.8	4.8	5.0	5.3	-
-	SBI Overnight	4339.1	17849	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1426.9	346	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Tata Overnight	1416.5	2569	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Union Overnight	1414.1	398	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	UTI Overnight	3661.9	2973	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.4	-
	ARBITRAGE FUNDS									
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.8	25065	1.0	0.3	4.7	5.4	6.0	5.8	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9023	1.0	0.3	4.5	5.4	6.0	5.8	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.9	7790	1.1	0.3	4.4	5.2	5.7	5.5	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	45	0.9	0.4	4.4	5.6	5.9	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1276	1.1	0.3	4.0	4.9	5.5	5.5	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6376	0.9	0.3	4.5	5.4	5.8	5.7	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.3	14414	1.1	0.4	4.6	5.4	5.9	5.7	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.1	23777	0.9	0.4	4.8	5.5	6.1	5.8	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2526	0.9	0.3	4.4	5.8	6.1	5.8	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.0	31342	0.9	0.4	4.5	5.4	6.1	5.8	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.5	26370	1.1	0.4	4.8	5.3	6.1	5.9	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.6	73	0.9	0.2	2.9	5.5	6.0	5.9	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.1	353	1.1	0.4	3.4	4.9	5.7	5.4	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.3	67117	1.0	0.4	4.6	5.6	6.1	5.9	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	220	1.0	0.3	4.7	5.5	5.9	5.6	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	106	1.1	0.4	4.2	4.9	5.5	5.1	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3474	0.9	0.1	3.6	5.1	5.8	5.6	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.8	15788	1.0	0.3	4.6	5.3	5.9	5.7	0.80
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.2	100	1.0	0.4	4.2	5.2	5.8	5.3	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.5	41059	0.9	0.4	4.3	5.5	6.0	6.0	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	412	1.0	0.3	5.3	5.7	6.1	5.8	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.1	20686	1.1	0.3	4.6	5.5	6.1	5.8	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.7	241	1.0	0.4	4.1	5.3	5.7	5.5	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.8	10500	0.8	0.3	4.7	5.4	6.1	5.9	-

DEBT FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below (%)
	DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS									
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Savings	576.8	19348	0.6	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	8.68
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1620.8	705	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.2	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4229.6	9512	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.7	24.37
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	3528	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.1	13619	0.8	0.4	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.1	11.70
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1375.3	1640	0.4	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.2	1.22
★★★★	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4440.2	3130	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.3	8.56
★★★	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	3958	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.6	10.59
★★★	DSP Ultra Short	3567.4	3560	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.6	8.42
★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16037	0.7	0.4	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.28
★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1422.7	2470	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2829.5	963	0.8	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.9	5.8	12.87
★★★	Kotak Savings	45.0	14989	0.8	0.4	6.1	6.7	6.8	5.9	7.59
★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1444.2	194	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.87
★★★	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6274.7	11847	0.6	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	9.47
★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1424.2	586	1.0	0.5	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.5	-
★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3312.1	117	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.5	9.44
★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1382.8	187	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.5	2.88
★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	161	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.6	-
★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	3955	1.2	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.6	5.6	8.31
★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3976.8	483	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.4	-
★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	411	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.6	5.7	4.8	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2797.1	1454	1.4	0.2	5.2	5.9	6.0	5.1	2.13
	DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Savings	572.0	26665	0.6	0.4	6.4	7.3	7.5	6.5	6.87
★★★★★	UTI Low Duration	3726.6	2246	0.4	0.3	6.2	7.2	7.2	7.2	7.56
★★★★	Axis Treasury Advantage	3248.2	5455	0.7	0.3	6.2	7.1	7.1	6.1	8.20
★★★★	DSP Low Duration	20.8	4669	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.9	-
★★★★	HDFC Low Duration	60.5	22104	1.1	0.5	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	12.55
★★★★	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	981	0.9	0.4	6.0	7.6	7.5	6.2	9.83
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	685.8	10865	1.2	0.4	5.6	6.6	6.6	5.8	12.11
★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.4	5723	0.7	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.9	-
★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	44.2	1295	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	3964.8	1659	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.9	6.9	5.9	6.15
★★★	JM Low Duration	38.8	212	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.8	5.86
★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3920.6	8768	1.1	0.4	5.9	6.9	6.9	5.9	8.84
★★★	SBI Low Duration	3650.8	13583	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.7	6.7	5.8	3.90
★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4117.9	2460	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.9	6.9	5.9	3.03
★★	Kotak Low Duration	3497.4	15257	1.2	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.7	5.8	12.08
★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1709.7	555	1.1	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.6	13.73
★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2362.6	2333	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.7	3.86
★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3608.6	436	1.2	0.4	5.3	6.5	6.5	5.6	2.98
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.9	260	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.6	1.94
★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1830	0.4	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.6	5.6	2.85
	DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4365.2	19420	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3244.8	18344	0.2	0.1	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	389.2	28780	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★	Axis Money Market	1505.8	20349	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	399.2	31750	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4723.8	32331	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1449.3	4365	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.0	5.9	-
★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.8	3959	0.3	0.1	6.3	7.2	7.2	6.2	-
★★★	HDFC Money Market	6011.6	28188	0.5	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★	PGIM India Money Market	1392.6	152	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
★★★	Sundaram Money Market	15.8	1943	0.3	0.2	6.2	7.1	7.1	6.1	-
★★★	Tata Money Market	4968.2	32382	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★	DSP Savings	55.3	8947	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★	HSBC Money Market	27.7	5970	0.3	0.2	6.2	7.0	7.0	5.9	-
★★	Invesco India Money Market	3198.5	7154	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★	SBI Savings	43.5	34892	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.9	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	42.4	13437	0.4	0.1	6.3	7.0	6.9	5.8	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.8	2508	0.8	0.1	5.8	6.6	6.6	5.5	-
	DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	62.9	20688	1.1	0.5	5.5	7.3	7.2	6.4	10.50
★★★★★	UTI Short Duration	32.9	2359	0.8	0.4	4.7	6.8	6.9	6.9	9.41
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.5	6501	1.0	0.4	4.9	7.1	6.9	6.1	14.38
★★★★	Axis Short Duration	32.3	8342	0.9	0.4	5.3	7.4	7.1	6.0	7.99
★★★★	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.4	14728	0.7	0.4	5.2	7.3	7.2	6.2	9.59
★★★★	Nippon Ind Short Duration	54.9	6632	1.0	0.4	5.0	7.2	7.0	6.0	8.51
★★★	Bandhan Short Duration	59.5	8612	0.8	0.3	5.0	7.2	6.9	5.8	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.3	280	1.1	0.4	4.5	6.8	6.7	5.7	1.80
★★★	HSBC Short Duration	27.5	3799	0.7	0.3	4.8	7.0	6.7	5.5	-
★★★	Kotak Bond Short Term	54.0	15582	1.1	0.4	4.4	6.8	6.6	5.6	-
★★★	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	593	1.1	0.2	4.0	6.6	6.4	5.4	-
★★★	SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	14580	0.9	0.4	4.8	7.0	6.8	5.8	6.58
★★★	Sundaram Short Duration	46.0	190	0.7	0.3	4.8	7.0	6.8	5.9	2.62
★★	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.3	357	1.0	0.3	4.6	6.5	6.4	5.3	-
★★	DSP Short Term	48.2	2903	0.9	0.4	4.3	6.7	6.5	5.5	-
★★	Invesco India Short Duration	3692.5	712	1.1	0.4	4.5	6.7	6.6	5.4	3.91
★★	Tata Short Term Bond	49.5	2785	1.2	0.3	4.0	6.4	6.3	5.3	-
★	Groww Short Term	2157.2	88	1.1	0.4	4.6	6.5	6.1	4.9	-
★	LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	188	1.2	0.4	4.3	6.6	6.3	5.1	5.69
-	Bank of India Short Term Income	27.7	278	1.0	0.5	4.5	7.4	6.8	10.0	2.89
-	Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.2	88	1.3	0.4	4.7	6.8	6.6	5.5	13.56
	DEBT - MEDIUM DURATION FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium Duration	16.4	143	1.0	0.5	6.8	8.4	7.6	8.8	36.90
★★★★	Axis Strategic Bond	29.3	2083	1.3	0.7	5.4	7.7	7.4	6.6	55.06
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium Term Bond	47.1	5524	1.4	0.7	6.2	8.0	7.5	6.6	36.08
★★★	HDFC Medium Term Debt	58.7	3697	1.3	0.7	4.9	7.2	7.0	6.1	33.76
★★★	Kotak Medium Term	23.8	1807	1.6	0.7	5.9	7.8	7.5	6.4	44.81
★★★	SBI Medium Duration	53.2	6580	1.2	0.7	4.6	7.1	6.9	6.1	46.83
★★	DSP Bond	84.5	304	0.8	0.4	4.0	6.9	6.8	5.7	-
★★	HSBC Medium Duration	21.2	737	1.1	0.4	4.5	7.2	7.0	5.9	31.74
★	Bandhan Medium Duration	47.2	1329	1.4	0.7	3.7	6.6	6.2	5.0	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Medium Term	42.5	3078	1.6	0.8	7.9	11.2	9.5	11.8	42.48
-	Sundaram Medium Duration	70.3	34	2.1	1.1	2.3	5.2	5.0	3.9	2.94
-	UTI Medium Duration	18.8	37	1.4	0.8	3.4	6.3	6.2	5.9	24.65
	DEBT - MEDIUM TO LONG DURATION FUNDS									
★★★★★	UTI Medium to Long Duration	74.4	300	1.6	1.2	1.3	6.0	5.8	8.0	5.01
★★★★	ICICI Pru Bond	41.1	2698	1.1	0.6	2.4	6.7	6.7	5.7	-
★★★★	SBI Medium to Long Duration	72.1	2034	1.5	0.8	2.0	6.1	6.1	5.5	34.10
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Income	126.4	1792	1.1	0.7	0.5	5.6	5.6	5.1	-
★★★	Kotak Bond	77.7	1878	1.7	0.7	1.2	5.7	5.8	5.1	-
★★★	LIC MF Medium to Long Duration	73.7	189	0.5	0.2	2.0	6.4	6.2	5.2	-
★★★	Nippon Ind Medium to Long Dur	90.7	368	1.5	0.7	0.9	5.6	5.7	5.0	-
★★	Bandhan Medium to Long Duration	66.0	451	2.0	1.3	1.6	5.5	5.3	4.4	-
★★	HDFC Income	58.9	820	1.4	0.8	0.9	5.9	5.9	4.7	-
★	Canara Robeco Income	55.9	114	1.9	0.8	0.6	5.1	4.9	4.2	-
-	HSBC Medium to Long Duration	42.8	49	1.2	0.7	1.3	5.7	5.4	4.4	-
-	JM Medium to Long Duration	63.2	30	1.1	0.6	2.0	6.3	6.0	4.8	-
	DEBT - LONG DURATION FUNDS									
-	ICICI Pru Long Term Bond	89.5	897	1.0	0.4	-1.2	5.4	5.8	4.6	-
-	Nippon Ind Nivesh Lakshya LD	17.7	7538	0.7	0.3	-2.4	5.1	5.5	5.0	-
	DEBT - DYNAMIC BOND FUNDS									
★★★★★	360 ONE Dynamic Bond	23.4	595	0.5	0.3	4.3	7.7	7.5	6.6	4.21
★★★★★	UTI Dynamic Bond	31.9	418	1.6	0.7	3.0	6.7	6.5	8.6	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dynamic Bond	47.7	1510	1.2	0.6	2.9	7.2	6.8	6.5	37.63
★★★★	ICICI Pru All Seasons Bond	38.1	14002	1.3	0.6	3.6	6.9	6.9	6.2	22.17
★★★★	Quantum Dynamic Bond	21.8	91	1.0	0.5	1.1	6.3	6.5	5.8	-
★★★	Axis Dynamic Bond	30.6	1073	0.6	0.3	3.3	7.0	6.8	5.8	-
★★★	DSP Strategic Bond	3361.4	789	1.2	0.5	-1.4	5.2	5.9	5.1	-
★★★	HDFC Dynamic Debt	90.5	598	1.4	0.8	0.5	5.5	5.8	5.9	-
★★★	Kotak Dynamic Bond	38.4	2465	1.3	0.6	2.0	6.6	6.6	5.6	9.89
★★★	Nippon Ind Dynamic Bond	38.4	3976	0.8	0.4	3.3	7.1	6.8	5.7	-
★★★	PGIM India Dynamic Bond	2654.9	86	1.7	0.5	0.3	5.7	5.8	4.9	-
★★★	SBI Dynamic Bond	36.8	3928	1.3	0.6	2.5	6.8	6.6	5.8	-
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Dynamic Bond	45.6	134	1.7	0.7	-0.9	5.0	5.2	4.8	-
★★	HSBC Dynamic Bond	30.0	126	0.6	0.3	0.9	6.1	6.1	5.1	-
★★	Mirae Asset Dynamic Bond	16.9	116	1.0	0.1	5.4	6.7	6.3	4.9	-
★	Bandhan Dynamic Bond	34.5	2103	1.6	0.7	0.1	5.9	5.9	4.9	-
★	Canara Robeco Dynamic Bond	29.2	90	1.8	0.8	-1.7	4.2	4.5	4.1	-
-	Groww Dynamic Term	1473.3	38	1.3	0.5	-0.3	4.5	4.7	4.4	-
-	JM Dynamic Bond	42.5	54	1.0	0.4	1.9	6.5	6.2	5.5	-
-	Mahi Manu Dynamic Bond	14.6	71	1.6	0.4	2.3	6.3	6.0	4.6	10.50
-	Union Dynamic Bond	23.0	92	1.6	1.3	-2.4	4.5	4.8	4.0	-
	DEBT - CORPORATE BOND FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Corporate Bond	31.1	30212	0.6	0.4	5.3	7.3	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Corporate Bond	62.2	8354	0.8	0.4	4.4	7.2	7.1	6.3	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Corporate Bond	116.5	25105	0.5	0.3	3.8	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	Axis Corporate Bond	17.8	8142	0.9	0.4	4.7	7.2	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★	Kotak Corporate Bond	3915.8	15221	0.7	0.4	4.6	7.2	7.0	6.1	-
★★★	Bandhan Corporate Bond	20.0	13956	0.7	0.3	4.7	7.1	6.9	5.7	-
★★★	Franklin Ind Corporate Debt	104.3	1255	0.7	0.3	5.8	7.9	7.4	6.1	7.20
★★★	HDFC Corporate Bond	33.5	31029	0.6	0.4	3.7	6.7	6.9	6.0	-
★★★	Invesco India Corporate Bond	3281.6	4884	0.7	0.3	4.0	6.8	6.7	5.6	-
★★★	SBI Corporate Bond	16.1	21491	0.8	0.4

BENGALURU
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SUNDAY - MAY 3 - 2026

Kotak Mahindra standalone Q4 net up 13% on higher NII, lower provisions

STRONG SCORECARD. The bank had clocked a net profit of ₹3,552 crore in the year ago quarter

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Kotak Mahindra Bank reported a 13 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) increase in fourth quarter standalone net profit at ₹4,027 crore on the back of a decent growth in net interest income and a sharp decline in provisions.

India's fourth largest private sector bank had clocked a net profit of ₹3,552 crore in the year ago quarter.

QUARTERLY RESULTS

Standalone net profit for FY26 declined 15 per cent to ₹14,008 crore vs ₹16,450 crore in FY25. The net profit last year was boosted by sale of 70 per cent stake in Kotak General Insurance to Zurich Insurance Company for ₹4,096 crore resulting in a net gain of ₹3,803 crore (pre-tax).

The bank's board recommended a dividend of ₹0.65 per equity share of ₹1 face value each for FY26.

In the reporting quarter, the net interest income (interest earned less interest expended) was up 8 per cent at ₹7,876 crore (₹7,284 crore in Q4FY25).

Other income, including non-fund based income such as commission earned from guarantees/ letters of credit, selling of third party products, general banking fees, earnings from foreign exchange transactions, profit / loss from sale and revaluation of investments, and income earned by way of dividend, etc. from subsidiaries/associates, declined 2 per cent to ₹3,116 crore (₹3,182 crore).

Q4 scorecard *(in ₹ crore)*

	Q4 FY25	Q4 FY26	% Change
Net profit	3,552	4,027	13.4
Net Int Income	7,284	7,876	8.1
Other Income	3,182	3,116	-2.1
Operating Profit	5,472	5,855	7.0
Provisions	909	516	-43.2
GNPA (%)	1.42	1.2	-
Deposits	4,99,055	5,72,456	14.7
NIM %	4.97	4.67	-

Provisions, including towards non-performing assets (NPAs), declined 43 per cent to ₹516 crore (₹909 crore).

Asset quality improved further, with the gross NPA position edging lower to 1.2 per cent of gross advances as at March-end from 1.42 per cent as at March-end 2025. The net NPA position too improved to 0.25 per cent from 0.31 per cent.

As on March-end 2026, deposits and net advances increased 15 per cent (to stand at ₹5,72,456 crore) and 16 per cent (₹4,96,009 crore, respectively.

GLOBAL FACTORS

MD and CEO Ashok Vaswani said the bank is closely monitoring the second-order impact of the geopolitical developments and the El Nino weather pattern. Further, he does not see any stress from the West Asia war.

Provisions, including towards NPAs, declined 43 per cent to ₹516 crore (₹909 crore)

The bank expects to grow its unsecured book in a calibrated manner, with the focus on existing customers.

KMB reported a consolidated net profit of ₹5,423 crore in the reporting quarter, up 10 per cent from ₹4,933 crore a year ago.

ED Rohit Jain elevated as RBI Deputy Governor

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the appointment of Rohit Jain as a Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India for three years.

The appointment of Jain, who is currently an Executive Director at the central bank, will take effect from the date of joining the post on or after May 3, 2026, whichever is earlier.

TAKE THE BATON

He will take over from T Rabi Sankar, who has been Deputy Governor since May 3, 2021.

Jain currently oversees the functioning of the Department of Supervision (Supervisory Assessment).

Besides Rabi Sankar, the RBI has three Deputy Governors — Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta and Shirish Chandra Murumu.

TVS Motor sales rise 7% in April; dispatch slowed by supply chain, input woes

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Motor Company recorded monthly sales of 473,970 units in April, a growth of seven per cent as against 443,716 units in the same month last year.

TVS, in a statement, flagged dispatch volumes being impacted by lower production due to supply chain constraints, including workforce availability, raw material and consumable shortages (especially in Tier-1 and Tier-2 suppliers), and limited container availability for timely international dispatches.

DEMAND RISE

Two-wheelers registered a growth of 6 per cent with sales increasing to 455,333 units in April 2026 from 430,150 units in April 2025, a statement by the auto maker said. The motorcycle segment sales registered 200,039 units while the scooter segment saw sales of 211,158 units in April.

The company's three-wheeler segment registered a growth of 37 per cent with sales increasing to 18,637 units in April 2026 from 13,566 units in April 2025.

ROBUST EV SALES

As for electric vehicles, registrations saw a robust growth of 36 per cent with sales increasing from 27,684 units in April 2025 to 37,771 units in April 2026. International Business sales registered a growth of 3 per cent increasing to 120,008 units in April 2026 from 116,700 units in April 2025.

Crude oil surge poses a price, not supply, shock for India: CEA Nageswaran

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The current crude scenario poses a price shock, not a supply shock, said Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran on Saturday. He cautioned that while the current account deficit could widen, the fiscal deficit estimates would be under challenge, too.

"Many of the petrochemicals, petroleum products and the base crude oil that we import are much higher than what they were in early in February and compared to earlier. But based on the inputs from Ministry of Petroleum and Natural has. this is only a price shock and not a supply shock for India, which may be the case for others," Nageswaran said at the ICPP Growth Conference, organised by Ashoka University.

CHANNELS IDENTIFIED

He listed four channels of shocks, including the oil price channel. Then there is also an impact on trade in general. "As global growth slows down and the Gulf economies slow down, you have a trade impact. Then you have the logistics cost pack, which is going to be sticky," he said. Normally, they don't come down that easily once they go up, and the uncertainty will remain. Therefore, insurance and freight costs will not necessarily return to pre–February 28 levels.

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran
VELANKANNI RAJ B

"Then the remittance shock... We get $120 billion in remittances in general of which $30-40 billion comes from Gulf region. You could come up with your own estimate of how much will be lost, which will be only a guesstimate at this point," he said.

Further, the CEA said managing the current account deficit (CAD), ensuring its financing, and preventing further depreciation in the rupee will be key priorities for FY27. The CAD, which was estimated at below 1 per cent of GDP in FY26, is expected to rise in the current fiscal, with projections of around 2 per cent or higher.

The CEA said that India is better prepared than many other countries because we have some fiscal leverage. Because "we have brought down our gross fiscal deficit ratio to 4.4 per cent as of last year, and in FY27 we budgeted 4.3 per cent," he said

Adani Power readies for entry into nuclear energy, lining up land, SPVs

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Adani Power Ltd, India's largest private sector thermal power producer with an installed capacity of over 18 GW, is building an early-stage but deliberate pipeline in nuclear energy, focusing on land aggregation, corporate structuring and regulatory readiness so it can scale up quickly once policy visibility improves.

"So far the government of India has not notified the Rules, so we are only getting ourselves ready. As and when the Rules come, it will give us clarity about the size, capacity, etc. At this stage, we are only preparing ourselves. Therefore, we are identifying sites. Where we have the site, we are applying for approvals. So, we are preparing ourselves to move fast," said S B Khyalia, Chief Executive Officer of Adani Power Ltd, during an investor call earlier this week. He added that the company is currently focused on site identification and approvals so that it can "move fast" once the regulatory framework is in place.

Importantly, the company is not looking at re-purposing existing thermal assets for nuclear projects. "In our case these are new sites and will not be existing thermal sites," Khyalia said, indicating a clear preference for dedicated greenfield nuclear developments.

The groundwork on sites comes alongside structural steps already taken by the company to enter the nuclear segment. Adani Atomic Energy Ltd was incorporated in February to mark the company's entry into the nuclear power segment. Building on this, Coastal-Maha Atomic Energy Ltd , a step-down wholly-owned subsidiary, was incorporated in April to undertake generation, transmission and distribution of nuclear and atomic energy.

BROADER PUSH

While no regulatory approvals were required for incorporation at this stage, the broader nuclear push remains contingent on policy evolution. The Centre has been signalling a willingness to open up the sector to private participation, while retaining control over critical areas such as fuel management and safety.

Beyond India, Adani Power is also widening its search for opportunities. "We will evaluate international projects in thermal, hydro and transmissions sector and invest in attractive opportunities that qualify. We recently incorporated an SPV in Bhutan for a 520 MW hydro power plant with this aim," Khyalia said. The company is also aligning itself with long-term shifts in the power sector. " We have incorporated several SPVs in India for nuclear power projects. We are identifying lands for these projects and seeking necessary approvals," he added.

Alongside this strategic positioning, the company is preparing for significant capital expenditure (capex) over the next few years, both for its conventional and emerging energy portfolio.

Prasoon Joshi is new Prasar Bharati Chairman

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting on Saturday said that it has appointed lyricist and writer Prasoon Joshi as the Chairman of public service broadcaster Prasar Bharati. The Ministry said he is a distinguished creative professional with wide-ranging contributions across literature, advertising, cinema, and public communication.

This comes months after the Ministry accepted previous Chairman Navneet Kumar Sehgal's resignation.

Prasoon Joshi

Joshi has served as Chairperson, Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), Mumbai, since August 2017.

Noting that Joshi has played a significant role in shaping contemporary Indian media narratives, the Ministry said that his " body of work spans acclaimed film lyrics, advertising campaigns, and socially resonant storytelling that connects with diverse audiences across the country."

Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said, "My heartfelt congratulations to Prasoon Joshi on his appointment as Chairman of the Prasar Bharati Board. Under his stewardship, Prasar Bharati will discover renewed energy, deeper purpose, and a fresh creative voice. "

Electric 3-wheeler sales up a tad in April, led by L5 vehicles

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Electric three-wheeler (E3W) sales held steady in April at about 61,260 units, with Vahan data showing modest month-on-month growth, even as rising fuel cost concerns among fleet operators accelerated the shift towards higher-speed L5 vehicles.

Growth was led by the L5 segment, which expanded nearly 4 per cent to 25,307 units, while the L3 category declined about 1 per cent to 35,953 units, pointing to a gradual shift towards higher-value, lithium-ion powered vehicles.

CONSOLIDATION

The gains were sharply concentrated among incumbents. Mahindra Last Mile Mobility, Bajaj Auto and TVS Motor continued to dominate, accounting for nearly 88 per cent of the L5 market, reflecting increasing consolidation. In contrast, several smaller players, including Omega Seiki Mobility (OSM), reported sharp declines, highlighting pressure on the long tail as scale and distribution become critical.

Even so, industry participants view the shift positively. "There may be dips for a few OEMs, including us, but what is encouraging is the move towards higher-speed vehicles, that is a positive for the industry," said Uday Narang, Founder and CEO of Omega Seiki Mobility, adding that cost visibility is increasingly shaping fleet decisions.

NEXT PHASE

"While commercial LPG prices have moved up, there is growing concern around the trajectory of petrol, diesel and CNG costs. For logistics and e-commerce players, that uncertainty is pushing a faster shift towards electric three-wheelers, particularly in cargo applications," he said, noting a rising demand for higher payload vehicles. "There is a clear shift towards vehicles with payload capacities of 1-1.5 tonnes."

Fuel economics are reinforcing this transition. CNG prices remain elevated across key cities — about ₹77/kg in Delhi, ₹81/kg in Mumbai, ₹91.5/kg in Chennai and ₹90/kg in Bengaluru — translating to a running cost of ₹3-4 per km while electric three-wheelers offer significantly lower running costs of around ₹1.4 per km, making them more viable for high-utilisation use-cases.

Narang said the next phase of growth will be led by cargo and logistics even as passenger vehicles continue to dominate volumes. "Quick commerce and food delivery are driving demand for compact, high-utilisation electric three-wheelers operating in short-delivery cycles," he said.

Power Ministry 'targets 60% local content in HVDC substations in phases in FY28-35'

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Power Ministry has mandated a revised roadmap for achieving 60 per cent Minimum Local Content (MLC) in high voltage direct current (HVDC) substations in phases between FY28 and FY35.

The Ministry has revised the roadmap for local content in HVDC substations (Line Commutated Converter type), which aligns with its vision to promote self-sufficiency, reduce imports and create a robust domestic ecosystem for manufacturing HVDC equipment.

Under the revised roadmap, the Ministry has mandated reaching an MLC of 30 per cent by FY28, which will be scaled up to 40 per cent by FY30. The local content requirement will then be scaled up to 50 per cent by FY32 and finally 60 per cent by FY35.

India has one of the world's largest transmission networks, with more than 425,000 circuit km transmission lines and a transformation capacity exceeding 900,000 MVA, operating at voltage levels of 220 kV and above.

AMBITIOUS TARGET. Under the revised roadmap, the Ministry has mandated reaching an MLC of 30 per cent by FY28, which will be scaled up to 40 per cent by FY30

NATIONAL PLAN

As renewable capacity accelerates, the network is undergoing a significant technological transition, including the deployment of HVDC, GIS, STATCOMs, synchronous condensers, series compensation and advanced substation systems.

According to Hitachi Energy, HVDC is a key enabler for a carbon-neutral energy system.

A number of capital intensive transmission projects such as EHVAC projects, HVDC projects, synchronous condensers (syncon) with optimised planning are envisaged to be implemented as per the NEP for expansion of the inter-regional connectivity and grid modernisation.

These projects require high-value converter transformers and reactors, with only a limited number of qualified suppliers.

According to Motilal Oswal Financial Services, transformer manufacturers in India are also benefiting from the increasing share of HVDC projects, which require specialised, high-value converter transformers and reactors supplied by a limited pool of players such as Hitachi Energy India, Siemens Energy India, GE Vernova T&D India and BHEL.

Of the 32.3 gigawatt (GW) HVDC pipeline outlined in the National Electricity Plan (NEP) FY23-32, about 14.5 GW has already been tendered and awarded.

According to the NEP, over 191,000 ckm (circuit km) of transmission lines and 1,270 GVA of transformation capacity are to be added during the ten years from 2022-23 to 2031-32 (at 220 kV and above voltage level). In addition, 33 GW of HVDC bi-pole links are also planned.

The inter-regional transmission capacity will increase to 143 GW by 2027 and further to 168 GW by 2032, from the present level of 119 GW.

Swiggy elevates Swapnil Bajpai as CEO of Dineout, Scenes businesses

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Swiggy has appointed Swapnil Bajpai the Chief Executive Officer of its 'Dineout' and 'Scenes' businesses, handing the company veteran the mandate to scale its dining-out and experiences verticals as competition intensifies beyond core food delivery.

Bajpai steps into the role after several years within Swiggy across business, sales, supply and monetisation functions. Most recently, he served as Senior Vice-President and Business Head for Swiggy Dineout, Assure and Lynk. The addition of Scenes — focussed on events, nightlife and curated experiences — signals Swiggy's intent to move up the consumer spending chain, from meals to occasions. Bajpai will now oversee the combined vertical, which brings together restaurant discovery, table bookings, bill payments and events-led offerings under a single leadership structure.

E-bus sales up 19% in 4 months of 2026; April sees dip after March spike

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India's electric bus market grew about 19 per cent year-on-year in the first four months of 2026, with registrations rising to around 1,868 units from 1,571 in the same period last year, even as dispatches fell in April after a March spike, reflecting execution cycles linked to infrastructure readiness. New entrants such as JSW Greentech have begun pilot supplies, signalling fresh capacity entering the market.

According to Vahan data, total electric bus registrations stood at 347 units in April, down about 37 per cent from 553 units in March, following stepped up fiscal year-end deliveries.

SEGMENT PLAYERS

On a monthly basis, PMI Electro Mobility topped April with 111 units, followed by JBM (Auto + Electric Vehicles combined) and Switch Mobility at 62 units each, and Pinnacle Mobility at 52 units. Smaller volumes were recorded by Aeroeagle (28 units) and JSW Greentech (25 units) — the latter a new entrant in the electric bus segment. Other players, including Tata Motors, Olectra and VE Commercial Vehicles, reported limited dispatches.

The variation across manufacturers reflects delivery schedules rather than a uniform demand trend, with volumes tied to contract execution cycles.

JSW Greentech's April dispatch of 25 buses marks its formal entry into India's electric bus market, albeit as a pilot. Part of the JSW Group, the company is currently supplying initial batches for internal fleet electrification, and pilot deployments rather than large-scale rollouts.

The company is actively bidding for large public procurement programmes such as the PM e-Bus Sewa and PM E-Drive schemes, positioning itself for future scale.

It is also setting up a greenfield manufacturing facility in Chattrapati Sambhaji Nagar (Aurangabad) in Maharashtra with plans to produce up to 10,000 electric buses annually.

Industry analysts expect commercial dispatches to external customers to pick up in the second half of 2026, once the facility ramps up. The current rollout represents an early pilot phase as the company builds capabilities and aligns with tender-driven demand.

May data remain fresh with about 43 electric buses recorded so far, all of them from JBM Auto, indicating that dispatch activity has begun, with broader industry volumes expected to build as the month progresses.

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